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Hindust

No easing of pilot duty rules from Mar: DGCA

Neha LM Tripathi
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has told airlines that no variations to pilot duty and rest rules will be allowed from March 2027, when the second phase of the Flight Duty Time Limitations (FDTL), takes full effect, persons aware of the matter said.

The rules were due to be implemented since November 2025 and deferred after IndiGo's operational collapse roiled India's aviation sector. This time, airlines have been directed to plan their crew rosters and operations to comply with the regulations, one of the people cited above added.

"Airlines have been informed that all variations to DGCA rules will end when full FDTL are implemented in March," this person added, asking not to be named.

The FDTL rules prescribe limits on pilots' flight duty periods, night operations and consecutive duties, and specify minimum rest requirements, to address pilot fatigue and improve flight safety. The first of two phases took effect on July 1, 2025. The second, largely relating to night operations, was to take effect on November 1, 2025, but was deferred for all airlines after IndiGo's operational collapse.

More than 1.04 million passengers were affected by flight cancellations in December, over 93% of them IndiGo's, according to DGCA data, and the airline's market share fell to 59.6% from 63.6% in one month. DGCA exempted IndiGo from several FDTL provisions until February 10, 2026, and later fined it ₹22.2 crore.

A one-time relaxation for airlines, due to end on April 30 this year, was overtaken by the conflict in West Asia, which drove up aviation fuel prices and forced airlines to take longer routes, stretching them financially and operationally. A number of relaxations approved since then expire on October 31. They are likely to be extended, the persons said.

In submissions to the DGCA in November last year, before the December disruption, airlines had sought variations to several provisions. IndiGo, for

continued on →13

DGCA set for full FDTL rollout

JAN 8, 2024: DGCA notifies revised Flight Duty Time Limitations (FDTL)

JUL 1, 2025: Phase I takes effect

NOV 1, 2025: Phase II, largely covering night operations, due. Deferred for all airlines

DEC 2025: IndiGo ops collapse: thousands of passengers affected

FEB 10, 2026: IndiGo's exemption ends; airline later fined ₹22.2 crore

MARCH 2026: One-time relaxation for airlines due to end; West Asia conflict prompts extension

OCT 31, 2026: Current relaxations expire; likely to be extended

MARCH 2027: Full FDTL, no relaxations

U.S. TEEN HELD FOR PLOTTING SHOOTING AT CHICAGO TEMPLE

PALATINE/NEW DELHI: Police in a Chicago suburb has said that they had thwarted a potential mass shooting, arresting a 19-year-old man who they said may have planned to target a Hindu temple. Prosecutors said the suspect, Alexandros Paporakis, had openly identified as a white supremacist at work and told his co-workers he couldn't wait to kill Indian people.

India on Thursday expressed deep concern over the alleged plot and urged American authorities to thoroughly investigate the matter and bring those responsible to justice. →P14

COP'S 8-YR-OLD SON DIES AS CEMENT BENCH COLLAPSES ON HIM

Megha Sood
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MUMBAI : An eight-year-old boy, Rajveer Kale, died on Wednesday after a concrete bench collapsed on him at Vanrai police quarters. His mother is a constable attached to Dindoshi police station. The incident occurred while Kale and other children were playing on the bench, whose legs had reportedly weakened over time. The slab suddenly collapsed, causing the boy to suffer fatal injuries. →P3

SALE OF LOOSE SPICE POWDERS BANNED IN MAHA

MUMBAI: The Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has banned the sale of loose powdered spices across the state, directing that all such products be packed and sealed at their production premises to prevent contamination and ensure traceability.

An order issued on Thursday covers manufacturers, traders, e-commerce platforms, hotels and caterers dealing in commonly used spices. Misleading claims about purity, organic production or health benefits could attract penalties of up to ₹10 lakh, the order said. →P3

Markets log best day in 4 months, rise 2%

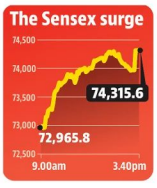
MUMBAI : Indian equity benchmarks posted their biggest single-day gain in four months on Thursday, bucking a global sell-off in stocks as domestic buying and a rush by traders to reverse their bets against the market fuelled the rally. Experts, however, do not see the uptrend sustaining as foreign funds continue to pull money out.

The Nifty 50 rose 1.66% to 22,997.35 and the BSE Sensex added 2.11% to 74,315.61.

Heavyweights ICICI Bank, Reliance Industries Ltd, HDFC Bank and Bharti Airtel buoyed the index. Domestic institutional investors (DIIs) net bought shares worth ₹3,319 crore, while foreign institutional investors (FIIs) net sold shares worth ₹5,285 crore. However, the FIIs, on a gross basis, bought shares worth ₹12,735 crore on Thursday.

While heavyweight stocks rose, the Nifty Smallcap 250 index fell 1.01% and Nifty Midcap 150 fell 0.8%. →P15

→SEBI REVISES CAS FRAMEWORK, P15



SC STRIKES DOWN YES BANK'S ₹8.4K-CR BOND WRITE-OFF, SHARES DROP 14.5%

MUMBAI : The Supreme Court on Thursday dealt a blow to Yes Bank by overturning the permanent write down of its riskier bonds during a government-backed rescue in 2020, raising the prospect of fresh liabilities for the private lender. Shares of the bank slumped 14.5%.

The bonds, known as Additional Tier 1 securities, were written off as part of a restructuring overseen by the Reserve Bank of India in March 2020. The move, the first of its kind in India, wiped out about ₹8,400 crore of bonds held by investors. The ruling could have consequences beyond Yes Bank, raising questions about the legal authority to impose losses on bondholders during bank rescues. →P15

J&K records season's first snowfall

A paramilitary soldier stands guard after the season's first snowfall near Zojila pass on Thursday. The upper reaches of Doda district, Gurez Valley and the Pir Panjal range were blanketed by snow, bringing down temperatures across the region. Travellers have been advised to follow official weather and traffic advisories. WASEEM ANDRABI/HT PHOTO

STATE GOVT FIXES NURSERY ADMISSION AGE AT MINIMUM 3 YRS

Niraj Pandit and Faisal Malik
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MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government has announced a new age-based school admission policy to be implemented in phases, mandating a minimum age of 3 years for admission to nursery from the 2027-28 academic year

The new age cut-offs will be implemented in phases for higher classes – children must be at least 4 years old for admission to Junior KG from 2028-29; 5 years old for Senior KG from 2029-30; and 6 years old for admission to Class 1 from 2030-31.

Under the new rules, June 30 will be the cut-off date to determine age eligibility for students, the state school education department said on Thursday. The move aims to bring uni-

continued on →13

CONGRESS SEEKS WHITE PAPER AS BMC'S FIXED DEPOSITS DIP

Linah Baliga
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MUMBAI: The BMC's fixed deposits have declined by nearly ₹13,785 crore, from approximately ₹91,690 crore in 2021 to ₹77,905 crore, raising concerns over its financial sustainability and ability to meet infrastructure commitments. On Thursday, Congress group leader Ashraf Azmi sought a comprehensive white paper from municipal commissioner Ashwini Bhide, detailing the civic body's finances from 2021-22 to September 2026. Azmi also flagged a ₹3,544 crore decline in FDs over the last eight months. →P7

HC: Ban on fireworks on the roads to apply throughout the year

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MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Thursday extended its ban on bursting firecrackers on streets, making a restriction first imposed during Ganeshotsav in September applicable throughout the year. The court cited the harmful effects of toxic pollution, particularly on children and senior citizens, and called for stricter enforcement by state authorities. "We all are bound by the Constitution, and the rights of citizens are paramount," the court said. The order came during a suo motu hearing on noise pollution caused by religious processions in Mumbai and other cities in the state.

THE ORDER WAS FIRST IMPOSED DURING THE GANESH FESTIVAL IN SEPTEMBER

On September 22, the court had directed the state government and Mumbai Police to enforce decibel limits during processions and take action against violators. →P8

CENTRE DIRECTS TELCOS TO SHOW CALLER NAMES FROM NOVEMBER 1

Sejal Sharma
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NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has directed all telecom operators to display the caller's name, not just the number, on the receiver's phone screen starting November 1. The October 13 directive on the calling name presentation service (CNAP) applies to all operators holding a licence or authorisation to provide access services across all service areas. →P1XX

Can the AIUDF inflict more pain on Congress in Assam?

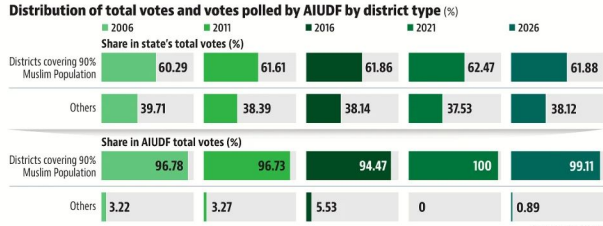
By Roshan Kishore and Nishant Ranjan

The results of the recently held Nagaon parliamentary constituency (PC) bypoll in Assam suggest more trouble for the already troubled Congress party in the state. The Congress won the Nagaon PC with a 50% vote share in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. Its MP, Pradyut Bordoloi, left the Congress to join the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) just before the 2026 assembly elections, which triggered the bypoll. Not only did the Congress lose the bypoll, it did so very badly, managing to get just 8.9% of the votes polled. The runner-up, Badruddin Ajmal from the All-India United Democratic Front (AIUDF), managed to get 39.3% of the votes. The AIUDF's political resurrection in these elections poses a grim question for the Congress. Here are three charts which explain this in detail.

1 AIUDF's primary support base is among Muslim voters

According to the 2011 census, Muslims accounted for 34.2% of Assam's population, the highest among Indian states. Within the state, the Muslim population is pretty skewed, with just 14 out of Assam's 27 Census 2011 districts accounting for 90% of the state's Muslims. The AIUDF contested its first assembly election in 2006 and registered its best performance in 2011 when it won 18 out of the state's 126 assembly constituencies (ACs). If one were to divide the state into two parts dividing 90% and 10% of the state's Muslim population, at least 92.3% of the AIUDF's MLAS and 94.5% of its vote share in every assembly election between 2006 and 2016 came from the former. In 2021, even when the AIUDF had an alliance with the Congress, all of its MLAs came from the Muslim-dominated districts. However, its graph fell really badly even in the Muslim-majority districts in the 2024 and 2026 Lok Sabha and assembly elections.

Distribution of total votes and votes polled by AIUDF by district type (%)



Source: ECI & TCPD-IED

2 The 2021 Congress-AIUDF alliance marked a recent peak of Muslim representation in Assam assembly

HT's historical database of the religious composition of the Assam assembly shows that the state's highest share of Muslim MLAs was in the 1983 elections when 33 Muslim MLAs were elected in an assembly of 126. This number fell sharply to 24 by the 1991 election and remained constant until 2006, the first election when the AIUDF contested. The number increased once again to 31 by 2021, when the Congress and the AIUDF formed an alliance. The 2026 election, which saw the Congress and the AIUDF contest separately and also a delimitation of AC boundaries, saw the number of Muslim MLAs fall to 22, the lowest since 1972. The 2026 results were also marked by the share of Congress among Muslim MLAs reaching its highest since 1972, while that of the AIUDF fell to its lowest since 2006.

Party-wise number of Muslim MLAs elected in the assembly elections in Assam

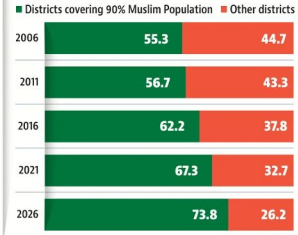
Source: HT Muslim MLAs database

3 What has changed between 1972 and 2026 for the Congress is its marginalisation among non-Muslim voters

In the last three assembly elections (2016, 2021, and 2026), the share of Muslim MLAs in the Congress's total MLAs has always been greater than 50%– it was 57.7%, 55.2%, and 94.7%. Between 1972 and 2006, this number was never above 32.3% (which happened in the 1996 assembly elections). Between 2006 and 2026, the share of Congress votes coming from the 13 districts with just 10% of the total state Muslim population has been declining. It was 44.7% in 2006, came down to 37.7% in 2016 and dropped to a historic low of 26.3% in the 2026 assembly elections. In the 2006 assembly elections, out of 53 ACs it won, it won 26 from the districts with 10% of the total Muslim population. In the 2026 elections, it managed to win just one AC from these districts. If the Congress were to lose substantial support even among Muslims, it could suffer further marginalisation in a state it ruled for decades.

Distribution of votes polled by Congress by district type (%)

Congress vote share in 13 Census 2011 districts with around 10% of the state total Muslim population has been declining in each election since 2006.



Source: ECI & TCPD-IED

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EC offers SSR lifeline amid furore over SIR

Himanshi Dahiya
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NEW DELHI: The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday ordered a special summary revision of electoral rolls in 17 states and Union territories, the first such exercise in nearly two years that is expected to not only help Gen Z and first-time voters but also those deleted by the controversial special intensive revision.

The SSR – which will be conducted between November 2 and December 28, with the final roll published on January 4, 2027 – will also provide political parties with machine-readable PDFs of the draft and final electoral roll, fulfilling a longstanding demand of opposition parties. This was part of a slew of changes announced by ECI to SSR, which also included greater sharing of data on additions, deletions and modifications to the roll.

Among the 17 regions where SSR will be conducted are all five states where assembly elections are scheduled early next year.

"The commission has issued instructions dated 29.09.2026 to undertake a special drive for the enrolment of left out/young/first time eligible electors. Now, in order to facilitate the enrolment of eligible electors with reference to the qualifying date of 1st January, 2027 along with seeking advance applications for the three subsequent qualifying dates of 1st April, 1st July & 1st October, 2027, the commission hereby directs that the existing electoral rolls shall be revised by conducting a Special Summary Revision (SSR)," ECI said in a let-

continued on →13

Amid CEC row, SC serves notices to...

EC and three election commissioners

On a plea by LoP in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and 12 other INDIA bloc leaders seeking an independent, time-bound inquiry into alleged electoral irregularities and the poll panel's functioning.

Oppn leaders have sought an inquiry into the June 2025 decision to conduct the SIR, and an interim suspension of the ongoing revision pending the inquiry.

Union govt and Delhi Police

On a plea seeking a framework for protests and processions in the vicinity of SC and other judicial complexes in the wake of Oppn's Oct 12 march.

Plea also seeks criminal contempt proceedings against Oppn leaders. However, SC said it was not initiating contempt proceedings at this stage.

Sanjay Raut, Shiv Sena (UBT) MP

Over his remarks against CJI Surya Kant after he declined to meet Oppn leaders seeking to raise concerns over EC's functioning. Court said that it would examine the issue after hearing his explanation.

Personnel deployed at the inner circle in Connaught Place on Thursday, a day ahead of CJP's planned march. Close to 32,000 security personnel are likely to be deployed across Delhi on Friday. SANJEEV VERMA/HT

Contempt plea filed in SC against Sanjay Raut for remarks against CJI

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NEW DELHI: A criminal contempt petition was filed on Thursday in the Supreme Court against Shiv Sena (UBT) lawmaker Sanjay Raut and journalist Nikhil Wagle for making derogatory remarks against Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on social media earlier this week after he turned down a request to meet Opposition leaders. The petition was filed by Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) through its president and senior advocate Pradeep Kumar Rai.

Sanjay Raut

The petition states that soon after CJI conveyed to Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Rajya Sabha Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge on Sunday refusing to meet the political leaders citing "separation of powers" and the issues regarding Election Commission and Delhi protests which are "sub-judice", Wagle made a derogatory post.

Besides the remarks, Raut further posted a video alleging that judges attend political programmed of the ruling party and accept dinner invites hosted by chief ministers.

The SCBA said that the "deliberate and intentional statements" made by Raut are false. The petition states that the false statements were knowingly made to "scandalise and diminish the authority of the Supreme Court".

Can't claim backwardness quota after conversion: SC

Abraham Thomas
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NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday said that a person belonging to a backward Hindu social order will lose their community status and accompanying benefits of reservation upon conversion to Islam or Christianity, holding that conversion was to a religion and not to the membership of a historically backward community within that religion.

The judgment upheld the decision of the Madras high court, which struck down a Tamil Nadu government order allowing a Hindu backward man who converts to Islam to retain his backward tag by getting a community certificate of any one of the seven notified Muslim backward communities in the state.

"A person who converts from a Hindu social order to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim affirmative action under Article 16(4) of the Constitution merely on the basis of the social backwardness associated with his

continued on →13

Conversion to Islam, Christianity in focus

"A person who converts from a Hindu social order to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim affirmative action... merely on the basis of the social backwardness associated with his pre-conversion status."
— SUPREME COURT

Days after protest, Imran Khan told to leave India

Vinay Dalvi and Mayura Janwalkar
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MUMBAI: Actor Imran Khan has been directed to leave India by October 28 by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO), Mumbai, four days after he participated in demonstrations outside August Kranti Maidan demanding the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Born in Wisconsin, US, in 1983, Imran holds Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) status under the Citizenship Act, 1955, which entitles him to a lifelong, multiple-entry Indian visa.

Police said the action followed a complaint by BJP leader Kirit Somaiya, who sought action against Khan for allegedly participating in political activities despite being a foreign national.

Imran Khan was detained along with other protesters at August Kranti Maidan during the CJP-led protest on Sunday. RAJU SHINDE

The notice, issued on October 14, cites Sections 7 and 29 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025. Section 29 allows the government to order a foreign national to leave India for violating the Act or its rules, or if an adverse security report is received. Khan's lawyer said the actor will challenge the notice in the Bombay High Court.

→P4

ACTIVIST MURDER: OLD RIVALRY SUSPECTED AS MOTIVE; 3 HELD

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THANE: Police have arrested three men - Avinash Naidu, Noor Alam Khan and Vijay Puran Singh - for the murder of social activist Harish Gajwani on Wednesday, allegedly over an old feud.

According to police, Naidu shot Gajwani twice outside Ulhasnagar station, while Khan and Singh attacked him with sharp weapons.

Police suspect Naidu sought revenge for a 2021 fight in which he suffered serious abdominal injuries and his friend was killed. Gajwani and his associate, Naresh Lefty, were arrested in connection with that case. "He (Naidu) still bleeds and suffers pain because of it, which is why he wanted to take revenge," a police officer said.

→P10

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PAGE ONE PLUS

{ MY INDIA } 'BIG ITEMS ARE DONE'

Gor: India, US close to landing trade deal

The US and India are close to finalizing a trade deal, with most of the major issues resolved, US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor said on Thursday, echoing comments from senior Indian officials earlier this week. "The big picture, the big framework, the big items are done, Gor said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum. The two countries are very close to "landing it," he added. The major issues had been resolved, while some of the remaining hurdles involved new matters that emerged as negotiations progressed, including changes in technology. "The big items are done," he said, adding that new issues arising during lengthy talks were natural. His comments underscore the optimism earlier this week by EAM S Jaishankar who said he was encouraged by progress in trade talks between India and the US, and that the two sides were "heading toward a landing point" after over a year of negotiations. BLOOMBERG

{ MY INDIA } SHOWERS IN SOUTH INDIA

Monsoon withdraws from entire country

The southwest monsoon withdrew from the entire country on Thursday, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said, adding that northeast monsoon rains had commenced over the southern parts of the country on the same day, bringing showers to Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala and Karnataka. While the IMD records the southwest monsoon season from June 1 to September 30, rains continue until October 15 in parts of the country, with the latter being the normal date for withdrawal from the entire country, as per the long period average (LPA). The northeast monsoon only impacts southern India, with rains continuing into December. The IMD said a number of weather systems were already at play in southern India, contributing to rainfall in the region. HTC

{ WORLD } PESHAWAR

34 children, teacher killed in Pak school roof collapse

At least 34 schoolchildren and a female teacher were killed on Thursday when the roof of a school collapsed during morning classes in Pakistan's Peshawar, police and rescue officials said. As panicked parents and relatives thronged the school site to search for their loved ones, rescue workers spent hours pulling children from the rubble of the privately run Al-Khair Education Center. Most of the victims were under 13. At least 45 children suffered injuries, ranging from minor wounds to severe trauma, said Arif Khattak, regional director of the Rescue Department. A higher-floor roof collapsed onto classrooms below, crumpling two storeys of the building, a rescue official said."The fatalities include 12 girl students and a female teacher," Lady Reading Hospital spokesperson Mohammad Asim said. Three children remained in critical condition with head injuries, while most of the injured taken to the hospital had been treated and discharged, he added. REUTERS

{ MY MUMBAI } MAHESH TINAIKAR

Indus Creed founder, guitarist dies aged 62

Mahesh Tinaikar, co-founder of the homegrown rock-n-roll band Indus Creed, died aged 62 on Thursday. Tinaikar was the guitarist of the band that gained a cult following in the 1980s and 1990s with their brand of original melodic pop rock ensconced in heavy bass and drums. He will be cremated in Mumbai on Friday at 10am. Indus Creed, first called Rock Machine when Tinaikar co-founded it with bassist Mark Selwyn in 1984, was one of few India-based rock bands that first rode the wave of satellite or cable television, as music channels broadcast Western pop and rock music in India. The band cut albums with record labels, made music videos and even toured internationally in several West Asian countries, Los Angeles in the United States, the United Kingdom and the Soviet Union. →P8

{ WORLD } AFTER BACKLASH

Trump scraps plan to livestream execution

President Donald Trump said Thursday that the Pentagon will no longer livestream the firing squad execution of Fort Hood shooter Nidal Malik Hasan, after the announcement faced bipartisan criticism and Vice President JD Vance said he wouldn't watch it. Trump said on social media that publicly airing the execution "might have been a strong deterrent for the World to witness how America deals with Terrorists and SCUM like Hasan."But, he continued, "any very good and well meaning people would rather not watch him die, through streaming, or through any other visual device."The Pentagon has said Hasan's execution is scheduled for December 3. The announcement earlier this month from defence secretary Hegseth that Hasan's execution would be public -- and confirmation from the Pentagon that it would be livestreamed -- prompted significant blowback from both Republicans and Democrats. AP

'Mother Of All Bombs' in US plans for Iran

US military has drawn up plans to use its largest non-nuclear bomb against Iranian energy infra and nuclear sites if Trump orders a resumption of combat, according to reports

THE MIGHT OF THE MOAB

The GBU-43/B Massive Ordnance Air Blast (MOAB) bomb, better known by its nickname the "Mother Of All Bombs," is an air-blast weapon that explodes before hitting the ground, spreading the blast outwards. Developed during the Iraq War, it was conceived partly as a psychological weapon to intimidate the enemy by targeting large formations of troops and above-ground bunkers.

WHEN WAS IT FIRST USED?

MOAB was first deployed in combat in 2017, in a US airstrike against an Islamic State-Khorasan Province tunnel complex in Afghanistan, killing 96 IS-KP terrorists, including four commanders. Originally intended for use against large troop formations, the bomb's potential targets have expanded to include caves and tunnels beneath srufaces.

CAN IT PENETRATE IRAN'S NUCLEAR SITES?

Military planners have included MOAB in options targeting Iranian nuclear facilities, including Pickaxe Mountain, where the US and Israel believe components of Iran's nuclear programme are stored. However, its effectiveness against deeply buried sites remains uncertain, according to reports. The weapon is not designed for deep penetration, and Pickaxe Mountain is believed to be protected by layers of granite. Its blast radius also raises concerns about civilian casualties.

MOAB detonates during a test at Eglain Air Force Base, Florida, on November 21, 2003 GETTY IMAGES

WHY IS ITS USE BEING CONSIDERED?

Diplomatic efforts to resolve the West Asia conflict have stalled, with no clear indication of an imminent agreement. Trump faces pressure to end the war as Republicans prepare for November's midterm elections. Media reports citing people familiar with the matter said the administration is exploring options for a decisive-looking strike that could allow it to declare victory and withdraw US forces.

Many threats, only 1 traced: School hoax hunt flounders

Hemani Bhandari, Jignasa Sinha and Gargi Shukla
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NEW DELHI: Over two years and hundreds of hoax bomb threats to schools later, Delhi Police have cracked just one case, and experts, principals and parents are losing patience with a force that has yet to find an answer.

The latest threats came on Thursday morning, when at least six Delhi schools, including The British School, Mount Carmel, and Ahlcon Public School received emails warning of bombs on their premises. Bomb squads searched the schools after the emails came in around 9am, and the threats were declared a hoax — the same drill Delhi's schools have been through hundreds of times in two years, with only one hoax perpetrator ever caught.

Experts and parents now want police to stop treating each email as a separate incident and build a system to trace repeat senders, and want schools given a common procedure that ends the routine of full evacuations every time a threat comes in.

To be sure, such problems have existed before 2024 but people aware of the matter say it has ballooned particularly over the last two years. The police finally set up a dedicated cell only in May this year, and have limited their advice to schools to verbal requests for more guards and daily email checks.

"Bomb hoaxes are far from harmless pranks," said Namita Singhal, principal of Venkateshwar Global School in Rohini. "They require authorities to be called in, and the subsequent security checks and inspections consume several hours of the school day."

Hard to trace

Officials cite technical and legal obstacles that make senders hard to trace. About 99% of the emails trace to IP addresses outside India, one official said on condition of anonymity, and requests to foreign companies for user details mostly go unanswered.

"The main struggle is the legal procedure of MLAT and LR," an officer with the Intelligence Fusion and Strategic Operations (IFSO) unit said, referring to requests (under a mutual legal assistance treaty) and letters rogatory sent to foreign countries through the courts.

A Delhi Police investigator on one such case, who asked not to be named, said most senders route their traffic through virtual private networks (VPNs), the Tor anonymity network or proxy servers abroad, and almost never use an Indian internet provider. Even when police trace a VPN address a step further, it can lead to thousands of users with identical traffic.

Cases that went cold

The Russia-linked emails of 2024 show how such cases stall. Threats to more than 250 Delhi schools in April that year came from IDs resembling those used that January, "swarim" and "swareem," on a Russian domain, and police traced both to the same person, based in Russia, but could not make an arrest.

Foreign companies either say they keep no logs or do not respond because they do not treat a hoax as serious, a second officer said. When details are shared, it takes three to six months, and countries with and without treaties with India have responded alike.

Investigators said a 2022 directive from CERT-In, India's cybersecurity agency, requiring VPN companies to keep user logs made matters worse, as companies with servers or offices in India shut them and moved abroad.

Email accounts are easy to create, as privacy-focused providers such as Proton and Tuta often skip phone verification. Some threats have come from hacked accounts belonging to real people, police said.

Cracked by luck

Till now, Delhi Police has cracked only one case. In January 2025, south district police zeroed in on a 17-year-old Class 12 student who, investigators said, had sent mass emails, mostly to south Delhi schools, on at least 10 to 12 occasions between July 2024 and January 2025, timed around exams or weekends.

"We were checking for the IP address each time but the sender was using a VPN. There was no way of finding who the sender was," the investigating officer said.

In early January, a weakness tied to the free VPN the boy was using gave investigators a pool of shared addresses, which they narrowed down to two.

"It also required us to see other factors like the fact that the mails were to south Delhi schools and that they were being sent around exams and weekends ," the officer said. Investigators finally identified the boy, who lived and studied in south Delhi.

Elsewhere too, it was only a single slip that worked. In June 2025, Gujarat Police arrested Rene Joshilda, a Chennai-based engineer behind over more than 21 bomb threats across 11 states; she used VPNs and virtual numbers from an app called Get-Code, but police said she was traced because she had once logged into her real and fake email accounts from the same device.

Stretched thin

Both breakthroughs depended on mistakes by the senders: a free VPN in one case, a careless login in the other. Police estimate more than half the emails are sent by students, with the rest coming from groups abroad.

"It's all mischief but people plan and do it," the officer said.

The cell formed in May has six officials under an assistant commissioner who reports to the deputy commissioner of IFSO, Delhi Police's cybercrime wing, but it too juggles cases of other nature.

"We can't have a dedicated team since there are other fraud cases, OTP scams, Chinese app scams, hacking cases and organised scams," the officer said, adding that IFSO reported about 4,000 cases last year involving losses of ₹850 crore.

Schools left to cope

Nor is there a common procedure that would spare schools a full evacuation and sweep each time. Schools have drawn up their own protocols, and every email, however familiar its wording, still sets off the same response, with children sent home or moved to an open ground and bomb disposal and dog squads searching the premises.

Parents, many of them working professionals, have to leave work to collect their children, while schools arrange buses to take other students home, Singhal said.

Tania Joshi, principal of The Indian School in south Delhi, said the threats have become so frequent that most schools have devised their own methods to keep disruption to a minimum. Her school's protocol involves informing government authorities and parents promptly and evacuating students safely.

"The entire school community is constantly on alert mode due to the frequency of these threats," Joshi said. "However, the fear that the 'cry wolf' scenario could one day become real continues to persist."

Rajan Bhagat, a former deputy commissioner of Delhi Police, said the failure cannot be pinned on VPNs or foreign email services alone. The real gap, he said, is that police do not quickly connect evidence across cases, from email headers and account records to intelligence from earlier incidents.

He called for centralised data and immediate preservation of electronic evidence, so that police can identify common infrastructure behind cases that appear unrelated. "Policy must now shift from incident-by-incident investigation to a permanent, intelligence-led bomb-threat attribution system," Bhagat said.

How others do it

Other countries have mechanisms to limit disruption when obvious hoaxes come in: UK guidance for schools and public venues assumes most bomb threats are hoaxes, and lets those in charge evacuate, move people to safer areas inside, search, or take no visible action. Some US school districts let the principal order a quiet search without dismissing classes if a threat is judged a hoax, keeping police and evacuation for threats that appear genuine.

International cooperation has caught at least one prolific sender: Michael Kadar, a US-Israeli teenager accused of around 2,000 bomb threats worldwide, was arrested in Israel in 2017 after a joint operation by the FBI, Israeli authorities and police in New Zealand, Australia and Europe.

New Zealand police traced one of his first threats to an Israeli IP address, and investigators narrowed it to his apartment in Ashkelon, which was rigged to a large antenna that let him use distant wireless networks.

UNSOLVED PROBLEM

Two years of hoax bomb emails to Delhi schools, and just one case cracked

120+ CASES REGISTERED SINCE 2024 | **1** CASE CRACKED | **99%** EMAILS TRACED TO IP ADDRESSES OUTSIDE INDIA

WHY THE TRAIL GOES COLD

Senders of such threat mails typically hide behind VPNs

VPN services route traffic through overseas servers

Foreign providers say they keep no logs, or don't reply

Treaty requests take months and rarely yield results

A security sweep is conducted outside Sardar Patel Vidyalaya after the school received a bomb threat, on September 15, 2026. Sonu Mehta/HT

CALLS FOR CHANGE

"Policy must now shift from incident-by-incident investigation to a permanent, intelligence-led bomb-threat attribution system." — **RAJAN BHAGAT,** former deputy commissioner, Delhi Police

"Bomb hoaxes are far from harmless pranks. They require authorities to be called in, and the security checks and inspections consume several hours of school day" — **NAMITA SINGHAL,** principal, Venkateshwar Global School

THE ONE THAT WAS CRACKED

January 2025: A 17-year-old south Delhi student who sent mass emails on 10–12 occasions, timed around exams. A weakness in his free VPN gave police a lead; patterns in the emails did the rest.

HOW OTHERS COPE

UK: Guidance assumes most threats are hoaxes; schools can search in place instead of evacuating

US: Some school districts run a quiet search and keep classes going unless a threat looks credible

Women can be charged with gang rape for aiding crime: HC

Shruti Kakkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court has held that a woman can be charged with gang rape even if she did not personally commit the act of rape, provided she acted in furtherance of a common intention to have the offence committed.

Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani observed that there was no rationale for interpreting the phrase "one or more persons constituting a group" in the provision on gang rape as referring exclusively to men. The term "persons", the court said, must be interpreted in a gender-neutral manner.

The court, however, clarified that a woman cannot be charged with gang rape acting alone, as this would not conform to the statutory definition of rape under Section 375 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) and Section 63 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

The court made the observations while dismissing a petition filed by a woman challenging a trial court order framing charges against her under provisions of the BNS and the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (Pocso) Act in a case involving the alleged sexual assault of her minor daughter.

"...For purposes of the offence of gang rape it is not necessary that a person acting in furtherance of a common intention must also be amongst the persons who physically commit the offence of rape," the court said.

"For instance, a woman who may not be part of the group of persons who commit the physical offence of rape may yet have acted in furtherance of a common intention to have rape committed upon the victim," it added. The court said there was no basis to hold that a woman could not be charged with gang rape under Section 376D of the IPC or Section 70 of the BNS. It added that the law did not restrict the offence to a group comprising only men.

> THE DELHI HC SAID THAT THE LAW DOESN'T RESTRICT THE OFFENCE TO A GROUP COMPRISING ONLY MEN

The case arose from an FIR filed by the woman in July 2024, alleging that her daughter had been kidnapped. The minor alleged her mother had threatened that the accused would kill her if she refused to have sexual relations with him, forced her into such relations and was present during the sexual assault.

The trial court, on January 17, 2025, framed charges against the woman under Sections 70(2) (gang rape of a woman under 18 years of age), 351(3) (criminal intimidation) and 64(2)(m) (aggravated rape) of BNS, as well as Section 6 of Pocso Act. Challenging the order, the woman argued that only a man could commit rape and that gang rape could therefore be committed only by a group of men.

PICK OF THE DAY

MY MUMBAI

Child dies as bench topples at police quarters

The top portion of the bench got detached from the base and toppled over, trapping the 8-year-old beneath, says witness

Megha Sood
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Local residents rushed the injured Rajveer Kale (left) to the Jogeshwari Trauma Centre, where he succumbed to his injuries.

MUMBAI: The eight-year-old son of a woman police constable attached to Dindoshi police station died on Wednesday after a concrete bench at Vanrai police quarters collapsed, trapping him beneath. The incident occurred around 9.30pm, when the boy, Rajveer Khanderao Kale, was playing in the area along with other children, said senior police inspector at Vanrai police station, Abdul Rauf Shaikh.

"The bench was shaky as its legs had been damaged over time. A few kids including the deceased were jumping on the bench while playing, when the cement slab then suddenly collapsed," he said. Kale too fell off when the slab collapsed and was seriously injured, Shaikh noted.

A resident of the police colony who witnessed the incident said the top portion of the bench, which was cemented to the two legs, had become loose.

"On Wednesday night, when some kids were jumping on it, it toppled over and fell on Kale, leaving him with serious head injuries," the witness said, requesting not to be identified.

Local residents rushed the injured boy to the Jogeshwari Trauma Centre where he succumbed to his injuries late at night on Wednesday.

After the police were informed about the incident, a team reached the spot, conducted a panchnama and registered an accidental death report.

"Though the deceased kid's parents have not filed a complaint, we are investigating the case regardless, trying to find out who was responsible for maintaining the bench," said Shaikh.

Investigators were recording the statements of witnesses to the incident and probing what led to the collapse of the bench, which had been installed there by a nonprofit.

FDA bans sale of loose spice powders across Maharashtra

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The order covers all commonly used spice powders. SHUTTERSTOCK

MUMBAI: The Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has banned the sale of loose spice powders across Maharashtra and mandated that powdered spices must be packed and sealed wherever they are produced to prevent contamination and ensure traceability.

A compliance order to this effect was issued on Thursday, covering manufacturers, traders, wholesalers, retailers, e-commerce outlets, hotels, caterers and institutional kitchens that produce and sell commonly used powdered spices such as turmeric, chilli, coriander, cumin, black pepper, cinnamon, cloves, cardamom, asafoetida, saffron, garam masala and curry leaves.

According to the order, only entities which have valid a license/registration will be allowed to deal with spices while food handlers will have to follow hygiene requirements after undergoing training. Sealed packets of powdered spices must bear details such as ingredients, manufacturer information, licence and batch numbers, and manufacturing or packing dates. Misleading claims about purity, naturalness, organic production or health benefits could attract penalties up to ₹10 lakh, the order said.

The FDA has prohibited the drying of spices on public roads, tarred surfaces, near drains, garbage bins or cattle sheds. Any adulteration or mixing of spice powders with prohibited colours and substances – such as Metanil Yellow, Rhodamine B, Sudan dyes, Lead Chromate, brick powder, chalk, sawdust and starch – to increase their weight or quantity has also been prohibited and could attract penalties ranging ₹3-10 lakh, the order stated.

The FDA said it will test spices for pesticide residues, aflatoxin, heavy metals and other contaminants as prescribed under applicable standards, and violators could face penalties, seizures, product recalls, licence suspension/ cancellation and legal cases.

Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation

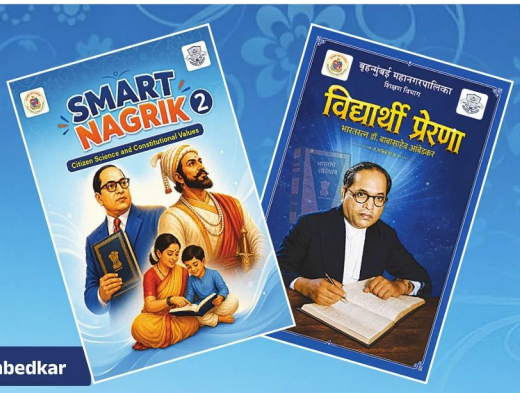
SMART NAGRIK

Syllabus on Citizen Science and Constitutional Values

and

Vidyarthi Prerana

Publication of books based on the life of BharatRatna Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar



Smart Nagrik syllabus inspires student to develop values that shape character and strengthen citizenship

Each lesson encourage students to think critically, make appropriate decisions and understand their responsibilities towards their family, school, society and nation

Chief Guest

Shri. Devendra Fadnavis — Chief Minister, Maharashtra
Shri. Bhushan Gawai — Former Chief Justice of India, Supreme Court

Guest of Honour

Shri. Eknath Shinde — Deputy Chief Minister, Maharashtra; Guardian Minister, Mumbai City District
Smt. Sunetra Ajit Pawar — Deputy Chief Minister, Maharashtra
Shri. Mangalprabhat Lodha — Minister, Skills, Employment, Entrepreneurship & Innovation and Co-Guardian Minister, Mumbai Suburban District
Adv. Ashish Shelar — Minister, Electronics, Information Technology, Artificial Intelligence Department, Cultural Affairs and Guardian Minister, Mumbai Suburban District
Shri. Dadaji Bhuse — Minister School Education Department
Smt. Ritu Tawde — Mayor, Mumbai
Shri. Sanjay Ghadi — Deputy Mayor, Mumbai

Special Presence

Shri. Anil Desai — Local Member of Parliament
Shri. Ameet Satam — Member of Legislative Assembly
Shri. Mahesh Sawant — Member of Legislative Assembly
Shri. Sunil Shinde — Member of Legislative Council
Shri. Rajhans Singh — Member of Legislative Council
Smt. Ashwini Bhide — Municipal Commissioner

Distinguished Guests

Shri. Ganesh Khankar — Leader of The House
Smt. Kishori Pednekar — Leader of Opposition
Shri. Amey Ghole — Shiv Sena Group Leader
Shri. Ashraf Azmi — Indian National Congress Group Leader
Shri. Vijay Ubale — AIMIM Group Leader
Shri. Yashwant Killedar — MNS Group Leader; Chairman, G North Ward Committee & Local Corporator
Smt. Amreen Abrahani — Samajwadi Party Group Leader
Shri. Prabhakar Shinde — Chairman, Standing Committee
Smt. Rajeshree Shirwadkar — Chairperson, Education Committee
Smt. Sandhya Vipul Doshi (Sakre) — Chairperson, Improvement Committee
Smt. Trushna Vishwasrao — Chairperson, BEST Committee
Smt. Yamini Yashwant Jadhav — Chairperson, Works Committee (City)
Smt. Sangeeta Sharma — Chairperson, Works Committee (Suburbs)
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Smt. Diksha Karkar — Chairperson Law, Revenue and General Purpose Committee
Smt. Meenal Turde — Chairperson, Women & Child Welfare Committee
Shri. Ajay Patil — Deputy Chairman, Works Committee (City)
Shri. Suresh Awale — Deputy Chairman, Works Committee (Suburbs)
Shri. Ritesh Rai — Deputy Chairman, Public Health Committee
Shri. Bhaskar Shetty — Deputy Chairman, Market & Garden Committee
Shri. Anish Makwani — Deputy Chairperson Law, Revenue and General Purpose Committee
Smt. Rita Makwana — Deputy Chairperson, Women & Child Welfare Committee

All Corporators and all Nominated Corporators

Cordially invited by : Prajakta Varma - Lavangare, Additional Municipal Commissioner (City)

Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation(Education Department) | Friday, 16th October 2026 | Time : 3.00 pm. | Venue : Bhavani Shankar Road Mumbai Public School, Dadar (West), Mumbai

PRO/1704/ ADV/26-27

{ STATE APPROVES EXPANSION PLAN }

Siddhivinayak temple to buy bldg for ₹94 cr

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MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government has approved a ₹94.12-crore proposal by the Shree Siddhivinayak Ganpati Mandir Trust to acquire 20 residential and commercial units in the adjoining Ram Mansion Cooperative Housing Society in Prabhadevi. The acquisition was approved to ease crowd management and expand facilities for devotees at one of Mumbai's busiest temples.

The government has authorised the trust to purchase the residential units at ₹66,000 per square foot, calculated on the basis of the existing carpet area, with the price of an additional 40% carpet area thrown in to make the offer tempting. The commercial premises will be acquired at ₹1.11 lakh per square foot. A government resolution to this effect was issued on Thursday by the state law and judiciary department, which controls the temple trust.

Ram Mansion is a three-storey residential building located on a 708 square-metre private plot next to the temple, and its acquisition is part of a ₹100-crore expansion plan of the two-century old temple. The temple trust is also in talks with the Siddhivinayak Cooperative Housing Society, located on the trust's land next to the temple, for acquisition. Together, the two plots measure around 1,800 square meters.

On Thursday, the state law and judiciary department approved the purchase consideration for Ram Mansion at ₹94,11,65,550. This includes stamp duty, registration charges and other incidental expenses that will be paid from the trust's available funds. The government has clarified that the acquisition will not impose any financial burden on the state exchequer.

"The property, located next to the temple's existing waiting hall, is expected to provide much-needed space for managing queues and developing facilities such as a canteen, kitchen, storage area, accommodation for pilgrims and limited parking," states the order.

Ram Mansion is a three-storey residential building located on a 708 square-metre private plot next to the temple HT PHOTO

Built in 1801, the Siddhivinayak Temple is one of Mumbai's most prominent temples. It is known for its unique Ganpati idol with a right-turned trunk. The temple currently faces space constraints, as large numbers of devotees visit it from across the country and abroad. During festivals and other periods of heavy footfall, the trust incurs substantial recurring expenditure on temporary structures and crowd-management arrangements.

"The proposed acquisition is intended to address some of these logistical challenges by expanding the space available for visitor facilities," said a senior law and judiciary official.

The Trust's managing committee had granted in-principle approval for the residential purchase rate at its meeting on March 31, 2025. It subsequently approved the proposed rate for commercial premises at a meeting on July 7, 2025, subject to government clearance.

The decision came over two months after the state government ordered an audit of the Shree Siddhivinayak Temple Trust's accounts for the last five years, following allegations of theft of donations made by devotees at the temple, one of the wealthiest in the country.

2 PVT MEDICAL COLLEGES MOVE HC AGAINST INSTITUTE-LEVEL ADMISSION BAN

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MUMBAI: Two private medical colleges in the state are challenging the Maharashtra government's decision to stop institute-level counselling for medical admissions in the Bombay High Court. On Wednesday, Parbhani Medical College approached the Aurangabad bench, while Vedantaa Institute of Medical Sciences, Palghar, filed a petition before the principal bench of the high court.

Both colleges seek permission to fill seats left vacant after the centralised admission process. The outcome of the petitions is likely to affect the ongoing National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) undergraduate (UG) and postgraduate (PG) admission process in the state.

Confirming the development, MV Thorat, counsel for both colleges, said, "Unaided colleges have the right to admit their own students and fill vacancies. We are appealing to the high court to give us back our rights."

The petitioning colleges argue that the Maharashtra Unaided Private Professional Educational Institutions (Regulation of Admissions and Fees) Act, 2015, does not prohibit institute-level counselling. They also rely on Supreme Court judgments in a similar case.

Institute-level counselling allows colleges to fill vacant MBBS and MD/MS seats on their own after the regular rounds of NEET counselling.

The state government, however, made it mandatory for all admissions, including the final stray vacancy round, to be conducted online through the centralised admission process (CAP) by state Common Entrance Test (CET) cell, following directions from the National Medical Commission (NMC).

The move came amid allegations by medical aspirants and activists that institute-level rounds lack transparency and allow colleges to bypass merit lists, with seats allegedly offered in exchange for large sums of money. Private colleges, however, maintain that institute-level counselling is necessary to ensure that seats do not remain vacant.

Imran Khan to move court challenging FRRO's notice

Police action follows BJP leader Kirit Somaiya's complaint alleging US-born Khan's participation in protest in India

Vinay Dalvi and Mayura Janwalkar
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MUMBAI: Four days after he participated in demonstrations outside the August Kranti Maidan in Mumbai, supporting demands for the ouster of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the America-born actor Imran Khan was asked to leave the country by October 28 by the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO), Mumbai.

Khan was born in 1983 in Wisconsin, USA, to Nuzhat Khan, film star Aamir Khan's cousin, and California-based software engineer Anil Pal. He was granted Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) status under the Citizenship Act, 1955, which allows him a lifelong multiple-entry Indian visa.

Khan has since said that he will challenge the FRRO's notice. His counsel, advocate Parvez Memon, senior partner of MZM Legal, said they are drafting a petition likely to be filed in the Bombay High Court on Friday.

"We are finalising the petition and will file it in the High Court tomorrow (Friday), also attempting to mention the case for an urgent hearing," Memon said, adding that the notice claims he contravened the provisions of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, and the Rules and Orders made thereunder.

Imran Khan's candid selfie from inside the police van, taken after his detention on October 10, went viral, drawing an outpouring of support from fans.

> We are finalising the petition and will file it in the high court tomorrow (Friday), also attempting to mention the case for an urgent hearing
>
> **ADVOCATE PARVEZ MEMON,** counsel of Imran Khan

The notice dated October 14, seen by HT, invokes Sections 7 and 29 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025. The latter empowers the Central Government "to order the removal of a foreigner from India for contravention of any provisions of the Act or any rule or order made thereunder or on receipt of an adverse security report."

Police officials said the action was initiated following a complaint lodged by BJP leader Kirit Somaiya. In his complaint to the police authorities and the FRRO, Somaiya sought action against Khan for participating in political activities in India despite being a foreign national.

What the law says

Legal experts, however, said authorities must cite reasons and allow him a hearing before taking action, abiding by the principles of natural justice.

Advocate Sujay Kantawala, who has handled several cases under the Citizenship Act, said a person holding OCI can only be asked to leave the country under "exceptional circumstances" with reasons provided in black and white. "The grant of OCI is discretionary but a person can be asked to leave abruptly, like in this case, only if the reasons are serious, such as an act endangering the country or if that person is a threat to security. If it has been done for participating in a peaceful protest then it's a serious stretch," Kantawala said. "Any action by the state must be backed by a solid reason or the decision would be arbitrary," said advocate Ashwin Thool, who earlier represented Indiaborn US national Nooriya Haveliwala in a 2010 drunken driving incident where she was convicted for mowing down two persons, including a policeman, at Marine Lines. He also said the police should give Khan a hearing in this case or seek a written reply.

Thool said OCI is, in fact, like an extended visa. "Any foreigner in India is under certain conditions which include not participating in any illegal activities and abiding by Indian laws. If the protest was held without the requisite permission, the police may consider it illegal. In that case, he may have to offer an explanation for participating in the protest. Now, whether the police were right in doing that is up to the court to decide. It's a matter of perception whether his (Khan) action was malafide or bonafide," said Thool.

The Mumbai protest

On October 10, Khan participated in protests organised by Mahatma Gandhi's great-grandson Tushar Gandhi, through his non-profit - Hum Bharat Ke Log – supporting the CJP campaign demanding the resignation of the CEC, in New Delhi.

As the demonstrations proceeded without prior police permission, hundreds of protestors gathered at August Kranti Maidan on October 10, including Gandhi, Khan, his partner Lekha Washington, Nuzhat and Imran's cousin Zayn Marie were detained by the local police.

Before being detained, Khan told media persons: "I am here as a citizen, to see why freedom of movement has been restricted and why people's voices are being oppressed."

Khan made his Bollywood debut in 2008 with 'Jaane Tu...Ya Jaane Na' which was a commercial success. Other rom-coms such as 'I Hate Luv Storys', 'Mere Brother ki Dulhan' and 'Ek Main Aur Ekk Tu' followed, and his attempt to enhance his equity as an actor was successful with the critically acclaimed action comedy thriller 'Delhi Belly' in 2011. However, work subsequently trickled down and he took a long hiatus from the film industry. He shares co-custody of his daughter with his ex-wife Avantika Malik.

SC JUNKS PLEAS SEEKING ADMIN FOR LILAVATI TRUST

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MUMBAI: The Supreme Court on Thursday dismissed two petitions seeking the appointment of an administrator to manage the affairs of the trust that runs the premier Lilavati Hospital, declining to intervene in a bitter dispute between rival factions of the Mehta family.

A bench of justices MM Sundresh and Prasanna B Varale allowed one of the petitioners, former trustee Rajesh Mehta, to withdraw his plea and approach the joint charity commissioner for interim relief.

The Lilavati Kirtilal Mehta Medical Trust (LKMMT) is currently headed by chairperson Charu Mehta, along with her sons Prashant and Rajiv Mehta, who are permanent trustees. The two petitioners are also members of the Mehta family.

The petitions challenged the Bombay High Court's order passed on September 24, dismissing Niket Mehta's plea before the joint charity commissioner, seeking the removal of the existing trustees.

In Rajesh Mehta's case, the high court had directed the joint charity commissioner to decide his petition seeking the removal of the current trustees within four months.

Rajesh moved the Supreme Court on September 26, claiming that the high court had erroneously dismissed his petition.

Pune woman seeking abortion moves SC against HC's 'restrictive' approach

Mayura Janwalkar
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MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court had taken a restrictive approach of the rules under the Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act, 1971, without addressing constitutional principles governing reproductive autonomy and risks to a pregnant woman's mental health. This was stated by the 33-year-old Pune engineer seeking an abortion in her petition filed before the Supreme Court, which is expected to hear the plea on Friday.

Past the 24th week of pregnancy, the woman had alleged that her husband had cheated her by concealing his first marriage. She also stated that she did not wish to bear the child of a bigamist who had also mentally and physically harassed her.

The woman is challenging the October 6 order of a division bench of the high court, which had refused to allow her case to be referred to a medical board constituted under the MTP Act, to seek their view on termination of her pregnancy.

In her plea, she said she had found out that she was 13 weeks pregnant on July 26 and had moved court in August. However, her case was placed before the judges for hearing only early this month. With each passing day, her pregnancy was becoming more untenable, she had told HT earlier.

Between trauma and legal delay, a woman's fight to end her pregnancy

Oct 14, 2026: HT report on the woman's fight to end her pregnancy as the HC refused to grant her relief under the MTP Act.

She stated that she sought an examination by a medical board under the MTP Act and not unconditional permission to terminate her pregnancy. She said she evidently does not fall under any of the seven categories covered by rules framed under MTP for women eligible for termination of pregnancy up to the 24th week.

These include minors, rape victims, women with changed marital status – widows and divorcees, and women with foetal abnormalities.

"The solitary submission of the petitioner is that the mental trauma suffered by her on account of the deception... by her husband, arising out of the alleged discovery of fraud played by him is grave enough to attract the provisions of the MTP Act," states her petition filed through her lawyers Narayan Mishra and Shantanu Krishna.

The woman, who quit her job in an IT firm two months ago, had earlier told HT, "The law won't let me terminate my pregnancy at this stage. Bringing this child into the world is going to be very hard. I am not prepared to be a single parent. I don't know what to do."

Her petition before the Supreme Court added, "The Petitioner does not contend that the allegations of fraud, by themselves, automatically confer eligibility for termination beyond the statutory limits; rather, the grievance is that the relevant circumstances and their possible bearing upon her mental health ought to have been examined in the manner permitted by law."

The woman also stated that the high court had held that there was no judicial finding regarding the alleged deception by her husband and her claims were in the realm of allegations.

AUTO DRIVER, 51, ELECTROCUTED WHILE PAINTING HOUSE IN VIKHROLI

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MUMBAI: A 51-year-old autorickshaw driver was electrocuted while painting his house in Suryanagar in Vikhroli West, though he had switched off the main electric supply to his house. The police have booked unknown officials of the electricity distribution company, Adani Electricity, after residents complained about leakage of electric current and receiving shocks abruptly on touching walls and iron objects in the locality.

"We have registered a case against unknown officials of Adani Electricity Company under section 106 (causing death by negligence) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023," said a police officer, adding that the FIR was registered following a complainant lodged by Yashwant Boyin, 30, the son of the deceased.

"The complainant stays with his wife and two-year-old daughter and his parents reside in the same locality separately. On Tuesday he was informed by his mother, Sabu, 46, that his father Babu, 51, had fallen unconscious in their house and suffered head injuries," said the police officer.

Babu was taken to the Mahatma Phule Hospital in Tagore Nagar where he was declared dead after which the body was sent to Rajawadi Hospital for post mortem.

Devil is in the details

Artists put finishing touches on effigies of Ravana at Girgaum Chowpatty ahead of Dussehra, when they will be burnt to symbolize the triumph of good over evil. ANSHUMAN POYREKAR/HT PHOTO

Tejas' soft launch into political frame raises prospect of a bigger role

Yogesh Naik
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MUMBAI: The political churn following widespread Gen Z protests has thrown up a slew of new faces in politics and spurred a rethink among mainstream political parties about the next generation of leadership.

In Mumbai, the youngest member of the Thackeray family, Tejas, 31, appears set to take on a large role in public life. Uddhav Thackeray's younger son made his first political appearance on Sunday at Shivaji Park along with his brother Aaditya at the protest against SIR. According to people in the know within the Shiv Sena (UBT) he will be taking on a more prominent political role in the coming months. "Sunday was also the first day of the Navratri, and an auspicious day for anyone making a new start," said a Sena (UBT) leader about the timing of Tejas's political foray.

The Thackeray family, still grappling with the fallout of the 2022 split engineered by Eknath Shinde, will also be looking at Tejas's entry as a way to further energise the rank and file and bolster their connect with a younger generation of voters. The party has vocally aligned itself with the Cockroach Janata Party and Aaditya Thackeray's strong oratory at the protests in Mumbai has earned him several admirers among the city's youth.

While Aaditya, 36, was launched by Balasaheb Thackeray himself in 2010 when he appointed him as president of the Shiv Sena's Yuva Sena, Tejas--five years his junior—has remained in the background until now. Even as his father and older brother engaged with electoral politics, Tejas, a wildlife researcher, focused on finding and documenting new species of wildlife. When asked about his political ambitions, he said "I am happy where I am" without denying any future plans in active politics.

Sources within the Shiv Sena (UBT) told HT that following the vertical split in the party and Uddhav Thackray's indifferent health, his wife Rashmi has been keen on inducting Tejas into the party fold. Her brother' son Varun Sardesai too is a newly-elected lawmaker from Bandra east, an old Shiv Sena bastion. Raj Thackeray's son Amit Thackeray, 34, too has become publicly active in the recent protests on behalf of the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena. On Sunday, all three new-gen Thackerays addressed protestors and spoke to the media in one voice.

From L to R: Tejas Thackeray made his first political appearance on Sunday at Shivaji Park along with his brother Aaditya Thackeray and cousin Amit Thackeray at a protest against the CEC. RAJU SHINDE/HT

> ACCORDING TO PEOPLE IN THE KNOW WITHIN THE SHIV SENA (UBT), TEJAS THACKERAY WILL BE TAKING ON A MORE PROMINENT POLITICAL ROLE IN THE COMING MONTHS

"We need young people like Tejas, and his entry into politics is welcome," said Sena (UBT) MP and party spokesman Sanjay Raut. He however clarified that Tejas has as yet not begun participating in party meetings.

More than one Shiv Sena (UBT) spoke about his sharpness and ready wit which they said was reminiscent of Balasaheb. Deputy leader Vishakha Raut said, "We welcome his entry in politics, he is sharp and witty and will take the party forward along with his brother. One of them can pull in the masses, and the other brother can handle party affairs; it will be a beneficial arrangement for us."

Another senior party leader, MLC Anil Parab, said, "Sunday's public appearance by Tejas was spontaneous and not preplanned. I don't know whether he will pursue a career in politics but he has a good grasp of politics and is sharply aggressive like his grandfather. While Aaditya Thackeray is already our party leader, perhaps Tejas can emerge as our party's young face."

A friend of the Thackeray family who did not wish to be quoted, told HT: "While Balasaheb Thackeray was a hardliner, Uddhav Thackeray is a much softer version of his father. Aaditya too is similar to him but I think Tejas is closer to his grandfather in his thinking and expression. Though what line he will eventually take remains to be seen." The friend also said that while his appearance at the protest on Sunday was "a soft launch," there is likely to be a formal induction at a proper rally in the near future.

Tejas Thackeray studied at Bombay Scottish and Jai Hind College before setting up the Thackeray Wildlife Foundation in Mumbai. He and his colleagues at the foundation have documented 116 different species in India, Nepal, Congo and Angola of which 104 were discovered in India. Earlier this week, he wrote to union minister for environment, forest and climate change Bhupendra Yadav about the illegal capture and trafficking of the Borna snakehead (Channa amphibeus), an exceptionally rare freshwater fish facing immediate threat from the international aquarium market. In his letter, Thackeray has asked for legal protection for scheduling the Channa amphibeus under the highest protection status of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, and to strictly criminalize its unauthorized capture, transit, and trade.

From jetboat thrills to alpine chills: Jemimah's fun-filled escape to Interlaken

From racing across lakes and creating chocolate masterpieces to exploring Swiss heritage, Jemimah's Interlaken adventure was extraordinary

If there's one place that knows how to turn a holiday into an adventure, it's Interlaken! Tucked between the gorgeous Lakes Thun and Brienz in Switzerland's Bernese Oberland, this alpine playground is packed with adrenaline rushes, chocolatey treats, cultural discoveries and mountain views that belong on a postcard. And Jemimah was ready to experience it all!

First up? Hold on tight! Jemimah hit the water for an exhilarating jetboat ride, speeding across the lake with the spectacular Swiss Alps as her backdrop. With twists, turns and plenty of thrills, it was the perfect way to dive straight into Interlaken's adventurous spirit. But the fun didn't stop there.

From high-speed splashes to sweet little indulgences, Jemimah swapped adrenaline for chocolate at *Funky Chocolate.* Here, she rolled up her sleeves and got creative with one of Switzerland's most delicious exports. Making her own chocolate was every bit as fun as it sounds and getting to taste the results was certainly a bonus!

Next, it was time for a little trip back in time at the Ballenberg Open-Air Museum. Surrounded by traditional Swiss farmhouses, historic buildings and beautiful countryside, Jemimah discovered how people lived, worked and crafted their way through generations. Think charming old-world architecture, fascinating traditions and a refreshing change of pace from all the action.

Of course, no Swiss adventure is complete without getting up close to those legendary alpine peaks. Enter Jungfraujoch—top of Europe! The journey up was an adventure in itself, with spectacular mountain views unfolding along the way. But the real magic began when Jemimah stepped into a world of snow and ice. Experiencing snow up close, she got to soak in the wintry wonderland, surrounded by glistening white landscapes and towering peaks as far as the eye could see. From the thrill of being surrounded by snow to taking in the sheer scale of the Alps, it was a moment filled with childlike wonder and plenty of excitement. Sitting at an incredible 3,454 metres above sea level, Jungfraujoch is home to Europe's highest railway station and offers an unforgettable taste of life at the top of the world. For Jemimah, it was more than just another stop on the itinerary it was a chance to experience the magic of the Swiss Alps in an entirely new way.

For the grand finale, Jemimah headed to Harder Kulm, perched 1,322 metres above Interlaken. With the mighty Eiger, Mönch and Jungfrau peaks on one side and Lakes Thun and Brienz glistening below, the views were nothing short of spectacular. As the sun dipped behind the mountains, it was time to slow down, soak it all in and give this action-packed day the sunset ending it deserved.

From racing across lakes and creating chocolate masterpieces to exploring Swiss heritage and reaching the top of Europe, Jemimah's Interlaken adventure was anything but ordinary. It was a destination that delivered a little bit of everything—thrills, treats, culture and views for days.

The takeaway? In Interlaken, you don't have to choose between adventure and relaxation. You can chase a rush in the morning, satisfy your sweet tooth in the afternoon and end the day watching the sun set over the Alps. Now that's what we call a Swiss holiday done right!

Jungfraujoch – Jemimah at the top of Jungfrau

At the Ballenberg Open-Air Museum

Swapping adrenaline for chocolate at Funky Chocolate

An exhilarating jetboat ride

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BMC fixed deposits fell by ₹13,785 cr since 2021

Congress demands a comprehensive white paper from municipal commissioner on civic body's finances from 2021-22

Linah Baliga
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MUMBAI: The sharp decline of nearly ₹13,785 crore—from approximately ₹91,690 crore to ₹77,905 crore—in the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's (BMC) fixed deposits (FD) since 2021 has raised concerns about how the civic body's reserves are being utilised and if the corporation will be able to meet its future financial obligations without facing a liquidity crunch. BMC's ongoing infrastructure commitments are estimated at ₹2.34 lakh crore.

Given these circumstances, Congress group leader Ashraf Azmi demanded a comprehensive white paper from municipal commissioner Ashwini Bhide on Thursday, on the BMC's financial position from 2021-22 to September 2026. He has sought an account of the utilisation of reserves, authorisation of expenditure and the civic body's long-term financial sustainability. Azmi also flagged the decline of ₹3,544 crore in FDs over the last eight months.

"The decline warrants a transparent explanation of how the funds had been utilised, who had authorised the expenditure and how the BMC would finance its future commitments while maintaining adequate reserves," Azmi told HT.

> The decline in FDs warrants transparent explanation of how the funds had been utilised
>
> **ASHRAF AZMI,** Congress group leader

The demand comes as the BMC operated under an administrator without elected representatives for nearly four years, during which major infrastructure projects and financial commitments were made. Green-lit projects with allocated funds include the Mumbai Coastal Road, road concretisation programme, GMLR, reconstruction of bridges and railway overbridges, and sewage treatment plants.

Azmi said financial decisions made during this period must be transparently accounted for to elected representatives and Mumbai's citizens. "The administration must reconcile the decline in reserves with actual expenditure, budgetary provisions and approvals, and clarify whether the money was used for approved projects, additional requirements, transfers between funds or settlement of liabilities," Azmi added.

He requested a year-wise, fund-wise statement on withdrawals, transfers, actual expenditure, closing balances, major transactions, departments, projects, and approvals.

"The administration should also specify which expenditures were covered by existing budget provisions and which required revised estimates, supplementary provisions or separate approvals," Azmi said.

Seeking a five-year projection, Azmi asked if projected revenues can meet obligations without depleting reserves. Azmi acknowledged declining reserves do not inherently mean irregularity.

Responding to Azmi's letter, Bhide stated BMC's FDs rose to ₹91,690.85 crore in 2021–22, dropped to ₹77,905.39 crore by March 31, 2026 due to heavy project spending, and rebounded to ₹79,873.39 crore by October 13, 2026. BMC's ₹2,44,552.65 crore infrastructure commitments will be met via revenue strategies and financing.

TODDLER DIES AFTER FALL FROM GOREGAON BLDG; FAMILY ALLEGES SHE WAS PUSHED

Megha Sood
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MUMBAI: An 18-month-old girl died after falling from the sixth floor of a Mhada building in Goregaon East on Wednesday night, after she went missing while playing outside her home. Her family suspects that a 12-year-old neighbour pushed her over the railing. The Dindoshi police have registered an accidental death report (ADR) and are investigating the incident.

The incident occurred around 9.30pm at Shiv Shakti Prakalp No. 1, Goregaon East. The victim, Ariba Shakir Khan, was playing outside her family's flat on the sixth floor when she suddenly went missing. Her mother, who was inside the house, asked Ariba's elder brother to look for her.

The boy peered over the railing and saw his younger sister lying on the ground floor, bleeding profusely. He rushed downstairs and screamed for help. Residents then took the toddler to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared her dead before admission. The hospital subsequently alerted the police.

The police conducted a panchnama and sent the body for a post-mortem examination. They are investigating the sequence of events leading to the child's death, police said.

Ariba's aunt, Gulnar Sayyed, said the family suspected foul play because the railing was too high for a toddler to climb over.

The family had moved into flat No. 602 of the building only 15 days earlier and had not yet got to know their neighbours, she said.

"When we checked the CCTV footage of the floor, we saw the neighbor's daughter playing in the same area as the child," Sayyed said, alleging that the 12-year-old had pushed Ariba over the railing.

"We have requested the police to investigate the involvement of the 12-year-old girl," she added. The allegation remains unverified, and the police are investigating the child's death.

State, railways form joint panel to draw blueprint for mass transport integration

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MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government and Indian Railways have formed a 13-member joint task force to develop an integrated transport blueprint for the Mumbai Metropolitan Region and other urban centres across the state.

The task force will explore expanding railways, metro rail and regional rapid transit system (RRTS) to facilitate seamless integration with other modes of transport. The decision to expand the reach of mass transport systems was taken on Wednesday.

The task force will be headed by the Mumbai Rail Vikas Corporation (MRVC), a joint venture between the Maharashtra government and Indian Railways. "We will submit a broad report to the state government within six months," said an MRVC official.

"The corporation may conduct the exercise through its own technical teams or appoint consultants, depending on the requirements. The task force will periodically review the study's progress," reads an internal note.

The state government is expected to hold a review meeting with the task force by November-end.

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results for the Quarter/Half Year Ended 30th September, 2026 (₹ in Lakh)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations (net)	817408	742139	1685632	1485460	2974098
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	78564	61976	144197	122720	276786
5.	Total Comprehensive income for the period (comprising Profit/Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)	Please Refer Note No. 2				
6.	Paid Up Equity Share Capital	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	1756007	1541844	1756007	1541844	1756007
8.	Securities Premium Account	504211	504211	504211	504211	504211
9.	Net Worth	2788109	2301266	2788109	2301266	2446221
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	0.08	0.09	0.08	0.09	0.09
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	0.75	0.66	0.75	0.66	0.70
12.	Earning Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
	1. Basic :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
	2. Diluted :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable				
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve					

Notes : 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/ half-yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under regulation 33 and 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly/half yearly Financial Result are available on the Stock Exchange websites. (BSE : www.bseindia.com and NSE : www.nseindia.com), Bank's website (www.uco.bank.in/investors) 2. Information relating to total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the bank.

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City's 3rd airport to be ready at Vadhavan by 2035

State govt begins feasibility study for Vadhavan airport, with traffic projections till 2071

Faisal Malik
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The state government has begun work on a master plan for the greenfield offshore international airport. PIC FOR REPRESENTATION

MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government has set a 2035 deadline to complete the proposed airport at Vadhavan in Palghar district, where one of India's largest ports is also being developed. The airport, when ready, will be the third in the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR).

The government has begun work on a master plan for the greenfield offshore international airport by appointing a consultant to conduct a detailed techno-economic feasibility study and oversee the bidding process through the Maharashtra Airport Development Company (MADC).

The government plans to develop the proposed airport in Kore in Vadhavan as the third airport serving MMR, alongside the Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports. It will serve a new city in Palghar, which will be developed around the aviation hub.

"The state government is targeting completion of the airport within the next nine years," said a senior official from the state general administration department. "A key component of the feasibility study will be forecasting passenger, aircraft and cargo traffic up to the financial year 2070–71, with projections at five-year intervals beginning in 2035–36," he added.

The consultant will analyse at least 15 years of historical traffic data from airports within a 150-km radius of the proposed site, including Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports. The study will assess how existing airports and their planned expansions could affect the proposed facility's traffic and growth prospects, the official said.

The assessment will also factor in industrial expansion in Vasai-Virar, economic growth in districts along the Maharashtra-Gujarat border, tourism and rising per capita incomes.

Based on the projections, the consultant will estimate peak-hour demand, determine passenger and cargo connectivity requirements, and recommend a phased development plan, taking into account capacity constraints at existing airports across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR).

"A major component of the master plan will be determining the airport's offshore configuration, including whether it should be developed on reclaimed land, an artificial island or an offshore platform," said a senior government official. The plan will also identify the onshore infrastructure required for access, utilities, logistics and emergency response, he added.

The consultant will assess the availability and transportation of reclamation material, rock required for coastal protection and other construction resources.

Detailed topographical, geotechnical and hydrological studies will be undertaken to establish site conditions, drainage patterns and flood levels.

The proposed terminal building will be designed to achieve carbon neutrality in operational emissions and comply with GRIHA Version 5 requirements. The consultant will examine the potential for solar power, offshore wind energy and other renewable sources, alongside energy-efficient construction and utility systems.

The techno-economic feasibility study will assess the regulatory framework and approvals required under the centre's Greenfield Airports Policy. It will also examine potential government incentives and the broader economic benefits expected from the project.

State plans 5th Film City at Guhagar on Ratnagiri coast

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MUMBAI: Spearheaded by cultural affairs minister Ashish Shelar, the government is planning to set up a fifth Film City at Palshet, Velneshwar and Tavsal villages in Guhagar taluka on 125 acres of land currently under the control of the Maharashtra Tourism Development Corporation (MTDC). The tourism and cultural affairs departments are preparing a detailed project report for the proposed project, which is likely to be developed under a public-private partnership (PPP) model, involving private players from the entertainment industry.

Shelar has already greenlit a ₹3,000-crore upgrade of Film City in Goregaon, plans to establish two new Film Cities in Nagpur and Nashik, and is considering another Film City on around 150 acres of central government-owned land in Malad. The Guhagar project envisages film production facilities in the coastal belt of Ratnagiri, which has significant tourism potential.

"Dapoli and Guhagar talukas are popular destinations for television and film shoots because of their scenic beauty and attractive coastal stretches," said an official from the Maharashtra Film, Stage and Cultural Development Corporation Limited (MFSCDCL). "However, the region lacks the infrastructure required for shooting activities. We have involved MTDC, as it already has accommodation facilities."

NAVI MUM COPS BUST IRIDIUM INVESTMENT SCAM; 2 BOOKED

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NAVI MUMBAI: Navi Mumbai police registered a case on Wednesday against two men for allegedly running an unregistered investment scheme named 'Iridium Particles' that promised returns of up to ₹28 crore on investments as low as ₹2 lakh. The police said around 500 investors had fallen prey to this scheme.

The suspected fraud came to light after the Economic Intelligence Cell of Navi Mumbai police was tipped off that some individuals were allegedly soliciting investments by promising disproportionate returns from the purported sale of iridium particles. An officer, Suraj Kiran Gore, was authorised to pose as a prospective investor to verify the information.

According to the FIR, Gore contacted an agent, Jayant Oak, through an informant. Oak arranged a meeting with a certain Tirthankar Sengupta at a hotel in Turbhe on October 13.

In the meeting, Sengupta allegedly claimed that they had discovered iridium along the West Bengal-Bangladesh border and that five custodians, including him, were entitled to half of ₹3.34 lakh crore received from its sale to Germany.

The decoy investor was told that investing ₹5 lakh in the scheme would yield ₹9-₹28 crore by the end of November 2026. Gore expressed his willingness to invest ₹5 lakh, paid Sengupta ₹1 lakh in cash as an advance, and audio-recorded the conversation.

He then filed a complaint stating that the accused claimed around 500 people had invested in the scheme, with each contributing an average of ₹4 lakh to ₹5 lakh. The complaint also stated that the accused had been collecting deposits since 2018 but had not paid the promised returns or returned the principal amount to the investors. However, they continued seeking investments by promising that the money would be released in November 2026.

Based on this complaint, Navi Mumbai police registered an FIR against Oak and Sengupta under sections 318 (4) and 316 (5) of the BNS and sections 3, 5, 21 and 23 of the Banning of Unregulated Deposit Schemes Act, 2019.

Amid malaria surge, doctors say strains affecting organs too

Mumbai registered 7,422 cases between June and August despite fumigation drives. FILE PHOTO

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MUMBAI: Doctors across the board, from big private hospitals to clinics in Dharavi, are reporting a large number of malaria cases this year. Dr Deepesh Agrawal, consultant physician and head of critical care medicine at Saifee Hospital, said that additionally, the cases were more severe, with at least two to three critical patients being admitted daily to his hospital's ICU.

"Earlier, only cases of falciparum malaria were dangerous but this year we are seeing even cases of vivax malaria turning critical and accompanied by problems in the kidneys, liver and other organs," he said. "While the rise in cases could be attributed to the huge number of construction sites, one of the key concerns is the delay in diagnosis, with people delaying treatment or even choosing to self-medicate, using AI-based information. It is important that they avoid self-medication and get timely treatment."

Malaria mostly spreads through the bites of some infected female Anopheles mosquitoes. According to the World Health Organisation, of the five Plasmodium parasite species that cause malaria in humans, P falciparum and P vivax pose the greatest threat. While P falciparum is the deadliest malaria parasite and the most prevalent in the African continent, P vivax is the dominant malaria parasite in most countries outside of sub-Saharan Africa.

Mumbai has registered two recorded deaths due to malaria in addition to the death of a nursing student at J J Hospital on October 4. "Some cases of malaria that we are treating now are so serious that even paracetamol is not effective," said J J Hospital dean Dr Ajay Bhandarwar. "One of the major causes of malaria and dengue on the campus is the construction work being undertaken."

According to the BMC, Mumbai registered 7,422 cases of malaria during the monsoon months from June to August, a 44% rise compared to the 5,144 cases registered in the corresponding period last year. However, medical practitioners say the actual numbers could be much higher than the official numbers due to under-reporting from private practitioners.

Dr Anil Pachnekar, a member of Mahim Dharavi Medical Practitioners Association, said this was because many doctors, in order to avoid paperwork, refused to inform BMC. "Doctors are supposed to report the names and numbers of patients to BMC and even remain available when the BMC team comes for verification," he pointed out.

Pachnekar, who practices at Dharavi, said the area was witnessing a huge rise in cases. "Almost every general practitioner is seeing at least seven malaria patients. What is important is to complete the course of anti-malarial treatment and to ensure that co-morbidities like diabetes and blood pressure are also under control," he said.

Santosh Gaikwad, executive health officer, BMC, said, "We are following the treatment protocols and guidelines set by the state government at our public health centres across the city."

Cracker ban on roads is all-year: HC

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The Bombay High Court extended the ban first enacted during Ganeshotsav into a permanent, year-round restriction. HT ARCHIVE

MUMBAI: With less than a month to go before Diwali, the Bombay High Court on Thursday said that its recent order directing a complete ban on bursting firecrackers on streets across Maharashtra would be applicable throughout the year.

A division bench of justices Girish Kulkarni and Neela Gokhale effectively extended the ban first enacted during Ganeshotsav in September into a permanent, year-round restriction.

The bench observed that the "toxic pollution" from firecrackers affects everyone, especially senior citizens and children, and the situation worsens after Diwali. "This needs to change as times are different now. The state authorities have no control over burning firecrackers. We all are bound by the Constitution, and the rights of citizens are paramount," it said.

The court was hearing a suo motu petition taken up in September concerning noise pollution caused by religious processions in Mumbai and other cities across Maharashtra.

During a hearing on September 22, the court had called for a complete ban on bursting firecrackers on streets. It had directed the Maharashtra government to strictly enforce decibel limits during religious processions and take strict action against violators.

On Thursday, the court clarified that its September 22 order will be applicable to all festivities throughout the year and across Maharashtra. "There cannot be any distinction between different festivities taking place throughout the year, during which issues of noise and air pollution continue to arise," the bench said.

The court also flagged the adverse impact of the "tremendous haze and smog" caused by "severe air pollution" in cities such as Mumbai during the post-monsoon season. It noted that the air quality index (AQI) in some parts of Mumbai had reached 425.

"The future generation needs to remain healthy to meet the challenges of contemporary times, rather than spending their time visiting hospitals and receiving medical treatment. The societal cost in terms of such health hazards is too high to be borne by those who silently suffer the ill-effects of toxic pollution, owing to the activities of a few who are least bothered about the impact of their actions on the society at large," the bench said.

The court urged citizens to become conscious of the "long-term hazards of living in cities", which it said had turned into "gas chambers". Accordingly, the court ordered the authorities to issue notices urging citizens to avoid firecrackers that generate noise and air pollution, highlighting the seriousness of their toxicity. It suggested involving celebrities in awareness campaigns, with a view to making cities better places to live.

"The whole idea is that all of us should contribute. We have neither banned any manufacturing of firecrackers nor are we concerned with any sale, and we are not restricting any activity. What we have restricted is what was prevailing for all these times," the bench said.

IIT-B SUICIDE: PARENTS MEET JOINT CP, SEEK PROBE DETAILS

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MUMBAI: Parents of the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay student who died by suicide on September 18 met Joint Commissioner of Police (crime) Anil Kumbhare on Thursday, to seek updates on the probe into their son's death. They also reiterated their demand for a fair, transparent and speedy probe to ensure justice for their son.

Congress MP and Mumbai Congress president Varsha Gaikwad, along with MLAs Amin Patel and Aslam Shaikh, accompanied the family for the meeting with the police officer. Speaking to reporters later, the Congress leaders raised concerns over the investigation and called for the immediate arrest of Prof. Suryanarayan Doolla, who has been named as an accused in the case.

On Friday, Mumbai Against Suppression of Students (MASS), a civil society group, has called for a protest at Azad Maidan, seeking justice for the deceased student.

MU panel flags dirty toilets and canteen, poorly maintained facilities at JBIMS

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Senate members have urged the administration to repair the toilets, fix problems with the canteen and drinking water coolers.

MUMBAI: Dirty toilets, a poorly maintained canteen, garbage and foul-smelling drainage water have raised questions about the condition of basic facilities at the Jamnalal Bajaj Institute of Management Studies (JBIMS), one of Mumbai's prominent management institutes affiliated to the University of Mumbai.

Photographs taken during a recent inspection by university Senate members, Pradeep Sawant and Alpesh Yadav, and former Senate member Rajan Kolambekar, highlighted the poor conditions at the institute.

"In one of the toilets, a bird's nest with eggs in them was found. White stains, possibly bird droppings, and dirt covered parts of the floor, making the toilet unfit for use. We largely avoid using the toilets on campus," said a student. He also pointed to the poor quality of food served in the canteen and the institute's library. "We filed a complaint with the management several times, but they failed to address the issues."

The canteen's kitchen also appeared to fail even a basic hygiene test. The photographs showed dirty walls, stained tiles, utensils piled near the washing area and large vessels on the floor. One of them contained what appeared to be prepared food. The cooking and washing areas too did not appear to be hygienic

"During our visit, we also discovered that one of the building's lifts had been out of order for nearly a month. Garbage and foul-smelling drainage water were also reported on the ground floor," said Sawant.

He said the library had been housed in a corridor on the first floor for want of space. This raises questions about whether students have adequate space to read and study," he said.

Senate members have urged the university administration to repair the toilets, fix problems with the canteen and drinking water coolers, and steps to address the cleanliness and maintenance issues. While repairs are undertaken, residential accommodation for officials and hostelites could be temporarily shifted to other university properties, Senate members suggested.

Responding to the issue, a university official said, "The repair work on the building is underway, and the debris will be removed soon. The toilet shown in the photograph is currently closed for maintenance and is not in use. The institute's library has been located at the same place for a long time to ensure easy access for students."

NAVI MUM TRAFFIC POLICE SEIZE 450 SILENCERS IN CRACKDOWN ON NOISE POLLUTION

The confiscated silencers were crushed under a road roller.

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NAVI MUMBAI: Navi Mumbai traffic police have seized around 450 modified motorcycle silencers across the city and destroyed 93 of them in a crackdown on vehicles producing excessive noise, with the remaining confiscated devices scheduled to be destroyed on October 20 at Kalamboli and Panvel.

The confiscated silencers were crushed under a road roller in the presence of senior traffic officials and a representative of the Vashi Regional Transport Office.

The drive follows complaints from residents along Palm Beach Road, particularly the stretch between NRI Junction and Balsheth Chowk, as well as sectors 42, 46 and 50. The loud exhausts are a particular concern during early mornings and late nights, when sudden bursts of noise can disturb sleep and affect people living in residential complexes.

The first phase of the drive was conducted by the Vashi and Seawoods traffic police units near the T S Chanakya signal on Palm Beach Road on Wednesday.

The confiscated silencers were crushed under a road roller in the presence of senior traffic officials and a representative of the Vashi Regional Transport Office.

Deputy commissioner of police (Traffic) Rahul Khade said, "People use these modified silencers to produce harsh, loud noises. This causes considerable distress, and we receive numerous complaints from the general public."

{ THE LAST CHORD } 1964-2026

Mahesh Tinaikar, founding member of Rock Machine and Indus Creed, dies at 62

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MUMBAI: Back in the mid-1990s, streams of rock fans would head to the iconic Rang Bhavan in Mumbai every August. The annual Independence Rock festival had by then become an important part of Mumbai's cultural calendar, and the band Indus Creed was at its peak.

Memories of watching them perform songs like 'Pretty Child', 'Trapped' and 'Top Of The Rock' flashed back on Thursday afternoon, when news of the death of guitarist Mahesh Tinaikar – an inspiration to many young guitarists over the years -- spread through social media.

Tinaikar, 62, suffered from health issues for many years, although his friends say he had been careful. Two weeks ago, he complained of stomach pain and suffered a heart attack while undergoing an endoscopy at a Borivali hospital. The funeral will be held on Friday at the Banganga crematorium.

"We were discussing a new song, just on Wednesday," said Zubin Balaporia, keyboardist of Indus Creed, who played with Tinaikar from the time the band was called Rock Machine. "We have known each other for 40 years, and besides various cities in India, toured the US, Russia and UK. I was 18 when we first met, and he was 20, and none of us knew if we would make music a full-time career."

Rock Machine was founded in 1984, and its early line-up had Tinaikar on lead guitar, Ian Santamaria on vocals, Mark Selwyn on bass, Aftab Currim on rhythm guitar and Suresh Bhadricha on drums. They did only a few shows, before Uday Benegal joined as vocalist, with Jayesh Gandhi on rhythm guitar and Mark Menezes on drums. Balaporia soon joined as keyboardist.

It is noteworthy that Tinaikar didn't come from a family of musicians. Son of former Mumbai municipal commissioner S S Tinaikar, he listened to the music of his time with his friends, and often spoke of how the bands Deep Purple, The Who and Creedence Clearwater Revival had helped him cultivate an interest in rock music.

Back in the early 1980s, bands like High and Shiva from Kolkata, 13AD from Kerala and Crosswinds from Mumbai were popular on the concert circuit. Ehsaan Noorani, of Crosswinds, later part of the film music trio Shankar-Ehsaan-Loy, remembered his first meetings with Tinaikar. He recalled, "I used to stay near (singer) Jayesh Gandhi's home at Oval Maidan, where all of us guitarists would converge driven by a common bond. I learnt from the famous Bismarck Rodriguez, and was slightly more experienced than them. So, I would teach them certain techniques, particularly in the blues style. Both Mahesh and I were fans of the British band Wishbone Ash – we would discuss their songs, especially the twin guitar parts."

According to Noorani, Tinaikar was known to give himself up to exploring new styles and closely observe different guitarists. "He was heavily into Michael Schenker, and jazz guitarists like John Scofield and Larry Carlton," he said.

Rock Machine released its debut album 'Rock N' Roll Renegade' in 1988, whereupon 'Top Of The Rock', 'The Enemy Within' and the title track became fan favourites. The follow-up 'The Second Coming', released in 1990, featured their classic 'Pretty Child'. The band was renamed Indus Creed, and the self-titled album had the songs 'Trapped' and 'Sleep'.

Along with New Delhi's Parikrama, Indus Creed ruled the rock scene in the mid-1990s. Some years on, with the musicians wanting to do other projects, the band members took a break in 1997. Tinaikar began playing gigs with other musicians, including singer Gary Lawyer. He eventually played guitar on and produced Lawyer's 2004 album 'Unbelong', later renamed 'No Turning Back'. Said Lawyer, "I don't think he realised the kind of brilliance he could display. No one could have done a better job than him in playing the guitar solos and the treatment he gave those songs."

In 2008, Uday Benegal formed his acoustic project Whirling Kalapas, with multi-instrumentalists Sankarshan Kini and Ashwin Andrew. Tinaikar joined them, and eventually he and Benegal talked about reviving Indus Creed. They approached Balaporia, bassist Rushad Mistry and drummer Jai Row Kavi. Said Balaporia, "I wasn't very keen as I had other projects on hand. But I agreed to do only the first show at Hard Rock Café in Worli. I never left after that."

Indus Creed recorded 'Evolve' in 2012 – their first album in 17 years. They opened for Santana in Bengaluru, played at the revived Mahindra Independence Rock and this March, opened for Def Leppard at the Jio World Garden. Lawyer spoke about a show at the Yacht Club two months ago when Tinaikar filled in for the regular guitarist. "It was a marvelous performance, as he just fit into the songs without much notice," he said. That was Mahesh Tinaikar's genius. .

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CBI ARRESTS SFIO DY DIRECTOR, 2 OTHERS IN ₹1-CR BRIBERY CASE

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MUMBAI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested three persons, including an Indian Revenue Service (IRS) officer working as deputy director of the Serious Fraud Investigation Office (SFIO) in an alleged ₹1 crore bribery case.

The CBI acted after registering a case against Harish Kumar Tanwar, the accused IRS officer working as a deputy director with the SFIO, Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Chennai, and a Delhi-based advocate, Bharat Sharma, along with others, on allegations that they had demanded undue advantage of ₹1 crore from the complainant for allegedly favouring him in an investigation being conducted by the SFIO related to the Dewan Housing Finance Corporation Limited (DHFL) fraud. Tanwar, a 2017 batch IRS officer, was the investigating officer of the case.

After verification of the complaint and registration of the case, the CBI laid a trap and arrested Tanwar, Sharma and the latter's relative Aryan Sharma. The arrests were effected after the advocate allegedly received an undue advantage of ₹20 lakh from the complainant, as part payment of the demanded bribe of ₹1 crore, for and on behalf of the SFIO officer, CBI officials said on Thursday.

During the course of the searches conducted at the premises of the SFIO officer and the advocate, material related to the case has been recovered, the officials said. The CBI on Tuesday registered a case against Tanwar, the lawyer and unknown public servants/others, based on a complaint from a businessman. The businessman had submitted a complaint to the CBI on Monday, alleging about Tanwar's bribe demand and that he had been threatened of arrest in connection with the SFIO's investigation.

CBI LAID A TRAP AND ARRESTED TANWAR, SHARMA AND THE LATTER'S RELATIVE ARYAN SHARMA

No bail for Nirav Modi's aide in PNB fraud case

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MUMBAI: A special Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) court has turned down the bail application of Sandeep Mistry, an alleged close associate of fugitive diamantaire Nirav Modi, in the ₹6,498-crore Punjab National bank fraud case. The plea was rejected on grounds that Mistry had allegedly destroyed electronic evidence, operated dummy companies in Dubai and Hong Kong, and handled 4 million UAE dirhams allegedly meant for Modi.

On Thursday, Special Judge S K Karhale held that Mistry's prolonged absence from India, his alleged involvement in the offence and the risk of evidence tampering weighed against his release. Mistry was arrested at the Mumbai airport on September 29 after being detained in the UAE and brought back to India.

The court relied on prosecution witness Ashish Kumar Lad's statement that he had withdrawn around 4 million Arab Emirates Dirams in cash from accounts of 13 Dubai-based group companies on the instructions of Mihir Bhansali, another accused, and others. The money was allegedly with Lad for 12 days before he handed it to Mistry at the Dubai Airport Free Zone. Mistry allegedly told Lad he would give the money to Modi.

The court said Mistry allegedly managed dummy companies in Dubai and Hong Kong, coordinated the preparation of false import and export documents to portray fictitious trade in diamonds, gold and pearl jewellery, and issued instructions through communication systems called "panemail" and "crickinfo", designed to automatically delete messages.

It also recorded allegations that Mistry helped replace dummy directors after the case was registered and that electronic evidence was destroyed. A server containing accounting and operational data was removed from the Dubai office of World Diamond Distribution FZE before it was vacated. Its hard disk was subsequently handed over by Nehal Modi, Nirav Modi's brother, for destruction, according to the order.

> Mistry's return to India was secured through coercive proceedings. His appearance in this case is under compelling circumstances...It would be difficult to secure his presence during the course of trial if he were released.
> Special CBI court

Mistry's lawyer argued that the investigation was complete, the chargesheet had been filed, his passport had been revoked and other accused who returned to India had secured bail. He also pointed out that the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) had not sought his custody after arrest.

The prosecution opposed bail, saying Mistry had avoided proceedings despite notices and a non-bailable warrant issued in March 2021. It argued that he could abscond again, as his wife and child were in Dubai, and that his alleged role differed from that of other accused.

Rejecting Mistry's plea, the judge observed that his return to India had been secured through coercive proceedings. "Thus the appearance of the applicant in this case is under compelling circumstances," the court said, adding that "it would be difficult to secure his presence during the course of trial" if he were released.

The court also cited the risk of evidence destruction and witness tampering while rejecting his bail application.

3 held for Ulhasnagar murder; cops suspect revenge killing

The main accused wanted to avenge the killing of a friend and injuries he suffered in 2021 attack: Police

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THANE: The Vitthalwadi police have arrested three men for the brutal murder of social activist Harish Gajwani outside Ulhasnagar railway station on Wednesday evening. Police suspect the murder was an act of revenge for a 2021 attack in which the main accused was seriously injured and his friend was killed.

The arrested accused were identified as Avinash Naidu, Noor Alam Khan and Vijay Puran Singh. According to the police, Naidu shot Gajwani twice at close range before Khan and Singh attacked him with sharp weapons. Gajwani, 54, died on the spot.

The three accused allegedly shot Harish Gajwani (left) twice and stabbed him with sharp weapons.

The attack took place around 8.30 pm on Wednesday, when Gajwani, who frequently posted about social issues on social media, was standing outside Ulhasnagar railway station. The three accused allegedly arrived on a motorcycle, attacked him and fled.

The accused allegedly took an autorickshaw to Ambernath and then travelled to Kalyan. They were planning to flee to Gondia in Vidarbha, where Naidu's wife lives, a police officer said. The three were produced before a magistrate's court in Ambernath on Thursday and remanded to police custody until October 26.

Police said the killing stemmed from an old feud between Naidu and Gajwani. In 2021, the two had been involved in a fight in which Naidu suffered a serious abdominal injury and his friend, Sanjay Shitlani, was killed. Gajwani and his associate, Naresh Lefty, were subsequently arrested in connection with the case. "He (Naidu) still bleeds and suffers pain because of it, which is why he wanted to take revenge on Gajwani," a police officer said.

Sachin Gore, deputy commissioner of police (zone 4), said that Gajwani had been released on bail in the case in 2025. He subsequently became involved in social activism, filing Right to Information (RTI) applications and online complaints on issues he claimed were in the public interest.

"Naidu also has a criminal background. He had been externed from Thane district because of multiple serious crimes registered against him, including murder, attempt to murder and cases under the Arms Act," he added.

Police are trying to recover the weapons used in Wednesday's attack and establish why Khan and Singh joined Naidu in the alleged murder. They are also checking whether the two have criminal records.

According to local residents, Gajwani had recently raised concerns on social media about the growing gambling and gutkha businesses in Ulhasnagar. He had alleged that local police officers and politicians were helping these illegal businesses flourish. In a recent post on X, he had also claimed to have received threats to his life from unidentified persons. Gore said Gajwani had also been booked in a gambling-related case in 2021.

'Garba of equality' to counter hate, divisions

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MUMBAI: To counter efforts by the Vishwa Hindu Parishad and other Hindu right wing groups to restrict Navratri celebrations to Hindus, and to provide a caste-, religion- and gender-neutral platform for people, the Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti (MANS) and Mumbai For Peace (MfP) are co-organising 'Samtecha Garba' or 'Garba for Equality' this weekend at Prabhadevi and Mumbra.

The theme of the two-day programme, to be held over the weekend, is 'Manasancha...Manasansathi' or 'Of the people...For the people'. The first event will be held on Saturday at Tilak Bhavan in Prabhadevi, followed by another on Sunday at Friendz Turf in Mumbra. Both events are open to all, across age groups, and participants have been urged to bring along their garba squad comprising friends, family and neighbours.

Last month, the VHP had opposed the participation of Muslims in garba and dandiya programmes during Navratri. HT ARCHIVES

"More than a celebration of Navratri, Samtecha Garba is a joyful statement against divisiveness and communal hate. A curated music playlist built around equality, friendship and constitutional values will keep the circles moving and each evening will close with an award ceremony felicitating the best dancers and standout participants," said Nandkishor Talashilkar, state secretary, MANS.

Founded by acclaimed rationalist Narendra Dabholkar, who was shot dead in Pune in 2013, allegedly at the behest of Hindutva outfits, MANS works to promote scientific temper and counter superstition among people across Maharashtra.

MfP, the co-organiser of the programme, is a platform comprising Mumbaikars committed to safeguarding the city's plural character and nurturing communal harmony.

Sameer Wagle from MfP told Hindustan Times that the two-day programme is part of a larger series of cultural interventions by the organisation. "It is aimed at countering and communalism while reinforcing Mumbai's identity as a city of love, tolerance and inclusivity," Wagle said. The two-day programme is backed by voluntary civil society groups such as Parcham and Bebaak, as well as several ordinary citizens.

Last month, the Vishwa Hindu Parishad had opposed the participation of Muslims in garba and dandiya programmes during Navratri. VHP spokesperson and joint secretary Shriraj Nair had told HT that the organisation had reached out to organisers of garba and dandiya events, urging them to check the Aadhaar cards of participants and only allow those wearing a tilak (a sacred mark applied on the forehead).

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पत्र क्र. 2431/व.ले.लि./2026 माचाडोली, दिनांक: 08.10.2026

निविदा निरस्तीकरण सूचना

इस कार्यालय द्वारा मिनीमाता बांगो बांध के पुराने भवन का जीर्णोद्धार सी.सी. सोल्डर का निर्माण, मेसनरी बांध के आधार गैलरी में चेकर टेराजो टाईल्स, मिट्टी बांध में वायर फेंसिंग एवं एतमानगर कालोनी हेतु सी.सी. रोड का पुर्निमाण कार्य हेतु निविदा सूचना क्र. 02/व.ले.लि./2026-27 दिनांक 03.06.2026 प्रथम आमंत्रण किया गया था। उक्त निविदा को निविदाकार द्वारा कार्य किये जाने के संबंध में आवेदन दिया गया है। उक्त निविदा को निविदा प्रपत्र की कंडिका के शर्तों के तहत धरोहर राशि राजसात कर निविदा निरस्त किया जाता है। जी क्रमांक:- जी-262701193 दिनांक 06.06.2026

कार्यपालन अभियंता,
मिनीमाता बांगो बांध विभाग क्र.3,
माचाडोली

G-262703927/5

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E - TENDER NOTICE

E- Tender notice no. - ECR-SnT-OT-21TAR-2026-27

Sealed tenders are invited for and on behalf of president of India from competent and experienced contractors for execution of the work mentioned below:- **S.N. (i) Name of work with its location and Completion Period :** Appointment of Project Supervision Services Agency (PSSA) for providing Project Supervision Services at various Project Sites/Sections in the work jurisdiction of Chief Signal & Telecomm Engineer/Works, East Central Railway, Hajipur. **Completion Period 24 months. (ii) Approx. cost of the work :** Rs.12,40,44,578/- (Rupees Twelve Crore Forty Lakh Forty Four Thousand Five Hundred Seventy Eight only). **(iii) Earnest Money to be deposited :** Rs. 7,70,200/- (Rs. Seven Lakh Seventy Thousand Two Hundred only). **(iv) Last date and time of submission of tender and Opening of tender :** 17/11/2026 up to 16.00 Hrs. and 17/11/2026 at 16.30 Hrs. **(v) Website particulars, Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen. : www.ireps.gov.in,** on the Notice Board of Principal Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/ East Central Railway/Hajipur & Dy. Chief Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Works, East Central Railway/Hajipur.

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Works-II, East Central Railway/ Hajipur.

PR/1116/HQ/S&T/T/26-27/40

BRIDGE WORKS

Tender Notice No. CON/2026/AUG/07. Open tender through e-Tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor(s)/firm(s) for the following works: **Tender No. CE/CON/J-M/IS/2026/08. Name of work:** Earthwork, construction of balanced major and minor bridges and protection works, trolley refuge, diversion of road in RUB between chainage 117404m to 124830m in connection with construction of Jiribam-Tupul-Imphal New BG Railway Line Project. **Tender value:** ₹84,51,39,284.72/- **Earnest Money:** ₹1,69,02,800/-.**Date & Time of closing of tender:** At **14.30** hrs. **& opening at: 15.30** hrs. on **18-11-2026.** The complete information and tender document of above e-Tender will be available at **www.ireps.gov.in**

Chief Engineer/Con/Manipur Project, Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
(Construction Organisation)
Serving Customers With A Smile

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No. NIT/2026-27/0449-77 Date: 14.10.2026

आपरक्षणीय ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 424/2026-27

विस्तृतनिविदा पार्थनाओं का प्रपत्र वाहनों हेतु ई टेरिटरिंग प्रणाली से ऑनलाईन विधिवत अवलोकन की जावे है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु.)
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following:- Jaipur Bhilwara (SH-12) BOT Road" for a period of 01 Year. UBK: RRC26275LC000699	5223.05 Lakh

विस्तृत ये सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र ये निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, राजस्थान करने व प्रक्रिया की सामान्य शर्तादि विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in तथा http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक फर्मों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के प्रमाण ये वेबसाईट http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर रजिस्ट्रार कराना आवश्यक है।

महाप्रबन्धक

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in, Mobile No. 96461-55525

E-Tender Enq. No. 7881/P-3/EMP-13458 Dated: 14.10.2026

Dy. Chief Engineer/Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP, Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_177486_1 for Procurement of empty DA gas cylinders for GGSSTP Rupnagar. For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **14.10.2026/5.00 PM** onwards.

Note: Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RTP-102/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16230

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
"Vidyut Bhawan" Near ISBT, Crossing, Saharanpur Road, Majra, Dehradun- 248002
Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Tel. No. 0135-2642711

E-TENDER CORRIGENDUM-1

The pre-bid clarifications of the E-Tender for "Replacement of existing conductor with HTLS conductor" under Package-4 against Tender Specification no. PTCUL/E-Tender/C&P-II/TL-08/2026-27 has been uploaded on e-tender website. For more details please visit the e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in (tender id no. 2026_PTCU4_100499_1)** and for e-tender corrigendum notice our website **www.ptcul.org.** All other terms and conditions shall remain same.

For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Ro.no 1963/HQPU/PTCUL. Dated 14.10.2026 Superintending Engineer (C&P-II)

"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF NATION"

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, नगर वृत, जोधपुर

क्रमांक: 2094 दिनांक: 08.10.2026

बोली सूचना संख्या: 02 वर्ष 2026-27

NIB No. PWD2627A3267

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से **विभिन्न भवनिपेचेवल/मिसिंग लिंक सड़कों का निर्माण कार्य** हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/ताक एवम् दूर संचार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ईटेण्डरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाईन बोली आमंत्रित की जाती है।

बोली से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेबसाईट **http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in** व **http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** व **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण बोली प्रक्रिया **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर ऑनलाईन सम्पादित की जावेगी। कार्यवार यू.बी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।

1.	PWD2627WSOB14751	2.	PWD2627WSOB14752

(अनिल सोनी)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता,
सा.नि.वि. नगर वृत, जोधपुर

DIPR/C/17627/2026

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
"Vidyut Bhawan" Near ISBT, Crossing, Saharanpur Road, Majra, Dehradun- 248002
Corporate ID U40101UR2004SGC028675 Tel. No. 0135-2642711

E-TENDER CORRIGENDUM-1

The pre-bid clarifications of the E-Tender for "Augmentation of Transformer capacity at 132 kV S/s Kashipur, 220 kV S/s Kamaluaganja, Haldwani, 132 kV S/s Kathgodam, Haldwani and 132 kV S/s Kichha in kumaon Zone under Package-2" against Tender Specification no. PTCUL/E-Tender/C&P-II/SS-06/2026-27 has been uploaded on e-tender website. For more details please visit the e-tender website www.uktenders.gov.in (tender id no. 2026 PTCU4_100166 1) and for e-tender corrigendum notice our website www.ptcul.org.

For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Ro 1962/HQPU/PTCUL/ Superintending Engineer (C&P-II)
Dated 14.10.2026 "Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"

भुसावळ नगरपरिषद, भुसावळ
ता. भुसावळ जिल्हा – जळगाव
Phone No - 02582-225403 Toll Free No-1800 233 5264
Website:www.bhusawalnp.org / Email-id-bmcbsl1882@gmail.com

जा.क्र./भुनप/आरोग्य/१४९/२०२६ दिनांक :- १५/१०/२०२६

Extension of E- Tender Notice 01

Bhusawal Municipal Council, Health department invites E-Tender Notice for the Collecting wet and dry waste from households and businesses for Bhusawal Municipal Council, Dist-Jalgaon for more details, terms and conditions given in tender id no.2026_DMA_1337180_1 is to be retender and new tender id no.2026_DMA_1337180_2 Please log on to website http://mahatenders.gov.in.

Date:- 15/10/2026
Place:- Bhusawal Municipal Council

Sd/-
Chief Officer
Muncipal council Bhusawal

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

GUJARAT ENERGY

Gujarat Energy Limited (GEL), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description
354397	Supply, Installation and Configuration of Secure Internet Proxy Solution for Gujarat Energy Limited
354399	Supply & Installation of Backup Appliances at PR & DR DC of GEL with Licenses for a period of 5 Years
353437	Appointment of Service Provider For Centralized Customer Call Centre (CCCC) for GEL operating area
353747	GIS Data Create, Capture, Develop And Update Land & Gas Features In GEL GIS Database
354121	Appointment of service provider for Environment related jobs & services for GEL Natural Gas facilities

Interested bidders can access the Tender Documents and related updates on **https://geltender.nprocure.com** and **https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/.** Interested bidders are advised to regularly visit above websites to stay updated on the aforementioned tender.

SURAT MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT

Online Quotation Notice No. SWM/ DMC/ 14/ 2026-27

Online Quotations are invited on **www.suratmunicipal.gov.in** for the various works of Solid Waste management, from the various Agency.

	Name of the Department	Solid Waste Management
2	No of the works	01
3	Total Estimated Cost of quotation Rs. in Lacs	-

The detail Tender Notice will be made available at above address and on website **www.suratmunicipal.gov.in**

No. PR.O./291/2026-27
Date: 14/10/2026

Deputy Commissioner
Surat Municipal Corporation

WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of West Bengal Enterprise)
WBSETCL
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhavan, Block-DJ, Sector-II, Bidhannagar, Kolkata-700091
CIN: U40101WB2007SGC113474 • web: www.wbsetcl.in

NIT No.: CE(P)WBSETCL/Line Pkg-C11 (2nd call)/26-27/32 Date: 16.10.2026

Under the jurisdiction of Chief Engineer (Procurement)

Work Details, Route Length & Completion Period	Description of Work
PROJECT-I	To-Tender is invited for construction of 400 kV D/C Transmission Line with twin HTLS (equivalent to Quad Moose) to make LILO of one circuit of Arambag-New PPSP 400 kV D/C at proposed Generation Station of JSW (Salboni).
RL = 68 K.M. OH (approx.) SC = 1.8 K.M. OH (approx.)	
24 months from the date of placement of LOA	

Bid documents can be downloaded from 16.10.2026, 11:00 A.M. and bids shall be submitted online up to 03:00 P.M., 11.11.2026. Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details. ICA-T19113(3)/2026

DELHI POLLUTION CONTROL COMMITTEE
DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENT,
(GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI)
3RD FLOOR, BLOCK-1, DMRC IT-PARK, SHASTRI PARK, DELHI-110053
Visit us at: http://dpcc.delhi.govt.in/

LiFE Lifestyle for Environment

F. No. ENV-A0Air/22/2026-O/o SSO-1-DoEnv/21 Date: 8.10.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Delhi Pollution Control Committee invites open e-tenders for **Deployment of innovative technologies on a pilot-field basis to abate outdoor ambient air pollution at the forty (40) sites identified in Delhi.**

Details of the scope of work, requirement, eligibility, and instructions are available in the tender document, which can be downloaded from **https://bidplus.gem.gov.in/all-bids (Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8047889)** and the DPCC website **https://dpcc.delhi.gov.in**

Member Secretary
Delhi Pollution Control Committee

SC issues notice to EC, its chiefs on Oppn plea seeking inquiry

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday issued notice to the Election Commission of India (ECI) and the three election commissioners on a petition filed by Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and 12 other INDIA bloc leaders seeking an independent, timebound inquiry into alleged electoral irregularities and the functioning of the poll panel.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi, however, issued a provisional notice to Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Raut, a co-petitioner in the case, asking him to explain his statements against the CJI after he declined to meet Opposition leaders seeking to raise concerns over ECI.

The court clarified the notice did not amount to a condemnation of Raut's conduct and that it would examine the issue after hearing his explanation.

"Issuing notice does not mean that we are condemning anything. We are issuing notice. But regarding one of the petitioners, we will definitely entertain the issue," said the bench, adding that the notice against Raut was provisional and subject to his explaining his conduct at the next hearing.

Raut's remarks came on October 12, after the CJI declined to meet Gandhi and Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, the Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, who had sought an audience to submit a memorandum on the functioning of ECI and the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

"The Chief Justice, whose role is to safeguard the Constitution, is unwilling to meet us...When we are seeking to save democracy amidst the theft of votes and electoral fraud, and the deletion of millions of names from the rolls and wish to meet you to voice our grievance, you say you will not meet politicians. The people will remember this," Raut had told reporters.

Calling the episode a "misfortune for the Constitution and democracy of this country", he had said that people would remember the CJI's refusal to meet the Opposition leaders.

The petition was filed after the CJI indicated that the Opposition leaders' concerns could be raised through appropriate judicial proceedings rather than through a meeting with the court's head.

The plea alleges that chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar took several decisions unilaterally, raising questions about compliance with Article 324 of the Constitution and Section 18 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, which provides for decision-making by majority in the event of a disagreement among the commissioners.

The Opposition leaders have sought a timebound, independent inquiry into the disputed decisions, including the June 2025 decision to conduct the SIR exercise, and an interim suspension of the ongoing revision pending the inquiry.

Referring to a media report that election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected to Kumar's alleged unilateral decision-making on 14 occasions over 10 months, the petition seeks production of the complete files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections recorded by the two commissioners on the disputed decisions.

It also seeks an independent committee headed by a retired Supreme Court judge, along with technical experts and civil society members, to examine the poll panel's decisions, policies, procedures and technical architecture relating to electronic voting machines.

The petitioners have clarified that they are not seeking to reopen the Supreme Court's decision upholding the validity of the 2025 SIR exercise in Bihar. Instead, they want the court to examine whether individual decisions taken during its implementation complied with constitutional and statutory safeguards governing the functioning of ECI. The petition, filed through advocate S Prasanna, names ECI, Kumar, Sandhu and Joshi as respondents.

LoP Rahul Gandhi led a march towards the Supreme Court on October 12 against the functioning of the election commission. HT

SC agrees to examine plea on curbs for stir near court complexes

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday asserted that "nobody can browbeat the judiciary" as it agreed to examine a plea seeking a regulatory framework for protests and processions in the vicinity of the top court and other judicial complexes, in the wake of an October 12 march by Opposition leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, and their supporters towards the Supreme Court over alleged electoral irregularities and the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

THE RULING COMES IN THE WAKE OF A PROTEST MARCH LED BY LOP RAHUL GANDHI ON OCT 12 TOWARDS THE SUPREME COURT

A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi issued notice on the petition, which also seeks criminal contempt proceedings against Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav and Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra, among others. However, the court made it clear that it was not initiating contempt proceedings at this stage.

"No contempt today. We are only issuing notices. Let us see what the response is, and then we will take it forward," the bench told senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, who pressed for notice on the contempt plea, arguing that such an incident should not recur within the precincts of the Supreme Court.

Bhatia, appearing for the petitioners, said it was unacceptable that the court had to deal with political processions near its premises and that lawyers were anguished by what had transpired on October 12. He referred to a memorandum signed by around 200 lawyers expressing concern over what they described as an attempt to browbeat the judiciary through scandalising statements.

"These are fragile statements and nobody can browbeat the judiciary," retorted the CJI.

Bhatia responded that he had complete faith in the judiciary but that any attempt to browbeat it was itself a matter of concern. He also sought action over statements allegedly made by political leaders outside the court, saying the vicinity and precincts of the Supreme Court had to be protected. "We are not sitting in ivory towers. We know what statements they make outside and what they say in Court. We know everything," replied the CJI, adding that the court was cognisant of the developments.

The bench also directed all law enforcement agencies to preserve CCTV footage and any other digital material collected in connection with the October 12 incident. The petition also refers to the conduct of demonstrators near the court premises, including an allegation that a pregnant journalist was pushed during the march.

The two voter roll revisions

SPECIAL SUMMARY REVISION (SSR)	WHAT IT DOES	SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION (SIR)
Updates the existing rolls		Rebuilds voter rolls from scratch
METHODOLOGY		
Individual applies for inclusion, deletion, or correction		House-to-house visit by BLOs for enumeration
FOCUS AREA		
Corrections in rolls, addition of first-time voters		Purification of rolls by eliminating deceased, shifted, duplicate entries
HOW OFTEN		
Annually		First since 2002-04

Abhijeet Dipke

DIPKE ACCUSES PM OF 'SHIELDING' CEC GYANESH AMID PROTESTS

Jignasa Sinha
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Thursday accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi of shielding chief election commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and putting him above students, youngsters, Opposition leaders and thousands of protesters who have been staging demonstrations over the alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Delhi.

Dipke along with other student outfits have called for a flag march (Tiranga Yatra) at Connaught Place on October 16 after the arrest of CJP leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka for tresspassing into Jantar Mantar, which has recently been denotified as a protest site.

"Narendra Modi had put all his systems, machinery and resources to save Gyanesh Kumar. In the last 10-15 days, all student organisations and youth are fighting on streets but they are being dragged... Even Opposition came on ground and they were also detained... On October 10, it was a rare historical event. All for whom? Gyanesh. What is Gyanesh giving Narendra Modi that he is ready to block entire Delhi. Modi-Shah have now waged a war against their own citizens. Why? For Gyanesh?"

"You are detaining people, your police is dragging students and opposition leaders on the streets. Declare an official emergency. Are you scared of your public image...? What happened to Har Ghar Tiranga? Ranka and Das were picked up for unfurling the flag. How is it violation of peace. Is Gyanesh more important than the national flag?" the CJP founder said.

SC refuses to club Maha SIR and Rahul's plea

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday refused to list a petition challenging the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Maharashtra along with the plea filed by Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA bloc leaders challenging the Election Commission of India's controversial exercise, saying it will hear the matter state-wise.

"The problem is that there cannot be a generalised challenge to SIR. We have to look at it state-wise," said Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, after senior advocate Arvind Datar mentioned the plea challenging SIR process in Maharashtra before the court.

Datar sought an urgent listing of the petition, saying that SIR data from Maharashtra was shocking as around 20 million out of the 97.9 million total voters in the state have been deleted from the draft rolls and another 12.2 million electors have been struck off under "logical discrepancies". The lawyer pointed out that the situation was particularly serious in Mumbai and Pune, where over 40% of the total electors stand deleted.

Stating that the matter was shown as listed for October 26, Datar urged the court if it could be taken up along with the petition filed by Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders seeking an independent, timebound inquiry into alleged electoral irregularities and the functioning of ECI, and an interim suspension of the ongoing SIR pending the inquiry.

"We will not list it today. We will go through the data that you have produced. We have to concentrate on Maharashtra. Then we have to deal with the Delhi issues. We will list it some other day," the CJI remarked.

The senior advocate — who mentioned the petition filed by one Arun Anandagiri, a chartered accountant and journalist — urged the court to issue notice in order for ECI, Centre and the Maharashtra government to file a response by October 26, when the court is expected to take up the matter. The apex court, however, refused to accept this suggestion as well.

The top court said it will hear SIR-related matters state-wise.

Of the 97,854,049 electors in the pre-SIR rolls, 20,688,487 voters, or 21.14%, were placed in the ASDDO (absent, shifted, dead, duplicate, other) category in Maharashtra's draft electoral rolls published on August 31, 2026. The final electoral rolls are scheduled to be published on November 16.

On Thursday, a bench of chief justice Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi, issued notice to ECI and the three election commissioners, including chief election commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, on the petition filed by Rahul Gandhi and 12 other INDIA bloc leaders.

The plea alleges that CEC Gyanesh Kumar took several decisions unilaterally.

Referring to a media report that election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected to Kumar's alleged unilateral decision-making on 14 occasions over 10 months, the petition seeks production of the complete files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections recorded by the two commissioners on the disputed decisions.

The petition against Maharashtra SIR states that till the issue is adjudicated by the top court, the exercise in the state should be kept in abeyance.

SC blocks 'coercive action' against journo

Abraham Thomas and Shruti Kakkar
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday directed that no coercive action be taken against a woman journalist accused of making casteist remarks against Delhi Police assistant commissioner of police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat, after she alleged that the case against her was a counterblast to her complaint accusing the officer of sexual harassment during a protest in the Capital.

The order came on a day the Delhi High Court declined to hear urgently the journalist's plea challenging the FIR against her for allegedly making casteist remarks, publicly humiliating Bhagat and obstructing him from discharging his official duties. However, the bench agreed to hear the matter on Friday.

A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi was hearing a petition filed by the Network of Women in Media, India (NWMI), which flagged allegations of violence and sexual harassment faced by women journalists covering protests in Delhi on October 10 and earlier.

The petitioner, represented by senior advocate Indira Jaising, was allowed to submit in a sealed cover the identities of all women journalists who were victims and wished to submit complaints in writing. Jaising said that since the allegation was against police personnel, an independent commission be constituted, comprising former women judges, Indian Police Service (IPS) officers, eminent citizens and social activists.

The court said, "Meanwhile, no coercive action be taken against the journalist," and further allowed Jaising to submit in a sealed cover her suggestions on persons who could be part of the committee. "There are allegations against certain police officers. We are considering whether there must be an independent committee to probe them," the court remarked.

It also raised questions about the scope of protections that should be extended to journalists covering protests.

'Select few' to be allowed to march today; 6k cops for Delhi

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NEW DELHI: Delhi Police will deploy more than 6,000 personnel in and around Connaught Place and central Delhi on Friday, ahead of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) proposed "Lehra Do Tiranga" protest, even as officials said that a "select few people" could be allowed to conduct a march at a "suitable place".

The local police deployment will be in addition to around 26,000 personnel of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) stationed in the Capital over the past week following the CJP's call for protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

Together, around 32,000 security personnel are expected to be deployed across central Delhi on Friday, according to people familiar with the matter.

During the October 10 protest, Delhi Police had deployed around 5,000 personnel in the New Delhi district, which includes Connaught Place, Rajiv Chowk, Central Park, nearby metro stations, Jantar Mantar and Palika Bazaar.

THE LOCAL POLICE DEPLOYMENT WILL BE IN ADDITION TO AROUND 26,000 PERSONNEL OF THE CENTRAL ARMED POLICE FORCES STATIONED IN THE CAPITAL

The sweeping security arrangements come after CJP convenor Abhijeet Dipke announced the flag march following the arrest of co-convenors Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka on Tuesday morning. Both were sent to five days of judicial custody. The march, scheduled for 5pm on October 16, is expected to be joined by Dipke, student organisations, activists and the AAP.

Neha Yadav, deputy commissioner of police and public relations officer, said police had not granted permission for a large march and had imposed prohibitory restrictions under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) in Connaught Place and surrounding areas.

"Given the current security situation, a prohibitory order under Section 163 of the BNSS is already in effect in Connaught Place and surrounding areas. NDMC has informed the Delhi Police that Central Park will remain closed on October 16 and 17," she added.

Yadav said the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) had also sought security arrangements to prevent unauthorised entry into the park. Trade and market associations in and around Connaught Place had submitted written requests for protection of their shops and establishments, she said. "Various trade and market associations in and around CP have given us in writing, seeking protection for their shops and establishments," Yadav said, adding that the associations.

"We appeal to everyone not to join any such gathering which violates the BNSS guideline or affects peace," she said.

HC rejects Vijayan, others' pleas to file appeal in CMRL case

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Pinarayi Vijayan

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The Kerala high court on Thursday refused to permit former chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan and his family to challenge the single-judge order directing the Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) to register an FIR against them in the alleged CMRL bribery case.

A bench of justices K Natarajan and Johnson John also rejected the applications filed by Vijayan, his daughter Veena and his son-in-law and CPI(M) MLA PA Mohammed Riyas to file an appeal against the single judge's October 9 order, while holding that "an accused in a corruption case has no legal right to be heard before registering the FIR." It said since applications are dismissed, their appeals are consequently also dismissed.

The court also said when sufficient material disclosing commission of cognizable offences is furnished along with the information under section 66(2) of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) 2002 by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), there is no necessity for conducting a preliminary inquiry. The bench said that the October 9 order "has not affected the applicants' rights to pursue the constitutional statutory remedy against the registration of the FIR." In its judgement, the court said as long as cognizance of an offence is not taken, a writ petition under Article 226 of the Constitution to quash the FIR can be filed.

Markets, schools shut after Bandh call in Pjb

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BATHINDA: A statewide 'bandh' call in Punjab on Thursday over the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota in Mansa evoked a strong response with markets and educational institutions remaining shut and protesters blocking roads at several places, even as chief minister Bhagwant Mann asserted that no one will be spared for the crime.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi took to X to attack CM Mann over the incident, saying: "Raising a voice against drugs in Punjab has now become a death sentence. And this is happening under the rule of Bhagwant Mann's AAP government."

Ashwani Kumar, the store owner who opened fire on Jhota on Tuesday after he questioned him for selling addictive drugs to an elderly man, was taken into custody from Salasar in Rajasthan on Wednesday. His shop was set on fire by a mob while authorities razed a portion of his house.

Jhota's family had given the 'Punjab Bandh' call from 6 am till 5 pm with support from the Congress, Akali Dal, BJP and Akali Dal Waris Punjab De, the Samyukta Kisan Morcha and other farmer unions, and some state government employee bodies.

In response to the bandh call, shops and markets remained shut at several places, including Hoshiarpur, Amritsar, Ferozepur, Ludhiana, Jalandhar, Sangrur, Barnala, Moga, Patiala and Mansa. However, emergency services remained operational.

Several toll plazas, including in Ludhiana and Patiala, did not charge any fee from the commuters in support of the bandh call. Many private schools in Hoshiarpur, Jalandhar, Moga and Mansa declared a holiday in view of the shutdown. Meanwhile, Mansa SSP Vaibhav Choudhary on Thursday issued the suspension order for SHO Beant Kaur amid demands for action against certain police officers.

IRCTC to offer tiger safari tour packages

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MUMBAI: Indian Railways has joined the tiger safari bandwagon in Maharashtra, with the Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) tying up with the Maharashtra Forest Department to offer wildlife tour packages at Tadoba and Pench tiger reserves.

The package will include confirmed safari permits. "We have named this tour package, Vandarshan. It will commence on November 19. It will be our first such initiative, combining rail travel, accommodation, local transport and wildlife safari in a single package," said an IRCTC official.

IRCTC has planned five itineraries covering mainly Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve and Pench Tiger Reserve, with visits to Bor Tiger Reserve, Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve, Umred-Paoni-Karhandla Wildlife Sanctuary and Tipeshwar Wildlife Sanctuary. Each itinerary is designed as a 4-night, 5-day tour, with onward travel from Mumbai on the Vidarbha Express (12105), departing every Thursday, and return travel on train 12106 from Gondia every Sunday. Boarding and return stations will depend on the selected package. The packages have limited availability; IRCTC is allocating six berths in 3AC and six in 2AC for each departure.

Each itinerary is designed as a 4-night, 5-day tour. HT FILE PIC

"Wildlife safaris are subject to forest regulations, making advance confirmation an important consideration for visitors planning trips during peak holiday periods," the official said.

U'khand min accuses husband of conspiring to murder her, bigamy

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DEHRADUN: Uttarakhand women and child development minister Rekha Arya on Thursday accused her husband Girdhari Lal Sahu of forgery, caste-based harassment and conspiring to murder her, prompting the police to register a first information report (FIR) against him, officers said.

In her complaint to the police, Arya alleged that Sahu had concealed his earlier marriage before entering into a union with her and having relationship with other women. She alleged that Sahu, in collusion with another woman, was plotting to kill her, according to her complaint.

Arya, the BJP legislator from Someshwar, also alleged that Sahu forged her signature on various documents to remove her from certain positions, despite her not having submitted any resignation. The offences, according to her complaint, took place over an extended period from July 6, 2004, to October 15, 2026.

The FIR, registered at the Cantonment police station in Dehradun on her complaint, charges Sahu of forgery, cheating, criminal conspiracy, bigamy, cruelty by a husband, and criminal intimidation under relevant sections of the Indian Penal Code (IPC), as well as charges under the SC and ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, police said, adding that inspector Santosh Singh Kunwar was heading the probe in the case.

Arya posted a video statement on Facebook and also shared two audio of purported phone calls of her husband with some woman. HT could not independently verify the veracity of the audio recordings.

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{ OUR TAKE }

Caste, faith, and affirmative action

The apex court has drawn a line on the legal debate around backwardness and conversion, but the social debate is far from settled

The Supreme Court's decision to uphold a Madras High Court verdict — scrapping a Tamil Nadu government order allowing individuals from backward classes and denotified communities to claim reservation after converting to Islam — might have limited immediate effect but it lays down crucial guardrails that will shape the contentious intersection of caste, faith and affirmative action. Making a clear distinction between the Hindu social order and the non-Hindu social order, the Court underscored three key aspects.

First, while the top court has previously adjudicated on Scheduled Caste Christian conversions, this is a rare verdict connecting conversions and other backward classes — a far bigger chunk of both the reservation pie and the Indian population. Earlier this year, the top court held that conversion to Christianity and other religions results in the loss of SC status. The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 and its 1956 amendment — which explicitly restrict SC status to Hindus, Sikhs and Buddhists — provide a degree of clarity to the SC debate. For OBC communities, the absence of such an order makes their status more fluid.

Two, the court's observation — that a person converting to a non-Hindu social order cannot claim backward class quota solely based on their pre-conversion status — requires more clarification on the nature of assessment that will be necessary. This is especially important given that several states have included a number of Muslim communities in their OBC groups; in some states, such as West Bengal, this has even led to legal trouble. Will the latest order make it more difficult for newer groups to be included?

Three, the court might have drawn a line on the legal debate around backwardness and conversion, but the social debate is far from settled. The 2006 Rajinder Sachar committee underlined the social and economic vulnerabilities of large chunks of the Muslim community. The 2007 Ranganath Mishra commission recommended that SC status be made religion-neutral based on similar reasons. A 2008 National Minorities Commission report also found that Dalit converts to Christianity and Islam continue to endure economic deprivations, occupational segregation, and social isolation comparable to their Hindu brethren. Clearly, there appears to be some chasm between the legal status of affirmative action and conversions — both for backwards and Dalits — and the social realities of many who are unable to shake off their marginalisation even after changing their faith. A wider debate will help turn polarising positions towards more nuance.

Parks only for women are not the solution

There are many arguments that can be made against the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's recent decision to designate women-only parks in the city. Notwithstanding a lukewarm response to a previous attempt — the "pink" park near Ramlila Maidan has fallen into disrepair — there is also the matter of an inadequate number of security guards, CCTV cameras, and gardeners. Most MCD parks lie in residential areas, making this directive further unfeasible. The MCD must also answer basic questions on safety measures that it will undertake in mixed-gender parks and, more significantly, the basis of its claim that segregation of spaces results in safety.

Urban planners would, in fact, draw our attention to how the larger vision of any society is to move from exclusion to inclusion of citizens, irrespective of their class, caste, gender or sexuality. And while gendered spaces such as women-only train compartments or girls' schools are necessary to ensure women's access to mobility and education, segregation of public spaces requires a more nuanced approach. By pinning the decision on safety, we validate the idea that social interaction between genders is the core issue, leading to the assumption that safety needs eliminating the opportunity for this. Besides the misogyny inherent in this viewpoint, there's also a blindspot: Everyone — and not just women — deserves to feel safe in the city, especially in public spaces. Infrastructure is part of the solution. While perpetrators of violence operate with impunity regardless of the space, unlit streets and park-spots, inadequate and intemperate policing, etc, make it harder for survivors to get justice.

Safety does not come from the perception of its existence. It comes from swift reprisal for crimes, equitable access to justice, and a recognition that we all constitute the body public.

Indispensable partners, unfinished business

Beyond investment, India and Japan must build the missing middle of suppliers, skills and institutions

Ashish Dhawan

Prachi Mishra

"India and Japan are natural and indispensable partners," the two countries' leaders declared at their 16th Annual Summit held earlier this year. The relationship is now backed by a 10-trillion yen target for private Japanese investment in India over the next decade; an Economic Security Initiative spanning critical minerals, semiconductors, information and communication technology (ICT) and Artificial Intelligence (AI), clean energy and pharmaceuticals; new cooperation on batteries, mobility and technology; and the first significant India-Japan defence co-development project.

Both governments have also agreed to review the 2011 Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, recognising that 15 years on, economic ties have not kept pace with the diplomatic relationship. Japan still sources less than 1% of its merchandise imports from India, scarcely changed in four decades. Japan's share of India's imports has slipped from over 10% to about 2.5%, and of India's exports from roughly 11% to 1.5%.

Investment is more encouraging: India's share of Japan's outbound investment has risen from 0.1% in the mid-1990s to about 4%. But nearly three-fifths of it lies outside manufacturing, with finance and insurance alone accounting for over a third. Within manufacturing, transport equipment, led by Suzuki's early bet on Maruti, makes up more than half. Electronics and machinery together are barely 9% of the total.

What remains missing is the middle: the suppliers, intermediaries, institutions and people that turn headline commitment into a working factory, a qualified vendor, or a filled job. Japanese investment has built impressive plants in India but remains shallowly rooted in the local supplier base. The opportunity is to deepen these roots.

The complementarities are sharpest where supply chains are most fragile. Take semiconductors. India has committed ₹76,000 crore (about $7.8 billion) in incentives to build a chip industry. Japan is the leading exporter of the machinery and inputs needed to make chips. Yet India sources over 60% of its chipmaking equipment from China. A dedicated channel, with Japanese tools flowing to India and Indian chips flowing back to Japan, would make both countries less vulnerable.

More than 90% of refined rare-earth supply is concentrated in China. Japan launched a $1.1 billion diversification drive after a 2010 supply disruption, yet China still supplies about half its rare-earth imports. Resilience takes years. India holds the world's third-largest reserves but refines a sliver of what it can mine: 5,000 tonnes of refining capacity against 10 million tonnes of mining capacity. Japan invented the neodymium magnet and still supplies 8.8% of the world's permanent magnets. A rare-earth corridor, with Japanese firms refining and making magnets in India using Indian engineering talent, would broaden Japan's sources of supply and seed a supply chain for India's own EVs and electronics.

Resilience means having no single point of failure. India and Japan can become each other's second source and, in time, the first.

Japanese manufacturing runs on long-standing supplier relationships. Indian small firms often find these networks hard to enter: Qualification cycles are long, quality norms unfamiliar, and information gaps wide. Closing them needs patient intermediation: supplier-development programmes run jointly by Japanese anchor firms and Indian industry bodies; shared testing and certification facilities in industrial clusters; and platforms that match Japanese corporates with Indian startups. Joint labs between Japanese companies and Indian universities would give Indian firms a stake in the technology, not merely the assembly.

The third complementarity is demographic. Japan's ageing population has left industries short of workers; India has a vast young workforce it is racing to skill. Yet Indians make up just 0.3% of interns under Japan's Technical Intern Training Program (TITP).

The opportunity of the next decade is to let trade, capital and people move freely enough to build true resilience. HT ARCHIVE

That programme is being replaced from 2027 by the Employment for Skill Development (ESD) system, which allows workers to change employers and offers a route to longer-term status — a welcome reform, and one India should position itself for early rather than late. India can build a pipeline into ESD to fill Japan's labour gaps, through Japanese-language training in Industrial Training Institutes and polytechnics and mutual skills recognition. Sparing Indians this year's visa-fee increase helped; easier pathways for students and researchers can follow. People who know both countries are precisely the intermediaries the missing middle lacks.

A fourth complementarity lies in capital itself. Japan's Government Pension Investment Fund, with nearly $2 trillion in assets, allocates 30% to the US and less than 1% to India. Japanese investors account for about 3% of foreign portfolio holdings in Indian securities. As Indian markets deepen and join global bond indices, even a modest reallocation by Japanese pension funds, insurers and households would be large by Indian standards.

Finally, the two countries need a clear way to track results. Every initiative must carry measurable targets, from Indian suppliers qualified into Japanese chains and magnets made in India to interns placed and Japanese institutional capital invested, reviewed publicly at each annual summit. A joint delivery unit, working with state governments, could clear bottlenecks. An updated trade agreement can address what still slows business: standards, certification and visas.

Kautilya advised rulers to turn to trusted friends in hard times. At the Kautilya Economic Conclave, external affairs minister S Jaishankar pointed to Japan as an example of India opening to transparent, mature markets with greater purchasing power. The opportunity of the next decade is to let trade, capital and people move freely enough to build true resilience.

Ashish Dhawan is founding chairperson, Board of Trustees, Ashoka University, Delhi-NCR, and Prachi Mishra is dean, Rakesh Jhunjhunwala School of Economics and Finance, and professor of economics, Ashoka University, Delhi-NCR. This article draws on the research paper "Closing the gap: What India and Japan Could Build Together", by Prachi Mishra, Maitreyee Mohile, and Shubhangi Sahai, featured in the Iron Pillar India–Japan Economic Corridor Report. The authors thank the ICPP team for contributions. The views expressed are personal

India & the UK: From ties of history to scripting a future

Lindy Cameron

As I leave India after more than two years as British high commissioner to this extraordinary country, I do so with mixed emotions. I am extremely proud of everything we have achieved but equally it is so difficult to say goodbye to a country that has welcomed me so warmly, challenged me intellectually, and left me with memories that will last a lifetime.

We have a lot of history, but this recent chapter has been all about looking ahead.

The signing of Vision 2035 and the entry into force of our landmark Free Trade Agreement (FTA) have signalled a new era of cooperation between two of the world's largest and most innovative economies. More than just words on paper, these represent a shared recognition that a future facing, mutually beneficial partnership creates enormous opportunities for Indians and Brits alike.

The FTA will increase India's and the UK's GDP by nearly 5 billion pounds annually, and we have already seen deals worth nearly 12 billion pounds announced since it was signed last year, supporting thousands of jobs across both countries. This week, three UK Cabinet ministers, eight mayors and local government leaders from northern England, and a major delegation of over 100 British businesses, universities, investors and innovators travelled to India to deepen partnerships here and take advantage of the trade deal. Their visit is recognition that India matters to the whole of the UK.

I have heard India described as the most optimistic country in the world, and I couldn't agree more. From major metropolitan centres to emerging regional hubs, I have witnessed the energy of a nation defining its future with confidence and ambition. Fantastic startups, world-class research institutions and an exceptionally talented young population are driving growth on a scale few countries can match.

I, too, am extremely optimistic about the future of India, as well as where the UK's partnership with India is headed next. Through our Technology Security Initiative, we are working together on shaping and securing the technologies of tomorrow, including artificial intelligence and critical minerals.

Much like the rest of the world, the UK has a massive interest in India being the biggest, best version of itself, and of being part of that journey. HT ARCHIVE

In education, it's truly been thrilling to see nine world-leading UK universities announce plans to open campuses across the country, growing opportunities and access for thousands more students and researchers. And I know, there are just as many waiting in the wings.

One of the most promising opportunities ahead, I believe, lies in defence collaboration, with Rolls-Royce announcing their intent to partner with Reliance Industries to develop indigenous combat engine for India's Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft programme. It is a genuinely groundbreaking opportunity to bring world-leading British engine capability to India, and to move our partnership toward co-development and co-production.

What gives me greatest optimism, however, is not any single agreement or initiative. It is the spirit in which this partnership has evolved during my time here. There is genuine warmth between our governments, businesses, institutions and people. There is a shared recognition that our economies are complementary, our interests increasingly aligned and our ambitions mutually reinforcing. Most importantly, there is a belief that the best years of the UK-India story still lie ahead.

The future of this partnership, too, will not be shaped by our governments alone. It will be shaped by our people. It will be built by entrepreneurs creating new businesses, researchers developing new technologies, universities educating future leaders, and cities and regions forging closer connections with one another.

The tragic Air India crash in Ahmedabad last year brought home the deep personal connections between the UK and India. Families in both our countries mourned together, and our shared grief reflected the closeness of a relationship built on people, family and friendship. This was a tragedy that touched both the UK and India profoundly. In grief, as in so many other moments, our countries stood together in support of the families and loved ones affected.

I leave immensely grateful for the friendships I have received in India, the journeys I've made across the breadth of this beautiful country, and the lessons I have learned along the way. India is truly amazing and there's no doubt loads more to understand, but I leave knowing that the relationship between our countries has never been more confident, more ambitious or more future-focussed.

India will remain central to the UK's economic and strategic future. Equally, the UK is determined to be a trusted, long-term partner in India's continued success. Much like the rest of the world, the UK has a massive interest in India being the biggest, best version of itself, and of being part of that journey.

As I bid goodbye, I am sad to leave but excited about the next chapter. I leave convinced of two things: I'll most certainly be back. And that the next chapter in the UK-India partnership will be even more significant than the one we have just begun to write. Because the opportunities ahead are truly immense.

Lindy Cameron is British high commissioner to India. The views expressed are personal

{ S JAISHANKAR } EXTERNAL AFFAIRS MINISTER

The reform of multilateralism is urgent. It can be supported through stronger minilateralism. The India-UAE partnership of the last decade is a great example

AI gets cheaper, but human thought remains priceless

Amit Kapoor

Sheen Zutshi

A recent publication from Epoch AI, authored by Luke Emberson and David Roodman and titled "*The Plunging Price of Thought*", estimated that the cost of achieving a fixed level of artificial intelligence (AI) performance has fallen by roughly 47% each quarter, about a 13-fold decline each year. The paper measures the price of thought as a commodity. It asks: For a given level of measured performance, what is the cheapest available model capable of achieving it? This is closer to a quality-adjusted technological price frontier.

The authors estimated that AI prices fell four times faster than DNA sequencing, 18 times faster than lithium-ion batteries, and 54 times faster than electricity. These results come from five benchmarks that cover mathematics, hard science, and game skills. The pace varies across benchmarks, with costs falling roughly 39-43% per quarter for game-based puzzles and 50-52% faster for mathematics problems. Overall, the findings suggest no general-purpose technology has become so cheap so quickly.

The research finds that frontier performance depreciates fastest when it first debuts as the state-of-the-art across five benchmarks; capability costs fall about 66% per quarter initially, slowing to 32% after two years. This pattern is pronounced in three benchmarks. But benchmark performance is not synonymous with intelligence. AI models may be deliberately optimised for widely used benchmarks, a practice the paper calls "benchmark-maxxing". The better results we are seeing across the tasks they are trained on could reflect improved training data, post-training test-time reasoning, or greater general capability, in varying proportions. That said, benchmark-maxxing alone cannot explain the result, nor is benchmark performance a clean measure of an underlying quality called intelligence.

One plausible explanation, the authors say, is that the new capability achieved by large language models (LLMs) commands a scarcity premium before competition and engineering improvements rapidly reduce costs. This suggests rapid technological progress, but it doesn't necessarily mean the cost of producing intelligence itself is falling at the same rate.

Frontier economics is moving in the opposite direction. Separate research from EPoch suggests that frontier language-model training costs have risen about 3.5 times annually since 2020, even as reproducing a fixed level of capability has become cheaper. Yesterday's capabilities may cost less to deliver while labs spend more to advance, but cheaper capabilities don't guarantee lower user prices or greater access.

Users ook at benchmark capabilities, but in the end buy the overall package and what it offers, i.e., the product. As the cost of reproducing LLM capability falls, the cost of developing the frontier can rise, and the price consumers pay can follow a different path altogether. This matters most for countries outside the highly concentrated AI frontier. For most countries, the immediate question may be how to absorb technology whose architecture, commercial trends, and technological directions are largely determined elsewhere. This changes the question, especially for economies in the Global South: If AI cognition becomes dramatically cheaper, which domestic factors of production determine whether countries can actually turn it into productivity? One of them is human capability. The technology does not enter an economy in isolation; its effect depends on complementary institutions, infrastructure, and human skill.

AI models' capability has an unusual property as a factor of production. Once created, it can be copied, distilled, and deployed at enormous scale. However, can we say the same for human capability? Developing a capable scientist, engineer, teacher, or researcher still requires decades of education, practice, experience, and rigorous training. India illustrates this challenge. PARAKH's 2024 assessment, covering over 2.1 million students in grades 3, 6, and 9, points to weaknesses in the foundational competencies at later grades, especially mathematics. When these competencies are at their weakest, importing powerful insights from LLMs does not automatically teach people to question, verify, or build on their outputs. AI may replace some forms of human cognition while increasing the value of others: identifying worthwhile questions, forming hypotheses, exercising judgment under uncertainty, conducting experiments, and creating new knowledge to understand real-world use cases. For economies behind the AI frontier, falling costs shift the challenge from model access to building the human and institutional capacity to boost productivity.

We do not yet know whether producing a capable human mind will itself become more expensive, but in a world of abundant, cheap AI, producing thought through AI models is cheap. The economic cost of failing to produce capable human minds could be much higher.

Amit Kapoor is chair, and Sheen Zutshi is research manager, Institute for Competitiveness. The views expressed are personal

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{ FROM PAGE 1 }

NURSERY ADMISSION

formity in admission rules across schools and end confusion over age eligibility.

Until now, schools affiliated to different school boards, including the state board, CBSE, ICSE and IB, had adopted different age criteria and cut-off dates for admission to Class 1.

The move aims to standardise admission rules across all schools boards and is in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the centre's guidelines recommending that children entering Class 1 should be six years or older, said a senior official with the state education department.

The new age criteria will not apply to students already studying in nursery to Class 1 during the 2026-27 academic year. Regular students who have passed the previous class in a recognised school will also be exempt from the age criteria while moving to the next class.

The resolution also allows school heads to grant a relaxation of up to 15 days in the minimum and maximum age limits for admission from nursery to Class 1.

AVIATION RULES

instance, sought to define night duty as midnight to 5am instead of midnight to 6am. Those requests are no longer being pursued, the persons said.

Pilot bodies have pressed for the FDTL as per civil aviation rules to be implemented in full. At a meeting with the DGCA on July 13 this year, chaired by joint director general Maneesh Kumar, representatives of the Federation of Indian Pilots (FIP), Indian Pilots Guild (IPG), Indian Commercial Pilots' Association (ICPA) and ALPA India urged the regulator to avoid further temporary variations. According to the minutes, issued on August 13 and seen by HT, they said airlines had been given sufficient time to increase pilot strength and revise their scheduling systems, and that IndiGo and Air India had adequate pilot strength to implement the second phase without temporary variations. They also sought reinstatement of the provision that states "no leave shall be substituted for weekly rest", saying weekly rest is important for preventing cumulative fatigue. They said the FDTL CAR, dated January 8, 2024, was based on scientific fatigue assessment. "Concerns were raised over several provisions of the FDTL Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR), including those relating to night duty, consecutive night duties, minimum rest periods and weekly rest. A clarity was also sought on the legal implications of changes to the regulations," a senior official aware of the matter, who asked not to be named, said. DGCA asked the pilot bodies to submit their views on the existing variations, to be examined by an internal DGCA committee reporting to the director general, the minutes show.

Pilot bodies filed a contempt petition in the Delhi High Court in December 2025, after the variations were given on FDTL CAR, over the implementation of its order requiring the DGCA to bring the norms into force in two phases: 15 of the 22 clauses from July 1, 2025, and the remaining seven from November 1, 2025.

Queries sent to Air India and IndiGo did not elicit a response.

SPL SUMMARY REVISION

ter to chief electoral officers of 17 regions.

SSRs – where new voters can file form 6 to enter the rolls, file form 7 to object to the inclusion of another person, or file form 8 to correct details and particulars on the roll – is typically an annual affair. Unlike SIR, there is no scrutiny or verification of every existing voter in SSR and only new applications are verified before adding or dropping someone from the list. The exercise is used to bring new voters – those between ages 18 and 19 – into the electoral roll.

But the last time SSR was conducted was in August 2024 and the final roll was published on January 6, 2025.

Transparency activist Anjali Bharadwaj said that the SSR is particularly significant for first-time voters. "SSR provides a structured opportunity for newly eligible citizens to enter the electoral process. Unlike existing voters, who may already have their names on the electoral roll, young citizens turning 18 depend on timely and accessible registration mechanisms to exercise their democratic rights. Any delay in SSR risks creating an administrative gap for this group," she said. This time, though, SSR is also likely to help the millions deleted by the SIR as many of those people are likely to file form 6 to return to the rolls.

The long delay in holding SSR became a focal point of controversy amid anger over SIR, which has already deleted 130 million names across India. These include voters marked in absent, shifted, dead, and duplicate (ASDD) categories. The SIR mass deletions and allegations of mismanagement, dubious software and faulty procedures have fuelled sweeping protests against ECI and chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. In the past two decades, SSRs were held 19 times and SIR only twice – 2002-03 and 2025-26.

BACKWARDNESS QUOTA

pre-conversion status," said a bench of justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar.

"The backwardness suffered in the antecedent social order cannot, by itself, be carried forward so as to confer upon him the status of a backward class in the religion to which he has converted."

The court went further and held that this rule will equally apply to converts belonging to Scheduled Castes. The Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950 confers scheduled caste status on a person who is a Hindu, Sikh, or Buddhist. The court said, "Consequently, upon conversion to a religion not specified therein, such person ceases to possess the Scheduled Caste status attached to his ancestral caste and cannot claim any affirmative-action benefit of a backward class under Article 16(4) of the Constitution which is predicated upon membership of a Scheduled Caste."

In other words, the court emphasised, "A person's pre-conversion caste or community status cannot, merely by reason of conversion, be transposed into membership of a distinct notified Backward Class community in the post-conversion social order."

Justice Mishra said, "Such conversion severs the legal foundation of an entitlement which is specifically conditioned upon membership of that Hindu social order."

All telcos told to display caller names on phone screens from Nov 1

Sejal Sharma
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has directed all telecom operators to display the caller's name, not just the number, on the receiver's phone screen starting November 1.

The October 13 directive on the calling name presentation service (CNAP) applies to all operators holding a licence or authorisation to provide access services across all service areas.

Under the new protocol, all incoming domestic calls will display both the caller's number and name.

If the recipient has saved the caller's number in their contact list, the stored name will appear on the screen. If the number is not saved, the recipient's screen will display the name recorded in the caller's operator records. An international call will show the words "International Call".

According to the order, telecom service providers such as Airtel, Jio, and Vodafone carried out trials for the introduction of the name presentation service in wireless terrestrial networks.

ACCORDING TO THE OCTOBER 13 DIRECTIVE BY DoT, USERS WHO HAVE OPTED FOR CALLING LINE IDENTIFICATION RESTRICTION WILL NOT HAVE THEIR NAMES SHOWN

The implementation covers 4G and higher-generation wireless networks.

The government will consider extending the facility to 2G, 3G and landline networks at a later stage. To power the service, each telecom operator must maintain an updated database linking subscriber names to phone numbers. When a call is placed, the recipient's network will query the caller's operator database in real time to retrieve the registered name.

The DoT directive requires operators to follow a "security-by-design" framework, ensuring that operators delete fetched names immediately after the call terminates and do not retain them. Operators must also make sure their databases and networks can handle the lookups quickly without impacting call quality.

Entities with corporate or bulk mobile connections may be offered the option to display a "preferred name" rather than the name in the operator's records. The chosen name must correspond strictly to a trademark registered in the subscriber's name or a trade name verified on the GST portal.

Users who have opted for calling line identification restriction (CLIR) will not have their names shown. Operators must also set up a system to receive and resolve CNAP-related complaints within a fixed time.

The circular follows recommendations made by the TRAI on February 23, 2024.

K'TAKA CABINET DECIDES TO MOVE SC ON 56% QUOTA STRIKING DOWN

Arun Dev
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: The Karnataka Cabinet on Thursday decided to approach the Supreme Court challenging a high court order that struck down its 56% reservation framework for Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs), even as a committee led by chief minister DK Shivakumar examines whether the state can seek constitutional protection for the law through the Ninth Schedule, according to an official communication.

The Cabinet has decided to file a Special Leave Petition (SLP) against the October 2 verdict. The parallel examination of Ninth Schedule inclusion by the panel, which is yet to be formed, would require action by the Union government, opening a separate political and constitutional route for the state to pursue the enhanced quota.

Indian Council for Cultural Relations
Azad Bhawan, I.P. Estate, New Delhi-110002

Expansion of ICCR Panel of Government Universities/Institutions Empanelment of Central/State Universities/Institutions, IITs, IITs, NITs, Agricultural Institutions, IIMs and Autonomous Institutions

Indian Council for Cultural Relations provides scholarships to foreign students to pursue UG, PG and Ph.D. level courses in its empanelled Government Universities/Institutions. ICCR invites applications to expand its panel of the Universities/Institutions, in the following categories for empanelment with ICCR

a) Central Government Universities
b) State Government Universities
c) Agricultural Universities/Institutions
d) IITs/IIITs/NITs
e) IIMs
f) Autonomous Institutions under the Central Ministries of the Government of India

Detailed eligibility criteria along-with Application Form may be accessed at www.iccr.gov.in Application may be submitted online by 10 November, 2026. For any further information/clarification, please contact Director (Scholarships) at e-mail - director.ppr@iccr.gov.in

BRIC-National Institute of Plant Genome Research
(An Autonomous Research Institution of the Department of Biotechnology Ministry of Science and Technology, Govt. of India)
Aruna Asaf Ali Marg, New Delhi – 110067

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

BRIC-NIPGR, pursuing research on various aspects of plant genomics, invites applications from Indian Citizens for filling up the post of Junior Assistant in the Pay Level 4 (₹25,500-81,100) on Direct Recruitment basis.

For detailed information, please visit our website www.nipgr.ac.in. The last date of on-line submission of application is **November 15, 2026 (11.45 pm).**

Director

OFFICE OF THE CHAIRMAN,
STATE NEET UG MEDICAL/DENTAL COUNSELING BOARD-2026,
SMS MEDICAL COLLEGE, JAIPUR
Email- chairmanneetug2026@gmail.com

No. State-UG Counselling Board-2026/229 Date:- 15.10.2026

NOTIFICATION

State UG MEDICAL/DENTAL ADMISSION BOARD-2026 (Stray Vacancy Round)

The procedure for state UG Medical/Dental Admission Board-2026 Stray vacancy Round will commence from **16.10.2026** as per the detailed schedule available at www.ug.neetrajasthan.com

The candidates are advised to visit the website for all detailis and further updates.

DIPR/C/17819/2026 Chairman

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
"Vidyut Bhawan" Near ISBT, Crossing, Saharanpur Road, Majra, Dehradun – 248002,
Corporate ID No. U40101UR2004SGC028575, Phone: 0135-2642711

E-TENDER CORRIGENDUM-1

The pre-bid clarifications of the E-Tender for "Replacement of existing conductor with HTLS conductor" under Package-3 against Tender Specification no. PTCUL/E-Tender/C&P-II/TL-07/2026-27 has been uploaded on e-tender website. For more details please visit the e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** (tender id no. 2026_PTCU4_100371_1) and for e-tender corrigendum notice our website **www.ptcul.org.** All other terms and conditions shall remain same.

For any assistance on E-Tendering, please contact +91-8899890000

Ro no- 1964 /Hqpu/ptcul Dated: 14.10.2026 Superintending Engineer (C&P-II)

"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"

GOVERNMENT MEDICAL COLLEGE & HOSPITAL
[Academic Branch]

Notice for Admission to MD/MS Courses
Session-2026

Online applications are invited for counseling/admission to MD/MS Course Session-2026 for State Quota seats. The date of counseling is mentioned in MD/MS Prospectus-2026. The detail of seats is as follows:-

The distribution of State Quota seats is as below:

Total No. of seats	Scheduled Castes (SC)	OBC	General	EWS
76 (including 4 PwBD seats) + 4 (EWS)	11	5	60	04
76+4 EWS = 80	11	5	60	04

Eligibility Criteria can be seen in MD/MS Prospectus-2026 which will available at **www.gmch.gov.in**

Note: Any change in eligibility criteria/admission process will be uploaded on the **www.gmch.gov.in**

Online application proforma is available from 14.10.2026 to 18.10.2026 on GMCH website. The applicant must upload all the certificates and photograph as mentioned in the MD/MS Prospectus-2026 which is available at **www.gmch.gov.in**. For further details read the prospectus carefully.

Note: Application submitted in any other form, other than online, during the prescribed application submission period or after due date and time shall not be entertained under any circumstances.

- **Application fee:** Application fee can be paid online only. Rs. 2,000/- (General/EWS/OBC/OCI card holder) + Bank charges (if any)
  Rs. 1,000/- (SC/PwBD/Third Gender) + Bank charges (if any)
  The application fee, once paid, shall not be refunded in any case.

Director Principal
Govt. Medical College Hospital
Chandigarh

SECTOR-32, CHANDIGARH

WESTERN RAILWAY RATLAM DIVISION

E-TENDERING NOTICE

The Divisional Railway Manager (WA) RATLAM invites "Open Tender" through e-tender on website **www.ireps.gov.in** The details are as under:- **Sr.No. 1 : E-tender No.: RTM-2026-27-78R Name of Work:** Ranayala Jasmiya (RCJ) Station : Provision of El SYSTEM ATT Left Over PI STATIONS in Dewas-Maksi Section (including Electrical Work). **Approx Value:** Rs.1,21,49,262.57 **Earnest Money to be deposited in Rs.:** 2,43,000.00 **Completion period :** 10 Months **Date of uploading on website:** 14.10.2026 **Date of opening of Tender:** 06.11.2026 **Sr.No. 2 : E-tender No.: RTM-2026-27-104 Name of Work:** 1. Maksi-Dewas-TRR(P) - 11.709 Tkm 2. Indore-Dewas-Ujjain section - Through Rail Renewal (P) Total 4.354 Tkm & 3. Indore-Dewas-Ujjain section - TRR - 36.973 TKM **Approx Value:** Rs.2,12,51,003.29 **Earnest Money to be deposited in Rs.:** 4,25,000.00 **Completion period :** 12 Months **Date of uploading on website:** 14.10.2026 **Date of opening of Tender:** 06.11.2026 • Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria and terms and conditions are available at Website **www.ireps.gov.in**, cost of tender form is NIL.

Apex/299

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CENTRAL RAILWAY

PARCEL & LUGGAGE HANDLING WORKS

Mumbai Division, Central Railway has called tender Mechanised handling of booked parcel & luggage at Lokmanya Tilak Terminus stations of Mumbai Division of Central Railway for a period of 03 years on **www.ireps.gov.in** through e-tendering module. The interested bidders are required to get participate in the bid process and all necessary documents to be uploaded prior to the opening of Bid. For further details the interested bidders are requested to visit the website **www.gem.gov.in** to know the details. Open **Tender-GeM Bid Number:** GeM/2026/B/8165605. **Name of the Work:** Mumbai Division, Central Railway has called tender Mechanised handling of booked parcel & luggage at LTT station of Mumbai Division of Central Railway for a period of 03 years. **Address of the office:** DRM office, Commercial Branch, Mumbai Division, 1st floor, Reservation Centre, CSMT, Mumbai-400001. **Work Location:** Lokmanya Tilak Terminus. **Advertised Value:** Rs. 6,22,50,368. **Tender type:** Two Packet System. **Tender closing Date and Time:** 09.11.2026 at 11.00 Hrs. **Period of contract:** 03 Years. **Validity of Offers:** 90 Days. **Tender Document available on website:** https://gem.gov.in/. Further Addendum/ corrigendum, withdrawal of Tender, change in date, time extension, clarification etc. if any, in connection with the subject tender, will only be uploaded in the website. Bidders should regularly visit the website to keep themselves updated.

Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense

WESTERN RAILWAY
Material Management Department
VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. 5/62/2026 Date 13.10.2026

S.N.	Tender No	Short Description of items	Quantity	T.O.D.
495	23265006	AAR Approved Cartridge Tapered Roller	500 Set	23-Nov-26
496	04263324	Flexible poly vinyl chloride (PVC) flooring sheet in rolls	2193 Nos	18-Nov-26
497	23262339A	Lock for Upgraded High Tensile Non-Tr CBC	38828 Nos	16-Nov-26
498	22265061	Hood for smoothing reactor SL-30,as per CLW DRG NO 1)05/1/50/440 ALT 8 2) 05/1/50/441 ALT 7 (REF. 1 TO 27,43, 44, 46 TO 52) 3)0/5/3/50/292 ALT 4 & conforming to SPECN M/EL/20/TS-1 suitable for CLW built electric Locos	171 Nos	16-Nov-26
499	22263631	Set of single duct leather air bellows	86 Set	16-Nov-26
500	22263628B	Contactor for Compressor and scavenger Blower Motor	623 Nos	11-Nov-26
501	09265016B	Traction transformer complete with cooling system	1 Nos	11-Nov-26
502	09252015	Repair KIT for spring brake chamber	653 Set	11-Nov-26

CORRIGENDUM

Please read the quantity as **"276 Set"** and due date as **"26.10.2026"** for the **Tender Notice No:- S-55-2026 Dated: 16.09.2026 at Sr. No. 434**

Please read the quantity as **"7511 Nos"** and due date as **"16.11.2026"** for the **Tender Notice No:- S-52-2026 Dated:04.09.2026 at Sr. No. 418**

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** and **wr.indianrailways.gov.in.** 0710

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DELHI METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India and Govt. of Delhi)

INVITATION FOR BIDS

Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Ltd. invites online open e-tenders from eligible Bidders for the **Design, Manufacture, Supply, Testing, Commissioning and Training of 60 No. Standard Gauge Cars for Hyderabad Metro Project and Comprehensive Maintenance of these 60 Numbers of Standard Gauge Cars as well as Depot M&Ps, Special Tools, Jigs and Fixtures, Testing and Diagnostic Equipment and Test Benches, Material Handling Equipment Etc., for a period of 15 years.**

International Competitive Bidding will be conducted in accordance "Single –Stage Two-Envelope" Bidding Procedure.

For detailed information log on to **www.delhimetrorail.com** or e-tendering website **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.**

Advertisement No.: DMRC/1002/2026

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd, Ground Floor, Ackruti Centre, MIDC, Near Telephone Exchange, Opp Ackruti Star, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400093

PUBLIC NOTICE-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF SECURED ASSET
[See proviso to Rule 8(6)]
Notice for sale of immovable asset(s)

E-Auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable asset(s) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. This notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited will be sold on 'As is where is', 'As is what is' and 'Whatever there is' as per the brief particulars given hereunder;

Sr. No.	Name of Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/ Loan Account No.	Details of the Secured asset(s) with known encumbrances, if any	Amount Outstanding	Reserve Price / Earnest Money Deposit	Date and Time of Property Inspection	Date & Time of E-Auction
(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)	(F)	(G)
1.	M/s. Chamunda Enterprises (Borrower) Mr. Kalpesh Damji Raparka Mrs. Priti Subhash Kanoji (Guarantor/ Mortgagor) 123605002409	Property 2 :-Basement, Shop No. 02, Wing No. A, Lower Ground Floor, In the Building Known as Saket Apartment, Presently name as Saket Co-Operative Housing Society Limited (Reg. No. TNA/AMB/HSG/(TC)/25314/2013-2014), Constructed on N. A. Land, Being C. T. S. No. 7710 to 7716, Survey No. 50, Hissa No. 06(B)Paiki, Vadavali Section, Ambarnath(E), Taluka Ambarnath, Municipal Ward No. 07, Municipal Property No. 8243/A, Taluka & Sub-District Registration Ulhasnagar, Registration District THane, Maharashtra Admeasuring Area 1840 Square Feet + 160 Square Feet Common Places, Total Built Up Area 2000 Square Feet (Ambarnath)	Rs. 4,68,31, 871/- as on 04/09/2026	Rs. 1,05,00, 000/- Rs. 10,50, 000/-	October 19, 2026 From 11.00 AM to 02:00 PM	November 07, 2026 From 11.00 AM onward

The online auction will take place on the website (URL Link-https://BidDeal.in) of e-auction agency ValueTrust Capital Services Private Limited. The Mortgagors/ noticee are given a last chance to pay the total dues with further interest till November 06, 2026 before 05:00 PM failing which, this secured asset will be sold as per schedule.
The Prospective Bidder(s) must submit the Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Demand Draft (DD) (Refer Column E) at ICICI Bank Limited, Level 3-5, 74 Techno Park, Opp SEEPZ Gate No. 02, Marol MIDC, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400 093 on or before November 06, 2026 before 04:00 PM and thereafter they need to submit their offer through the above mentioned website only on or before November 06, 2026 before 05:00 PM along with scan image of Bank acknowledged DD towards proof of payment of EMD. Kindly note, in case prospective bidder(s) are unable to submit their offer through the website then signed copy of tender documents may be submitted at ICICI Bank Limited, Level 3-5, 74 Techno Park, Opp SEEPZ Gate No. 02, Marol MIDC, Andheri East, Mumbai 400 093 on or before November 06, 2026 before 05:00 PM. Earnest Money Deposit DD/PO should be from a Nationalised/Scheduled Bank in favour of "ICICI Bank Limited" payable at Mumbai.
For any further clarifications with regards to inspection, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of tenders, kindly contact ICICI Bank Limited on 8104548031/9004392416
The Authorised Officer reserves the right to reject any or all the bids without furnishing any further reasons.
For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please visit www.icicibank.com/n4p4s

Date: October 16, 2026, Place: Mumbai

Authorized Officer, ICICI Bank Limited

भिवंडी निजामपूर शहर महानगरपालिका, भिवंडी
बांधकाम विभाग, प्रभाग समिती क्रं. १
ई-निवीदा सुचना क्रमांक ५३ सन २०२६/२७
(दूसरा कॉल) – (नगरसेवक निधी सन २०२६ – २७ अंतर्गत)

भिवंडी निजामपुर शहर महानगरपालिकेच्या बांधकाम विभागामार्फत खालील नमुद कामाचे निविदा फॉर्म दिनांक –१६/१०/२०२६ ते दि.:– २३/१०/२०२६ पर्यंत विक्रीस उपलब्ध आहे.

अ. क्र.	कामाचे नाव	अंदाजपत्रकीय रक्कम (रु.)	निविदापत्राची किंमत (रु.)
१.	प्रभाग समिती क्रं.१ कार्यक्षेत्रातील वॉर्ड क्रं. ३ (ब) मधिल मुकीमघरांच्या घरापासुन ते मुस्लीम भाजीवालेच्या घरापर्यंत नविन गटारीचे बांधकाम करुन मिळणेबाबत.	९,९८,७४६/–	११८०/–
२.	प्रभाग समिती १ च्या कार्यक्षेत्रातील वॉर्ड क्रं.०४ (ब) मध्ये विविध ठिकाणी नादुरुस्त गटार व पाथवेज दुरुस्ती करुन तसेच पेव्हर ब्लॉक लावुन मिळणेबाबत.	७,९९,६०२/–	११८०/–
३.	प्रभाग समिती क्रं.१ कार्यक्षेत्रातील वॉर्ड क्रं. १० (क) मधिल जोहर रोड परिसरात व विविध ठिकाणी नादुरुस्त गटर व पाथवेज दुरुस्ती करुन मिळणेबाबत	९,९८,८९१/–	११८०/–

वरील ऑनलाईन निविदा **दि. २३/१०/२०२६ पर्यंत दुपारी ४.०० पर्यंत** स्विकारण्यात येतील. तसेच सदरची निविदा ही **दि. २६/१०/२०२६ रोजी संध्या. ४.०१** अथवा कार्यालयीन कामकाजाच्या सोई प्रमाणे निविदा समिती समक्ष उघडण्यात येईल. अधिक माहिती महानगरपालिकेच्या **mahatenders.gov.in** या संकेतस्थळावरुन प्राप्त होऊ शकेल अथवा नविन शासकीय इमारतीमधील ५ व्या मजल्यावरील बांधकाम विभाग कार्यालयाशी संपर्क साधावा.

सही/–
(जमिल पटेल)
शहर अभियंता
भिवंडी निजामपूर शहर महानगरपालिका, भिवंडी

Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)
Extension Notice No. 3
E-Tender Notice No. 23 /2026-2027 (Mumbai)

Vide above E Tender Notice, tender for following work were published in Daily Navakal, Mumbai, Daily Hindustan Times, Mumbai, Daily Free Press Journal, Mumbai, Daily Bhaskar, Mumbai, Daily Prathakal, Mumbai, Daily Ramprahar, Raigad, Daily Sagar, Thane on 09/07/2026.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost
1.	Ransai water supply scheme.. Special repairs to overflow section, Energy dissipation Arrangements, provision of guide wall, shifting and extension of drainage pipeline of Ransai Dam.	Rs.24,80,00,501.00

Now the Extension Notice is hereby issued for extending the date of availability of E Tender and reply to queries/ MIDC Clarification on website of **https://mahatenders.gov.in** for the above work.

The blank tender forms for above work will now be available upto **28/10/2026** on following website of **https://mahatenders.gov.in.**

Answers to the queries / MIDC Clarification will be available from **16/11/2026** on above website.

Please note that the bidders who have already submitted / uploaded their offer will again have to reload or resubmit their offer with or without change, such bidders shall also note that if offers is not reloaded or resubmitted, their bid will be out of completion for the this tender in particular.

Other contents of the tender notice remain unchanged.

Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)
(Deptt. of Additional Sources of Energy, Govt. of U.P.)
Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow, U.P. - 226010 Tel. No. 0522-2720652,
Telefax: 0522-2720779, 2720829, Website: www.upneda.org.in, Email: compneda@rediffmail.com

Opportunity for Investors & Project Developers for setting up Floating Solar Projects

Online Applications can be made by Investors/Project Developers for allotment of identified Dams/Reservoirs for setting up Floating Solar Projects.

Key information for the application is as follows :

(a)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for public sector	Rs. 1/Acre/year
(b)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for private sector	Rs. 15000/Acre/year
(c)	Link for Standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) and Govt. order No. 372/87 dated 14.03.2024	https://solar.upneda.in https://upneda.org.in
(d)	Online Registration Fee	Rs. 23600.00 (including Taxes)

Detailed application & proposals will be evaluated on First Come First Serve basis according to the standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) dated 28.03.2025 & 30.07.2026 and Govt. order No.372/87 dated 14.03.2024

Note. All applications submitted till the last day of each month will be considered as one group. Evaluation will be done on a monthly basis.

Nodal officer Details: Sh. Narendra Singh, Senior Project Officer-II, Mob No: 94156 09007

Director, UPNEDA

WORLD

Musk: Trump has control of Starlink system in Ukraine

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: SpaceX boss Elon Musk said Wednesday that any disruptions reported by Ukraine in using the Starshield satellite communications system would be the responsibility of the US government, not his company.

"Starshield systems are owned and controlled by the US government. Any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS," Musk said, referring to US President Donald Trump.

Musk drew a distinction between the Starshield system, which Ukraine relies on for battlefield communications, and the parallel Starlink civilian satellite system, which Ukraine also deploys but is not allowed to use for offensive operations. Both were designed by Musk's SpaceX.

Musk was responding to a post on X by Ukraine's former defense minister Mykhailo Fedorov, who said that "Starlink connectivity at speeds of up to 160 km/h is being restored," but that "removing Starshield's speed limit entirely is now critical for Ukraine's defense."

Fedorov then thanked Musk for his "continued support."

Ukrainian defence ministry officials have suggested Washington is behind slower speeds reported on some internet terminals that help the country's military hit Russian-occupied territory and operate interceptor drones.

Ukraine has also accused the United States of America of helping Russia by failing to warn it of incoming missile strikes, with the capital Kyiv hit by ballistic missiles for two nights in a row before air raid sirens could sound to warn people to take cover.

A car hit by a Russian FPV drone in Donetsk, Ukraine. REUTERS

Ukraine has resumed strikes on Russian oil refineries: Zelensky

Agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

KYIV: Ukraine will no longer abide by Donald Trump's demands not to strike Russian oil refineries, President Volodymyr Zelensky said in remarks published Thursday, AFP reported. Zelensky described the US-Russia diesel deal as a "weak decision", saying it would encourage Russia to prolong its four-and-a-half-year war with Ukraine, while several of Ukraine's European allies criticised the agreement.

"The block (on attacking refineries) is out," Zelensky told the Financial Times in an interview published on Thursday. "We're done."

Ukraine struck a Russian oil refinery on Thursday, Reuters reported.

Musk calls on Zelensky to 'go'

Musk called for Volodymyr Zelensky to "go" as Ukraine's leader, after insisting any disruption to the war-torn country's use of his satellite communications system was the fault of the US government, not his company.

The comments came as Kyiv raised doubts over US support for Ukraine in its war with Russia, accusing Washington this week of helping Moscow by failing to warn it of incoming missile strikes and hobbling Kyiv's military response through changes to the SpaceX-designed system it uses for communications. "And so the slaughter continues," Musk wrote on X. "Time for Zelensky to go."

Teen held for mass shooting bid at Hindu temple in Chicago-area

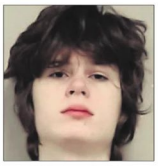
Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

PALATINE: Police in a Chicago suburb announced Wednesday that they had thwarted a potential mass shooting, arresting a 19-year-old man who they said may have planned to target a Hindu temple.

Alexandros Paporakis, a Taco Bell cashier from Palatine, Illinois, faces felony charges of making a terrorist threat and unlawfully possessing weapons. Investigators believe he planned to target the largest Hindu temple in Aurora, Illinois, but the exact intended location remains under probe.

The defendant's co-workers told police they had received concerning digital communications from Paporakis, including a document outlining an alleged plan to carry out a mass shooting and photos of tactical gear. They said Paporakis openly identified as a white supremacist at work and told them he couldn't wait to kill Indian people, according to prosecutors.

The Mount Prospect and Palatine police departments coordinated to locate and arrest Paporakis while he was leaving his home on Sunday afternoon, the same day detectives believe he may have been planning to carry out an attack, police said. He had allegedly told his Taco Bell co-workers that Sunday was going to be "a special day."



Alexandros Paporakis

Prosecutors said Paporakis called one coworker earlier in the day Sunday, saying that his gun had jammed and he left "super fast" without being seen.

"The seriousness of this alleged threat cannot be overstated," Palatine Police Chief William Nord said, adding that protecting places of worship is a law enforcement priority.

Prosecutors allege Paporakis sent the coworker an eight-page document titled, "Why I fought: A.K.A. (Aurora Shooter's Manifesto)," which described Indian, Jewish and African American people as "subhumans" and outlined a plot to kill as many of them as possible, according to a court document.

In a search of his home, detectives recovered an AR style rifle without a serial number, loaded magazines and ammunition, a gas canister labeled with a slur aimed at South Asians, and a several items depicting Nazi symbolism, police and prosecutors said.

Paporakis allegedly described himself in the manifesto as "a sociopathic white supremacist Neo Nazi filled with hatred, fantasizing about mass murder nearly every day." A judge ruled Wednesday that Paporakis will remain in jail pretrial. He is next scheduled to appear in court October 30.

'Racist and anti-Hindu plot disturbing': India urges US to prevent such incidents

NEW DELHI: India on Thursday expressed deep concern over an alleged plot for a mass shooting at a Hindu temple in the US state of Illinois and urged US authorities to thoroughly investigate the matter and bring those responsible to justice.

"We are deeply concerned by reports of an alleged plot to carry out a mass shooting targeting a Hindu temple in the Aurora area of Illinois. The reported anti-Hindu and racist nature of the alleged plot, including references to violence against people of Indian origin, is particularly disturbing," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said in response to media queries on the incident.

While acknowledging the action taken by US law enforcement, including the arrest and detention of the suspect and charges brought against him, Jaiswal said: "We expect US authorities to thoroughly investigate the matter, bring those responsible to justice, and take all necessary measures to prevent such incidents." The incident , adds to "growing concerns over racist hostility and anti-India hate in the US". He said, "There is a need for greater vigilance, zero tolerance for hate-motivated violence, and decisive action to ensure safety of Indian community." HTC

Trump: Those who leak to journalists should be shot

WASHINGTON: Donald Trump called for executing individuals who leak information to the media during a campaign rally as he railed against what he cast as critical coverage of the war in Iran. "In my opinion, leakers should be shot. They should be shot. In the old days, we used to shoot leakers," Trump said. "Leakers should be dealt with very, very strongly. They're real. To me, they're the scum of the earth." BLOOMBERG

Kerala-born woman leads in LA mayoral race

WASHINGTON: Kerala-born Nithya Raman has a lead over her former ally and incumbent mayor Karen Bass in the Los Angeles mayoral race. If elected in the November 3 polls, Raman will be the first Indian-American Los Angeles Mayor. Born in Kerala on July 28, 1981, Raman moved to Louisiana when she was six. PTI

McKinsey partner quits NGO over Linkedin posts

NEW YORK: A senior partner at McKinsey & Co, Chris Bradley, has resigned from his role at an NGO, days after he was removed from his leadership role at McKinsey's business and economics research unit, as the fallout from his LinkedIn comments questioning women's workplace challenges deepened. Bradley had questioned the term glass cliff, calling it "a very convenient way to always be a victim in the rain". BLOOMBERG

4 DEAD AS HOUTHIS HIT PRESIDENTIAL PALACE IN YEMEN

ADEN: The Houthis carried out a missile attack on the Yemeni government's presidential palace in the interim capital of Aden on Thursday, with government military sources reporting four killed and 10 wounded.

The site serves as the headquarters of the internationally recognised government. Three local police sources said on condition of anonymity that "Houthi missiles targeted the Al-Maashiq presidential palace". AFP

China, Pakistan start 1st joint drills since Sindoor, using Chinese arms

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

BEIJING: The armies of China and Pakistan began joint military exercises in a high-altitude area in Xinjiang, using weapons and equipment provided by the Chinese military, official media reported here on Thursday.

Significantly, all the weapons used in the exercise, including Type 191 rifles, Type 201 squad machine guns, Type 11 armoured assault vehicles, Type 08 infantry fighting vehicles, as well as artillery, unmanned and anti-unmanned systems, were provided by the Chinese military, state-run CCTV reported on Thursday.

China supplies over 80% of weapons to all three Pakistan military forces.

The joint exercises with Chinese weapons in high-altitude areas were significant considering the Chinese military's experience in the Himalayan border region with India.

The opening ceremony for the exercises was held at a training base in Korla, Northwest China's Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region.

The exercise is the first joint army training between the two allies after Operation Sindoor in May 2025.

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, JICA PROJECT CIRCLE, AT/PO: SUKINDA, DIST: JAJPUR. 32001/1064/2627
E-mail: sescc2011@gmail.com

1st Corrigendum

CANCELLATION OF TENDER

This is to notify that, Bid Identification No. ACE JPC-01/2026-27, the tender for the work vide si no.1,2,3,4,5,6 is hereby **cancelled** due to administrative reasons/issues.

Additional Chief Engineer, JICA Project Circle, Sukinda
OIPR - 32001/32501/1/26-27/0002

MADHYA PRADESH RURAL ROAD DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
(AN AGENCY OF PANCHAYAT & RURAL DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT, GOVT. OF M.P.)
3rd Floor, Vikas Bhawan, Arera Hills, Bhopal (M.P.)
(GST No. 23AAATM9054A3ZX)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER NO. 1306 (PM-JANMAN) (BATCH-I & II, YEAR-2026-27)

No./10490/22/D-12/MPRRDA/2026 Bhopal, Dated : 14.10.2026

Online Tenders for Construction of Rural Roads/CDs with 5 years maintenance are invited on the E-Procurement System portal **https://www.pmgsytenders.gov.in.** as detailed below :-

- **Name of Work :-** Construction/Up-gradation of Rural Roads under PMGSY including maintenance for Five year after construction.
- **SSR Applicable :-** SSR issued by M.P. Rural Road Development Authority, effective from 01.01.2024 and amended upto issue date of NIT.
- **Table-1 : PM-JANMAN-Batch-I, Year-2026-27**

S. No.	Name of District	No of Packages	No. of Road	Total Length (in kms)	Total PAC (In Rs.)
1	Balaghat	1	10	26.70	156281000.00
2	Mandla	1	7	24.43	132973262.00
3	Sheopur	4	12	14.45	90169775.00
4	Singrauli	1	1	2.73	17675000.00

- **Table-2 : PM-JANMAN-Batch-II, Year-2026-27**

S. No.	Name of District	No of Packages	No. of Road	Total Length (in kms)	Total PAC (In Rs.)
1	Chhindwara	1	1	3.93	31040000.00
2	Dindori	1	2	2.40	14671438.00
3	Mandla	1	8	14.72	79693036.00
4	Sheopur	1	1	1.35	8675297.00
5	Singrauli	1	3	28.32	176971000.00

1. **Availability of Bid Documents and Mode of Submission :** The Bid document is available online and should be submitted online in **www.pmgsytenders.gov.in**. The bidder would be required to register in the web-site which is free of cost. For submission of the bids, the bidder is required to have a valid Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from one of the authorized Certifying Authorities.
2. Bid document may be purchase online from **27.10.2026 (17:30 hrs)** and last date for online bid submission is **12.11.2026 (17:00 hrs.)**
3. Other Critical dates and details can be viewed in the detailed N.I.T. and SBD for PMGSY Works (June-2020) on the above-mentioned portal and concerned PIU.

CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (TENDER)
M.P. Madhyam/128611/2026

'मेरी सड़क' ऐप डाउनलोड कर फीडबैक देकर राष्ट्र के विकास में सहयोग दें।

कार्यालय श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर
प्रबंध समिति, उज्जैन
www.shrimahakaleshwar.mp.gov.in
Fax : 0734-2550144/2550563
क्र./महा/स्टोर/2026/3435 उज्जैन दिनांक 15.10.2026

निविदा विज्ञप्ति (सुविधा प्रबंधन एवं मानव संसाधन)

Tender ID- 2026_MMPSU_542247_1

श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति द्वारा संचालित विभिन्न इकाइयों में सुविधा प्रबंधन हेतु कर्मचारी प्रदाय करने के लिये संबंधित निविदाकारों से ई-टेण्डर के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन दरें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं :-
कार्य का नाम : श्री महाकालेश्वर मंदिर प्रबंध समिति में (सुविधा प्रबंधन) हेतु।
कार्य की अनुमानित लागत : रु. 25,00,00,000/-
अमानत राशि : रु. 75,00,000 /-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेन्ट की लागत : रु. 50,000/-
टेण्डर डाक्यूमेंट क्रय करने एवं बिड प्रस्तुत करने की दिनांक ई-टेण्डरिंग पोर्टल **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर Tender ID : 2026_MMPSU_542247_1 देखी जा सकती है। पोर्टल में उल्लेखित दिनांक अनुसार कार्यवाही सुनिश्चित करें।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128616/2026 उप प्रशासक एवं डिप्टी कलेक्टर

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Harshal Anil Paral**, Director and Authorized Signatory of accused No. 1, 107, Gold Crest Opp. Shreyas Cinema LBS Road, Ghatkopar (West), Mumbai - 400086 has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR/CC No. 2836/2021 U/s 138 NI Act**., has been registered at **PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Harshal Anil Paral** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Harshal Anil Paral** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Harshal Anil Paral** of under **FIR/CC No. 2836/2021 U/s 138 NI Act**., Registered at **PS: Punjabi Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankur Panghal
JMFC-05 (West), Room No. 336-A
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/14583/WD/2026
(Court Notice)

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, ग्वालियर, संभाग ग्वालियर
ई-मेल : pe.policehousinggwa@mp.gov.in

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम, ग्वालियर, संभाग ग्वालियर द्वारा निविदा क्रमांक 17/2026-27 ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक - 2026_MPPHC_543250_1, 2026_MPPHC_543251_1 2026_MPPHC_543252_1, ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक- आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 11.11.2026 तक** ऑनलाइन खरीदे जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण **Portal : https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128601/2026 परियोजना यंत्री

CENTRAL RAILWAY
VARIOUS WORK

Open e-tender notice No.CR-DRM(W)BB-2026-51 of 14.10.2026. Office of the DRM(W) Mumbai, CSMT. **Sr.No.1. Name of work:-**(A) Miscellaneous civil repair and painting work of officer's quarters at Nirmal Park officer's colony under ADEN(Wks)BY for year 2025-26 B) Structural repair, terrace water proofing, repairs to leaky toilet and Painting of Officers Rest House at Nirmal Park. C) Strengthening of Boundary wall at Nirmal Park Colony. **Approximate Value:** Rs.636.06 lakhs, **EMD:** Rs. 1272100/- **Completion period** - 12 months. **Sr.No.2. Name of work:-** Vasai Road- Roha: Provision of 5.50 Km boundary wall around Railway Staff Quarters & PWI depots. **Approximate Value:** Rs.399.85 lakhs. **EMD:** Rs. 799700/-. **Completion period** -12 months. **Sr.No.3 Name of work-** Picking of Released rails, PRC Sleepers, Turnout Sleeper, Crossing, Switches etc. with crane mounted on Rly's BFR Under Sr. DEN/East/ BB jurisdiction. **Approximate Value:** Rs. 157.47 Lakhs. **EMD:** Rs. 314900/-. **Completion period** - 12 months. **Sr.No.4 Name of work-** Supplying and stacking of 65 mm machine crushed Ballast at Karjat depot under ADEN N.L.NL. **Approximate Value:** Rs.568.67 Lakhs. **EMD:** Rs 1137400/-. **Completion period** -12 months. (I) **Tender closing date & time of aforesaid tender:** Up-to 15.00 hrs. of Sr.No.1 on 30.10.2026 and Sr. 2 & Sr. 3 on 13.11.2026 and Sr.4 on 10.11.2026 to be opened after 15.00 hrs. (II) The prospective tenderers are requested to visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for details of tenders & corrigendum, if any.
(III) Tenderer may participate in above e-tender electronically through website **www.ireps.gov.in** only & submission of manual offers against e-tender are not allowed. Manually, if submitted shall neither be opened nor considered. (IV) The Bid Security shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. (V) **For further enquiry, may contact:** Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Office, Central Railway on phone. 022-67455323. (VI) This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy Order 2017 dated 16-9-2017. Complete details of tenders are available at the website **"www.ireps.gov.in"**. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Office, Mumbai CSMT.

Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense

CENTRAL RAILWAY
BHUSAVAL DIVISION
TENDER NOTICE NO.: BSL-SNT-PROJ-04-2026-27 Dtd. 12.10.2026

DY CSTE (PROJECT) BSL Central Railway Bhusawal for and on behalf of President of India invites e-Tender from the eligible Tenderers for the following work: **Name of Work:** Supply & installation of Seamless CCOE Cylinder for gas based fire suppression system as per RDSO specification No. RDSO/SPN/218/2016 Ver 1.0-d2 for the Distributed Electronic Interlocking (Centralised EI + 3OC cabins) at BSL Passenger Yard. **Total Cost of Tender:** ₹ 69,17,076.49 (Rs. Sixty-Nine lakh, Seventeen thousand, Seventy-Six & Forty-Nine Paisa Only). **Earnest Money:** ₹ 1,38,400.00. **Cost of Tender Form:** Nil. **Completion Period:** 4 Month from date of issue of LOA (Letter of Acceptance). **Bidding Start Date:** 20.10.2026. **Date & Time of Closing of Tender Submission:** 03.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. **All details are available on website: www.ireps.gov.in** EXP-08 DY CSTE (PROJECT), Bhusawal

RailMadad Helpline 139

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR (At/PO :- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha) 25001/1342/2627
(E-Mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com , Tel/Fax:- 0680-2404287)

E-Mail / E-despatch

NO. e-tender // 6190 // RWC // BAM // Date. 14.10.26

2nd Corrigendum to Bid Identification No. Online Tender/17-2026-27/BPR

1) The partial modification of Building works vide above identification has been made as follows

1	Last Date of availability of tender	: 27.10.2026 upto 5.30 PM instead of 21.10.2026 upto 5.30 PM
2	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	: **23.10.2026 at 5.30 PM instead of 16.10.2026 at 5.30 PM**
3	Date of opening of Technical Bid.	: 28.10.2026 at 11.00 AM instead of 22.10.2026 at 11.00 AM
4	Date of opening of Financial Bid	: Will be intimated later on.

All other contents will remain unchanged

Chief Engineer, R.W. Circle, Berhampur
OIPR - 25001/25071/1/26-27/0040

Classifieds [Friday] www.htclassifieds.com

NOTICES | MISCELLANEOUS | TENDER NOTICE | CHANGE OF NAME

UCO BANK
A Govt. of India Undertaking (ZONAL OFFICE, MUMBAI)
General Administrative Department
359, UCO Bank Building, 1st Floor, Dr D N Road, Hutatma Chowk, Fort, Mumbai-400001
Ph Nos: (022) 40544401, 40544302
Email : zomumbai.gad@ucobank.co.in

TENDER NOTICE

PREMISES REQUIRED

Bank desires to take premises preferably on Ground Floor in following localityies for New/ shifting of its Branch/Office

Branch/ Office	Preferred Location	Carpet Area (Sq. Ft
Powai (Shifting of Premises)	Near Hiranandani Gardens, Chandivali, Kanjurmarg, JVLR, IIT POWAI	1000 to 1200 Sq.ft
Vashi (Opening of New Premises)	APMC Market, Vashi Main Market	1000 to 1200 Sq.ft
MHAPRE Ind. Area (Opening of New Premises)	MHAPE Business Park, Mhape Ind. Area	1000 to 1200 Sq.ft

Offers in two separate sealed covers containing technical and financial details on prescribed format are invited from the interested parties,
The details may be collected from Bank's Zonal Office Mumbai or can be downloaded from Bank's website **www.ucobank.com.**
The offerer must have a clear title to the property.
Rentable carpet area should be excluding area of toilet (**Ladies & Gents**), staircase etc.
Maintenance and Municipal Tax should be borne by the property owner.
Quoted rate should be inclusive of GST and taxes.
The last date for submission of application in sealed cover on prescribed format is **22.10.2026 till 3 p.m. only.**

I, **BIPINKUMAR** Patidar (old name), R/o 9709 Interstate 30, Little Rock, Arkansas 72209, USA, have changed my name to Bipinkumar Partidar (new name) vide affidavit dated 25.06.2026, sworn before Lisa Huntsman, Notary Public, St. Charles County, Missouri, USA. Henceforth, I shall be known as Bipinkumar Partidar for all purposes.

For Advertisement Call Manish Shirke 9820748750

HT

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A quiz on the week's development.
HT FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

Nifty logs best day in 4 months, rally may fade

Srushti Vaidya
srushti.vaidya@livemint.com

MUMBAI: Indian stocks surged on Thursday, bucking a global sell-off in artificial intelligence (AI) and technology shares as domestic buying and a rush by traders to reverse their bets against the market fuelled the rally. However, experts do not see the uptrend sustaining as of now as foreign funds continue to pull money out of Indian equities.

The Nifty 50 index closed 1.66% higher at 22,997.35 on Thursday, clocking its biggest rise in percentage terms since June 12. Sensex closed 2.1% up at 74,315.61, seeing a similar highest rise since June 12.

Heavyweights ICICI Bank, Reliance Industries Ltd, HDFC Bank and Bharti Airtel buoyed the index. Domestic institutional investors (DIIs) net bought shares worth ₹3,319 crore, while foreign institutional investors (FIIs) net sold shares worth ₹5,285 crore. However, the FIIs, on a gross basis, bought shares worth ₹ 12,735 crore on Thursday.

The proof of short-covering was visible in the put-call ratio of weekly options contracts on the Nifty, which witnessed a dramatic rise, said analysts.

Buying across banking, IT and heavyweight stocks lifted the benchmarks. MINT

The put-call ratio of Nifty options expiring on October 19 jumped to 1.65 on Thursday from 1.01 a day earlier, implying that call sellers were forced to cut their short call positions due to the smacking rally in heavyweights, they said.

"This means that for every 100 calls sold on Thursday, 165 puts were sold, skewing the market in favour of the bulls," said Sudhir Joshi, consultant at Khambatta Securities.

This ratio shows the number of outstanding puts relative to the outstanding calls. When the ratio rises, it's a bullish sign as investors and traders sell more puts than calls, hoping to pocket the premium paid by the put buyers who are bearish.

While heavyweight stocks rose, the Nifty Smallcap 250 index fell 1.01% and Nifty Midcap 150 fell 0.8% on Thursday.

FIIs have net sold shares worth ₹38,722 crore in October so far, according to National Securities Depositories Ltd (NSDL) data.

The market got a boost from moderating crude oil prices and a stronger rupee. The rupee continued its winning streak for the fifth straight day, rising 23 paise to 95.06 per dollar on Thursday, while benchmark Brent crude oil prices fell 1.3% to $104.63 a barrel, easing worries over inflationary pressures.

Globally, AI and tech-heavy indices saw a sharp correction: South Korea's Kospi index fell 8.18%, Japan's Nikkei 225 fell 4.18%, and Nasdaq fell 1.88% on Thursday.

The stocks that saw biggest declines on Nasdaq on 14 October were all AI-focussed companies: CoreWeave, Nebius Group and Marvell Technology fell 15%, 10%, and 8.8%, respectively. The fall in AI stocks globally comes amid worries that the massive spending on the technology may not deliver commensurate gains.

India, with its relatively low exposure to AI stocks, could offer investors a refuge from the global AI turmoil.

However, for investors to actually move money out of the US markets, "would need a more sustained correction in some of the major AI stocks," said Chrisly Mathai, fund manager at Quantum Mutual Fund.

"We may be seeing the beginnings of that in a few stocks, partly because bond yields have risen. But the earnings outlook for US technology companies remains strong, and we are not yet seeing clear signs of a broader earnings slowdown," Mathai added.

GROSS DIRECT TAX COLLECTION INCREASES 15%

Rajeev Jayaswal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The gross direct tax collections in 2026-27 up to October 14 jumped nearly 15% on an annualised basis to around ₹16.03 lakh crore with net revenue after refunds increasing by over 13% to ₹13.37 lakh crore due to stronger receipts from all key segments, according to government data released on Thursday.

The gross direct tax collection in the first seven months of the current financial year (April 1-October 14 of FY27) increased 14.89% to ₹16,03,066.12 crore compared to ₹13,95,278.39 crore in the same period of the FY26.

After refunds, net direct tax revenue surged by 13.21% to ₹13,37,866.98 crore in FY27 (up to October 14) compared to ₹11,81,786.98 crore in the same period last fiscal year. Total refunds in the said period of 2026-27 were ₹2,65,199.14 crore as against ₹2,13,491.41 crore in the corresponding period of 2025-26, registering a 24.22% jump, official data said.

Grant Thornton Bharat partner-tax Richa Sawhney said, "The latest data reflects a balanced revenue profile, with growth visible across both corporate taxes and securities transaction taxes. Although the sharp increase in refunds has impacted net collection growth, it is also indicative of more efficient refund processing by the tax administration."

Supreme Court blow to Yes Bank's bond kill

Krishna Yadav and Subhana Shaikh
krishna.yadav@livemint.com

NEW DELHI/MUMBAI: Yes Bank Ltd's bondholders scored a landmark win over India's central bank and the government on Thursday, with the Supreme Court striking down a six-year-old decision to cancel their investments.

The Reserve Bank of India had seized the wobbly private lender in 2020 to facilitate a bailout, appointing an administrator who wrote off the bank's additional tier-1 (AT-1) bonds worth ₹8,415 crore. The Bombay High Court quashed the write-off in 2023, and the apex court on Thursday said it found no reason to reverse that.

"The question is not whether the AT-1 bonds could have been or ought to have been written down off. The question is the manner in which it was done," the judgment penned by justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih said. The administrator could not exercise a power reserved for the RBI, the court said, noting the write-down was contrary to the RBI's own master circular on Basel-III capital regulations and the terms governing the bonds.

Yes Bank shares plunged 14.5% to ₹18.12 on the NSE, turning the worst-performer in the Nifty Bank index, as investors fretted about the ruling's financial impact.

The impact on Yes Bank's balance sheet may not be immediate.

According to the former chief financial officer of a private sector bank, since AT-1 bonds do not have a maturity date, lenders only need to pay coupon every year. However, most AT-1 bonds have a call option under which banks repay investors in full after five or 10 years. Therefore, unless the verdict is overturned, Yes Bank will have to restart making yearly coupon payments to bondholders, the banker said on the condition of anonymity. The fate of the past dues—from 2020 to now— could not be immediately ascertained.

Yes Bank sank into a liquidity crisis in March 2020 as bad loans swelled. MINT

The court made withering criticism of the central bank—"the RBI was a mere bystander, allowing the CET-1 ratio of Yes Bank to drop to an astonishing low of 0.6% while the business of Yes Bank was being carried out in a clandestine manner," the judgment said. The court added that making investors bear the consequences of administrative lapses is "highly unfair".

The court was not persuaded that the write-down was necessary to revive Yes Bank before the State Bank of India (SBI) infused capital into the lender. It said the need to rescue the bank could not override procedure. The court termed the conduct of Yes Bank, the RBI and the administrator in handling the investor money as "questionable".

"Payment of annual coupon rate shall remain unaffected by the outcome of these appeals and must be made in terms of the information memorandum," the bench said.

Yes Bank sank into a liquidity crisis in March 2020 as bad loans swelled, prompting the RBI to seize the lender and freeze withdrawals. A consortium of lenders led by SBI was assembled to orchestrate a massive bailout by injecting fresh equity capital. The administrator wrote down around ₹8,415 crore worth of AT-1 bonds as part of this exercise, prompting Axis Trustee Services and other bondholders to move court.

The bench also questioned if SBI, the RBI, the administrator and the government were aware that the Yes Bank reconstruction scheme did not have the bond write-down provision. It said the government's decision to remove the clause from the draft scheme appeared to favour bondholders, but the administrator subsequently wrote down the bonds.

The court slammed Yes Bank for offering high-risk AT-1 bonds to individual investors, noting that RBI rules required these instruments to be offered only to institutional investors. "A tighter scrutiny ought to have been exercised before luring individual investors to such high-risk securities", it said.

Queries emailed to Yes Bank remained unanswered.

"If the ruling is implemented and the AT-1 bonds are fully restored, Yes Bank's common equity tier-1 (CET-1) capital ratio will be impacted," Venkatkrishnan Srinivasan, founder of Rockfort Fincap said.In the June quarter, Yes Bank reported a 34% increase in net profit to ₹1,071 crore, and remained well-capitalized with a capital adequacy ratio of 15.1% and CET-1 ratio of 14.0%.

"The ruling could improve investor protection, but also increase uncertainty about future AT-1 write-offs. Investors may become more cautious, particularly towards lower-rated banks, potentially increasing their borrowing costs," Srinivasan said.

"Stronger banks may continue issuing AT-1 bonds, while others may prefer equity-raising if the cost or availability of AT1 funding becomes less attractive," he said, adding the bond market may require greater clarity on the legal process for writing down such bonds to boost investor confidence. DP Singh, former joint CEO of SBI Funds Management, said the latest developments could kill the AT1 bond market in India. "Institutional buyers are aware about AT-1 bonds and their risks. They cannot say that these bonds were mis-sold to them," Singh said.

Sebi rolls back closing auction change for derivatives expiry

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MUMBAI: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Thursday pulled back the two-month-old closing auction framework for settlement of derivatives contracts, after it led to abrupt price swings and uncertainty on expiry days.

In a late-night circular, the market regulator said that the closing price will be calculated based on a 30-minute volume-weighted average price (VWAP) on derivatives expiry days i.e. Tuesday and Thursday.

Sebi reviewed the framework through a consultation paper in September, following pushback from market participants over a liquidity squeeze during the auction.

The paper outlined two options for calculating closing prices on derivatives expiry days: adopt a blended VWAP-based methodology or retain the existing VWAP calculation based on the last 30 minutes of continuous trading on settlement days for at least a year.

Unlike a simple average, VWAP takes into account both the price and volume of trades. For instance, if 100 shares are traded at ₹10 each and 50 shares at ₹12 each, the WAP is ₹10.67, compared with a simple average price of ₹11. On the other hand, a CAS uses an auction to match orders and derive the closing price.

CAS will now run from 3:30 pm to 3:40 pm. REUTERS

Many market participants have urged Sebi to retain VWAP-based settlement pricing on expiry days-Tuesday for Nifty options and Thursday for Sensex options-and introduce blended pricing on non-expiry days for a year before transitioning fully to the blended framework.

CAS, introduced in August, led to abrupt price swings on expiry day, making it difficult for traders to participate in the futures and options (F&O) segment.

Initial operational challenges, including the need for market participants to modify their trading software and the early closure of the continuous trading session (CTS), have kept some participants, including arbitrage funds, away. Passive funds such as exchange-traded funds (ETFs) and index funds have been more active in the auction.

For the rest of the market, Sebi has reduced the transition period between continuous trading (CTS) to CAS from five minutes to one minute.

CAS would now run from 3:30 pm to 3:40 pm.

Trading in index derivatives contracts would continue until 3:45 pm. On expiry day however, trading in index derivatives contracts will stop at 3:30 pm.

India's merchandise exports rise 18.5% in first half of FY27

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NEW DELHI: India's overall merchandise exports rose over 18.5% to a record $260 billion in the first half of the current financial year, and may close the year on a high. Unveiling trade data for the first half (April-September) of 2026-27, commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal said India's overall exports are on a fast-track, led by merchandise exports. "If the trend of last year continues, where merchandise exports in second half of the year were higher than the first half of the year, then we are looking at the merchandise exports much ahead of $500 billion in the current (financial) year."

Cumulative merchandise export in the first half (H1) of 2026-27 stood at $259.89 billion as against $219.30 billion in H1 of 2025-26, registering 18.51% growth. Estimated service exports in H1 of FY27 crossed $216.31 billion, up 8.69% from $199.02 billion in April-September 2025-26, data showed.

Merchandise trade deficit in H1 FY27 was $177.64 billion. AFP

Overall exports (merchandise and services combined) in H1 of 2026-27 were estimated at $476.20 billion, registering a 13.84% increase over $418.31 billion in H1 of 2025-26. Services data for September are estimates, a conservative extrapolation of the previous month's numbers, as RBI releases figures for the services sector with a lag.

As trade performance of the second-half is often better than the first half, it is expected that overall exports in the full financial year 2026-27 would meet the $1 trillion target set by commerce minister Piyush Goyal, a government spokesperson said.

Overall imports (goods and services) jumped 15.68% to an estimated $551.13 billion in H1 of FY27, compared to $476.42 billion. Trade deficit jumped by 28.96% to $74.93 billion in H1 of FY27 compared to $58.10 billion in the same period last year. Trade deficit could have been more but for significant trade surplus in services exports, according to the data. Merchandise trade deficit alone in H1 (2026-27) was $177.64 billion, compared to $156.88 billion in April-September 2025-26.

In September 2026, India's merchandise exports jumped 23.06% to $44.40 billion from $36.08 billion in September 2025 while imports increased by 8% to $74.61 billion compared to $69.08 billion in the same month last year.

Unemployment falls for fifth straight month

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NEW DELHI: India's headline unemployment rate came in at 5% in September, lower than the 5.3% unemployment rate recorded in September last year, according to the monthly bulletin of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) published by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Thursday. However, youth unemployment increased from 15% in September 2025 to 15.2% in September 2026.

This makes September the fifth consecutive month when the headline unemployment rate has decreased year-on-year and at least the sixth consecutive month when youth unemployment rate has increased year-on-year. Year-on-year changes in monthly employment statistics can only be tracked since April because monthly PLFS bulletins are only available from April 2025 onwards. Labour statistics are usually compared for the same period across years because some jobs, such as those in agriculture, are seasonal.

The pace of change in unemployment rate also changed in September. The decline in overall unemployment rate was faster in the month. Overall unemployment rate declined by 30 basis points – one basis point is one hundredth of a percentage point – in September compared to a 10 basis points decline in each month from May to August.

On the other hand, the rise in youth unemployment rate -- the unemployment rate in the 15-29 years age group, the only specific age group for which monthly bulletins give data – was slower in the month. It increased 20 basis points year-on-year in September compared to 0.5-1.5 percentage points growth seen from April to August.

The share of youth working or looking for a job – called the labour force participation rate (LFPR) – declined 10 basis points to 41.2%.

BlackRock, ADIA, Norges eye Jio anchor book

Agnidev Bhattacharya and Sneha Shah
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MUMBAI: Global investors and sovereign wealth funds are eyeing allocations in the anchor book of Jio Platforms Ltd's public offering, according to four people familiar with the matter.

The potential investors include Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, Qatar Investment Authority, GIC Pte. Ltd, Norges Bank Investment Management and Mubadala Investment Co., alongside asset managers BlackRock Inc. and FMR LLC, these people said on condition of anonymity.

About 15 domestic asset managers, including HDFC Mutual Fund, SBI Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Nippon Life India Asset Management and Motilal Oswal Asset Management, have also submitted indications of interest for a share of Jio's ₹8,000-crore anchor book, the people said.

The asset management arms of Goldman Sachs and Franklin Templeton are also considering anchor investments, the people said.

While ADIA, Motilal and Norges declined to comment, representatives of Jio's parent company, Reliance Industries Ltd, as well as other institutional investors and fund managers, did not respond to requests for comment.

The telecom giant's parent filed its red herring prospectus with the Securities and Exchange Board of India on Wednesday for an initial public offering (IPO) that will raise around ₹30,200 crore, or about $3.2 billion, at the upper end of the 1,069-1,119 per share price band announced. The anchor allocation window, which precedes the public subscription period, allows institutional entities to secure share allotments before the main issue opens.

Up to 60% of the portion reserved for qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) can be allocated to anchor investors. Half of the anchor portion is reserved for domestic mutual funds. Final share allocations for the anchor book are scheduled to be finalized ahead of the opening of the retail and non-institutional bidding windows.

The three-day subscription window opens on 21 October. Shares are slated to start trading on 28 October.

Jio operates digital services and telecommunications infrastructure across India. Its existing equity holders include Meta Platforms Inc., Alphabet Inc.'s Google, KKR & Co., Silver Lake and General Atlantic.

The Jio Platforms IPO will raise around ₹30,200 crore. AP

At a press conference on Wednesday, which saw Anant Ambani, Shloka Ambani and other key CXOs of Jio Platforms seated in the front row, Uday Kotak, chairman of left lead merchant banker Kotak Investment Banking, said, "Reliance Industries (...) has always believed in making it attractive for investors to be long-term with the group."

Anant Ambani is an executive director on the board of RIL and non-executive director at Jio Platforms, while Shloka is the wife of managing director Akash Ambani.

Kotak said: "Akash Ambani has discussed in detail (at institutional roadshows) the various trends of Jio Platforms, including scale, growth, and the fact that significant capital expenditure has already been done and it's already put in place."

AIR INDIA SETS UP COST REVIEW TEAM

Tata Group-owned Air India has established a full-time team to systematically review expenditure and identify cost-saving opportunities across the airline, in an attempt to embed cost consciousness, frugality and disciplined decision-making into its culture.

In his first internal communication to airline employees, Air India's chief executive officer (CEO) Tewolde Gebremariam said cost savings could not be driven by a single team or function and required the active participation and commitment of every employee.

"Cost consciousness must become part of our culture," the CEO said, adding that alongside operational excellence, the airline needed to embed "a mindset of frugality, accountability, and thoughtful decision-making in everything we do". "Cost savings cannot be driven by a single team or function alone," he said. HTC

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

Across

1 She will shortly angle for seafood (9)
8 Architectural highlight (5)
9 A number leave one country for another (7)
10 Note article cannot be reduced (6)
11 It's old perhaps and not easily moved (6)
12 Intrude by chance or accident (8)
15 He had a model mother (8)
18 Put in charge again (6)
20 Do they keep to the beaten track? (6)
21 Fish and turtle photographer? (7)
22 Many pieces of wood made to last? (5)
23 Shop early for capers (9)

Down

2 A hunt for the den of criminals (5)
3 Yet all has been changed recently (6)
4 Just treatment for honest card-players (4,4)
5 He is or could be a shopkeeper (6)
6 Excavate almost everything with the fingers (7)
7 Straight thinking on what decongestants do (5,4)
11 Indicate where to find a tourist attraction (9)
13 Dog raves after fruit (8)
14 Unmarried woman I took on for a job (7)
16 Songster's throat infection (6)
17 Do wrong in bringing up students (4,2)
19 Region holding northern sports venue (5)

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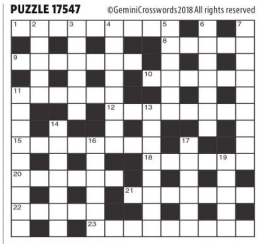

QUICK CLUES

Across

1 Wealth (9)
8 Defect (5)
9 Seclusion (7)
10 Deplorable (6)
11 Experienced adviser (6)
12 Decisive (8)
15 Clearly expressive (8)
18 Make possible (6)
20 Mass departure (6)
21 Intolerantly entrenched prejudice (7)
22 A durable twilled fabric (5)
23 Courageous deeds (7-2)

Down

2 Ridiculous proceedings (5)
3 Flippancy (6)
4 Pass completely round (8)
5 Exertion (6)
6 Be enough (7)
7 Painting of inanimate objects (5,4)
11 Stand to reason (4,5)
13 Country's domestic affairs (8)
14 Temporary stay (7)
16 Not accustomed (6)
17 Leave stranded (6)
19 Sensational (5)

SOLUTIONS FOR 17546

Cryptic

D	E	P	L	E	T	E	■	A	T	L	A	S	■	■
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G	■	I	■	V	■	T	■	S	■	R	■	T	■	■
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■	■	N	■	R	■	R	■	S	■	O	■	■	■	■
R	E	C	I	T	E	■	S	O	C	C	E	R	■	■
E	■	I	■	A	■	P	■	H	■	■	■	■	■	■
L	■	B	L	O	C	K	H	O	U	S	E	■	■	■
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Quick

C	H	A	U	C	E	R	■	C	O	V	E	R	■	■
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O	N	O	C	C	A	S	I	O	N	■	I	■	■	■
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J	A	C	K	A	L	■	U	N	S	A	F	E	■	■
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Y	■	S	E	E	T	H	R	O	U	G	H	■	■	■
R	■	S	H	■	R	■	S	■	R	■	A	■	■	■
I	N	C	L	O	V	E	R	■	J	A	M	B	■	■
D	■	A	■	M	■	S	■	■	T	■	I	■	■	■
E	Y	R	I	E	■	S	U	B	J	E	C	T	■	■

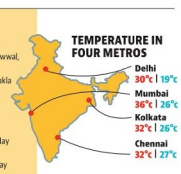
{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ▪HIGH ▪LOW

FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
Thunderstorm with rain	Partly cloudy sky	Mainly clear sky
36°c | 26°c	37°c | 25°c	36°c | 26°c

ALMANAC
Today is 16th October 2026
04 Jumada Al-Awwal, 1448
21, Ashwina, Shukla Paksha, 6 Samvat 2083
Sunset: Friday at 06:15 pm
Sunrise: Saturday at 06:33 am
Moonrise: Friday at 11:26 am
Moonset: Friday at 10:24 pm

TEMPERATURE IN FOUR METROS



SPORT

Sixes galore as India, WI look to hit caution out of the park

With 98 sixes in four matches, the ongoing series is threatening to rewrite record

Samreen Razzaqui
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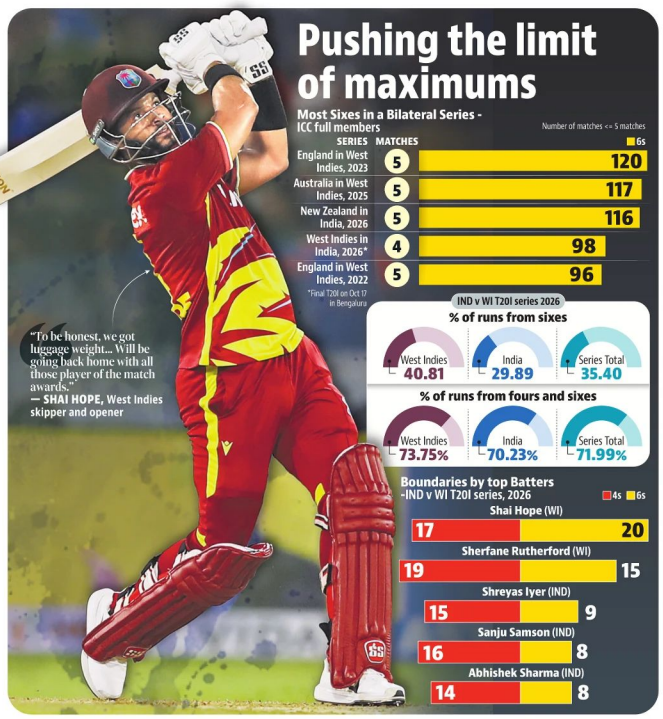
NEW DELHI: There was a time when hitting a six was considered a risk, an audacious shot reserved for situations that demanded something extraordinary. When Shai Hope and Sherfane Rutherford unleashed a six-hitting spree in Hyderabad, they offered a reminder of how much T20 cricket has changed. As the format continues to push the boundaries of the possible, what was once extraordinary has now become routine.

In the ongoing five-match T20I series between India and West Indies, the four matches have produced a staggering 98 sixes. According to CricViz, of the 1,661 runs scored between the two sides, 1,196 runs have come off boundaries and 588 have come from sixes alone. Essentially, 35.40% of runs have come from sixes. And there is still one match to go.

The series is already among the most prolific six-hitting bilateral contests involving ICC full members. In the final T20I at Bengaluru, the record of most sixes scored in a bilateral T20I series could be broken. Another 23 sixes in the final game would take the tally past the 120 recorded during England's five-match tour of West Indies in 2023, which remains the ceiling at the moment.



Sixes across phases

The evolution of T20 batting also suggests that batters are not necessarily waiting for the final overs or just a loose delivery to clear the ropes. Instead, the ability to hit sixes has become a skill to be deployed throughout an innings.

In this series, India concentrated their six-hitting during the Powerplay, scoring 14 sixes compared to West Indies' 10. Interestingly, West Indies have hit 27 sixes in the middle overs, compared with India's 16. They hit another 20 at the death against India's 11. In all, more than 82% of West Indies' sixes have come after the Powerplay.

While India with its explosive top-order comprising the likes of Abhishek Sharma, Sanju Samson or Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Ishan Kishan continue to go gung-ho in the powerplays, for West Indies' the middle overs seem to have become another opportunity to attack. It is one of the most obvious departures from the traditional understanding of the middle overs as a period of consolidation, when batters would rotate the strike, preserve wickets and build towards a final assault.

There also emerged a distinct approach even in this collective appetite for power-hitting. There is no doubt that both sides relied heavily on boundaries. India scored 124 runs in boundaries compared to West Indies' 126.

India, however, prefer to hit more fours – 83 compared with 69 while West Indies have struck 57 sixes to India's 41. West Indies sixes have accounted for a remarkable 40.81% of their runs, while India's figures stand at 29.89%.

West Indies, in this series, have preferred to clear the field altogether. India have found a more even balance between finding the gaps and clearing the ropes.

Hope's approach

Shai Hope's batting in this series has been special. He has piled up five 50+ scores across ODIs and T20Is, of which four were centuries. His case is particularly intriguing. Long associated with a more measured style of batting, his six-hitting numbers offer a glimpse into how batters traditionally known for constructing innings are also adapting to the increasingly aggressive demands of T20 cricket.

Hope has struck 20 sixes in the series, while Sherfane Rutherford has contributed another 15. Between them, they have cleared the ropes 35 times — just six fewer than the entire Indian batting line-up.

India, meanwhile, are more spread out as there is no single dominant six-hitter in India's line-up comparable to Hope. Instead, several batters have contributed to the team's boundary-scoring output.

Interestingly, in a line-up with Samson and Abhishek who have hit eight sixes, it is actually Shreyas Iyer who has led India's six-hitting charts with nine sixes.

Since six-hitting is no longer seen as audacious but routine, many batters are using sixes as a repeatable scoring option even when the required run rate does not demand immediate aggression. For instance, West Indies' batting approach in the fourth T20I in Hyderabad where they scored 247/3 came while batting first, not in a condition necessarily with pressure. That evolution has consequences for bowlers, too. If batters are prepared to attack throughout an innings, even reasonably good deliveries can disappear into the stands. In this series, Axar Patel (14) and Naman Dhir (12) have conceded the most sixes even though they have managed to pick up wickets.

{ SANJAY BANGAR } FORMER INDIA ASSISTANT COACH

'NZ is a frontier which most teams have not conquered'

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MUMBAI: New Zealand have proved to be formidable opponents for India in Tests. They have beaten India in six of the last eight Tests including the 2021 WTC final. They whitewashed India in India in 2024. The last time the two met in New Zealand (2019/20), the hosts won both Tests.

India tour New Zealand again this month for a long limited overs series followed by two Tests — India's second last series in the WTC — and expectedly there's interest surrounding the series.

Speaking on the sidelines of the reopening of the Spin & Swing Cricket Academy, headed by Anand Yalvigi, at the Matunga Gymkhana on Thursday, former India assistant coach Sanjay Bangar shared his views on the challenges for the Shubman Gill-led Test team on the upcoming tour.

Bangar played in New Zealand during the 2002-03 Test and ODI series and later coached during the 2015 ODI World Cup and 2019 limited overs series. Excerpts:

What do you make of the series against New Zealand?

We have two Tests against New Zealand and five against Australia. India have done well overseas, even in England, Australia and South Africa but New Zealand has been a frontier which most teams have not conquered. So, I think that is going to be a motivating factor for this group of players.

What is it about NZ that the Indian team finds tough?

They play to the dimensions really well, that is No. 1, No. 2, the wickets out there, they sort of take the spinners out of the equation. So, whether India will be having a combination wherein to take 20 wickets and having that seam bowling allrounder, that generally becomes the critical part. And if India's batting clicks in the first innings of the Tests, then there is a possibility (of doing well). These factors are important for any travelling team in New Zealand. Basically, score well and have a pace attack which can take 20 wickets.

The wickets in NZ will benefit Bumrah and Siraj...

I think the support bowlers will also be crucial because if Prasidh Krishna and Akash Deep play, that leaves the lower order a bit thin. But if those four play together, India have the resources to bowl New Zealand out twice. It all depends on whether everybody remains fit. The good part is that (Jasprit) Bumrah's workload has been managed well leading into this series, which is important if India have to qualify (for the WTC final). I expect India to do well in the home series against Australia. But if India do not have a good NZ series, then India could be out of contention (in the WTC).

Batting in NZ conditions is always a challenge. KL Rahul is there but overall India's batting line-up is relatively inexperienced...

I think it has settled down quite well. If you think once Rohit (Sharma) and Virat (Kohli) were not part of the scheme of things, it took some time. But now you have Devdutt Padikkal amongst the runs batting at 3, Gill is doing really well. Dhruv Jurel has been a good addition and he has batted well even as a specialist.

So, I think if you look at the 6 batters that might play, they do seem to have the experience of performing well in all conditions and add to that if (Ravindra) Jadeja plays at 7 and then you follow it up with 4 fast bowlers or whether they play 3 fast bowlers and 1 pace bowling all-rounder. So, I think that is the most critical part. That number 7 and 8 spot and more so the pace bowling all-rounder becomes critical to India having a good New Zealand series.

From the ODI World Cup point of view, in terms of preparation how important is this series going to be?

I don't think it's too much importance attached to the New Zealand series versus what is going to happen in South Africa (in the ODI World Cup). But it is a lead-up to it. It's a quite gradual build-up. If Shreyas(Iyer) is fit and he gets back at No.4, then India has a very settled one-day team. Again, the bowlers especially who are challenging for those spots, they will be looked at into how consistently they can deliver.

So, along with Bumrah who are the bowlers who are being identified for the World Cup and how they fare well from here on is going to be one thing which selectors as well as the team management will have a closer eye on.

{ SANJAY BANGAR } ON NZ SERIES

That No. 7 and 8 spots and more so, the pace bowling all-rounder becomes critical to India having a good series against the Kiwis

More wins historic U23 wrestling medal

LAS VEGAS: Vishvajit More became the first Indian Greco-Roman wrestler to win a silver medal at the U23 World Championship while Komal and Diksha Malik remain in bronze medal contention here. More, who already has two U23 World Championship bronze medals to his collection, was gunning for a historic gold but lost the fiercely fought final 12-13 to Georgia's Koba Karumidze.

Khangurra assured of BWF World Jr medal

CAIRO: India's Jagsher Singh Khangurra assured himself of a medal at the Badminton World Juniors after rallying to beat Chinese Taipei's Yuan-Syue Jhuang 6-15, 17-15, 15-12 at the Cairo International Stadium. Khangurra saved a match point in the second game. The Punjab shuttler had earlier defeated Malaysia's Lee Qian Chong 15-8, 15-8 in the pre-quarterfinals on Thursday.

Chola Chiefs end APL winless streak

HYDERABAD: Struggling Chola Chiefs managed to snap their five-match losing streak as they beat Prithviraaj Yodhas in a thrilling Archery Premier League match. The match was decided via Hit-or-Miss shoot-off after a 4-4 draw in regulation time. For the Chiefs, Colombia's Alejandra Usquiano and India's Yuktha Sri Kondapavuluri landed their arrows in the golden X-ring.

Think big and stop in-fighting: Minister tells federations

Shantanu Srivastava
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NEW DELHI: Union sports minister Mansukh Mandaviya met representatives of National Sports Federations (NSFs) on Thursday to review the performances at the Asian Games. India finished fourth on the medals table with 85 medals (21 gold, 27 silver, 37 bronze), well behind China (341), Japan (269) and South Korea (150).

Athletics emerged the top performer with 24 medals, although with only one gold, while shooters bagged 15 podium finishes. India had won 106 medals at 2023 Hangzhou, including 28 gold.

"It was an honest conversation. Most sports federations that had sent teams to the Asian Games were represented. The meeting lasted over two hours and the underlying issues in most NSFs was discussed," a sports ministry official told HT.

The minister, it is learned, also asked the NSFs to set aside their internal politics.

"The ministry wants NSFs to become solution-oriented and not problem-oriented. It was also noted that a lot of sports federations are riven by internal politics and the minister asked them to set aside their internal differences and work towards a common goal.

"We want the NSFs to think long term, which means better talent scouting and grooming. Also, going into major competitions, we want the medal estimations to be accurate and realistic. The Los Angeles 2028 Olympics, 2030 Commonwealth Games and the 2030 Asian Games in Doha are our next targets," the official said.

The Boxing Federation of India (BFI) was represented by president Ajay Singh, but the strife within the body didn't come up for discussion, the official said.

"How long will Mirabai Chanu alone keep winning medals for us? We need to produce 10 more Mirabais. Every federation must take this responsibility seriously. We have to identify talent, provide the right training and create an environment in which athletes can progress to the highest level," Mandaviya said.

Mandaviya emphasised the need for more sports psychologists, sports science experts and high-performance mental trainers to help athletes when they compete on major international stages. He also urged every NSF to introduce more competitions, strengthen athlete preparation, work with commitment and carry out honest assessment of gaps in performance and administration.

The minister of state for sports, Raksha Khadse called for the federations to align their work with the vision of Khelo India Mission. "Every NSF must ensure that state and district-level federations are also in place and functioning effectively. This work has to be undertaken wholeheartedly, alongside talent identification. Identifying talent is only one part of the process; athletes must also receive the correct training and support to reach their potential," Khadse said.

PSG beat City in thriller; Barcola trick in Reds win

Agencies
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

PARIS: Reigning champions Paris Saint-Germain romped to a 4-2 victory away to embattled Manchester City in the UEFA Champions League on Wednesday, while Bradley Barcola hit his first Liverpool goals with a hat-trick in a 6-3 win over LASK in Austria.

Elsewhere on a prolific night of European action, Real Madrid came from 3-1 down to beat Roma 4-3 and Aston Villa demolished Fenerbahce 6-0 at Villa Park.

City were playing at home at the Etihad Stadium for the first time since being found guilty of serious breaches of the Premier League's financial rules over almost a decade that have left them facing the prospect of severe sanctions.

That verdict appeared to be hanging over the City team as PSG raced into a three-goal lead just past the half-hour mark, with Desire Doue, Ousmane Dembele and Vitinha all netting for the French side.

With former boss Pep Guardiola watching on, City produced a second-half fightback as Erling Haaland scored twice to take him to four Champions League goals already this season.

However, PSG got a fourth in between the Norwegian's strikes, with City goalkeeper Gianluigi Donnarumma unable to keep out a Maghnes Akliouche shot.

Donnarumma later made some amends by saving a Ferran Torres penalty, but City succumbed by the same margin as in their last Champions League meeting with PSG in January 2025.

"In the first half we were far superior to a great City side," Paris coach Luis Enrique told broadcaster Canal Plus. "You can think these games are over but it is never the case at this level, and we could have ended up losing."

Back-to-back title-holders PSG have won both Champions League games this season, scoring 10 goals in the process. They face Barcelona next week.

"Even with 3-0 in the first half, with the amount of chances we created in the second half, we deserved more," City coach Enzo Maresca told TNT Sports.

Barcola, a big-money summer signing from PSG, had not found the net for Liverpool before scoring three times at the Raiffeisen Arena after Ronald Araujo had broken the deadlock against the Austrian champions.

Jeremie Frimpong and Lewis Koumas also netted for Andoni Iraola's side, who were 4-0 ahead at one point before LASK scored three times in the space of 15 second-half minutes through Robert Ljubicic and Florian Flecker's brace.

"Obviously I think he has to enjoy this because to score a hat-trick in the Champions League is always very difficult," said Iraola of France forward Barcola.

PSG's Ousmane Dembele (L) celebrates after scoring against Manchester City at the Etihad Stadium on Wednesday. AFP

RESULTS: Feyenoord (NED) 3 Como (ITA) 2; **Linz (AUT) 3** Liverpool (ENG) 6; **Aston Villa (ENG) 6** Fenerbahce (TUR) 0; **Bodo/Glimt (NOR) 1** Dortmund (GER) 0; **Man City (ENG) 2** PSG (FRA) 4; **Real Betis (ESP) 3** Porto (POR) 2; **Roma (ITA) 3** Real Madrid (ESP) 4; **Shakhtar Donetsk (UKR) 3** AEK Athens (GRE) 1; **Slovan Bratislava (SVK) 0** Stuttgart (GER) 3

The work put in when I was out is helping now: Shafali

Samreen Razzaqui
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NEW DELHI: As far as comeback stories go, Shafali Verma's is right up there. From being out of favour despite piling on the runs in domestic cricket to becoming player of the match in the ODI World Cup final and now, being appointed deputy to captain Smriti Mandhana, the Haryana opener is feeling right at home with her new responsibility.

Ahead of India's first assignment with the new leadership duo of Mandhana and Verma against Zimbabwe, the 22-year-old has her plans set for the Indian team in the shortest format. "I have also captained the team in the 2019 World Cup, so I have that experience. I know vice-captaincy is not just a title; it is a big responsibility," Verma told reporters ahead of the first T20I in Raipur.

"We have to look after every player and ensure they are in a good headspace. I am trying to make everyone comfortable and help the captain."

Recalling the memorable final in Mumbai last year where she scored 87 off 78 and picked up 2/36 against South Africa, she said the work she put in behind the scenes came in handy when the team needed her to step up. Interestingly, Verma wasn't even in the reserve players list travelling with the team then. Only an injury to Pratika Rawal in the semi-final opened the doors for her.

"When Pratika got injured, I got a direct call-up. Luckily, at that time, I was playing state games for Haryana. In 2025, I worked a lot on myself and did everything alongside my cricket, as I have said before. I think the hard work I put in during 2025 has helped me a lot now. I am just trying to keep my head down and continue learning. Every day and with every experience, I am trying to learn something new," she said.

Shafali Verma. PTI

Harmanpreet Kaur during her captaincy also relied on her bowling to provide breakthroughs. Since 2025, she has picked up 15 international wickets across formats.

"Bowling is nothing new for me because I have been bowling for Haryana since 2021. When I used to bowl for Haryana, I would think that someday I would have to bowl for India. So, I mentally prepared myself for that possibility," she added.

"I used to think about how I would prepare if I got the opportunity to bowl for the Indian team. By God's grace, that opportunity came, and I was already mentally prepared."

MANSEBDAR'S 7/42 PUTS GENERAL EDUCATION ON FRONT FOOT

HT Correspondent
sportm@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Shamsuddin Mansebdar took seven wickets for 42 runs as General Education Academy bowled out Parag English School for 67 before finishing Day 1 on 219/2 in their second round U16 Harris Shield match on Thursday.

Brief scores: Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Vidyalaya 274/9 (Advit Tiwari 105, Dhiaan Barai 41, Akshay Akrikeri 36*, Shani Zaware 34; Kshitij Morgaonkar 3/56) vs **Anjuman Allana CSMT. Anjuman Khairul Islam** 283/9 (Mayank Singh 112, Umair Khan 63; Ansh Mali 4/48) vs **High School Sanpada. Parag English School** 67 (Shamsuddin Mansebdar 7/42) vs **General Education Academy** 219/2 (Shardul Fagare 98*, Sparsh Gholap 58, Viren Atole 53). Chembur Karnataka 117 (Vignesh Shinde 34; Jayant Waghule 5/21) vs **Swami Vivekanand International** 49/1. **Parle Tilak English School** 35 (Golu Pal 5/14, Atul Chowdhary 3/10) vs **Dyandeep Seva Mandal** 240/8 (Lavish Singh 57, Shriyush Chavan 51, Aryan Yadav 49*, Shivam Singh 32; Devraj Kamthe 4/78, Parth Phadke 3/53). **IES VN Sule Guruji** 219/8 (Eshan Kale 68, Gaurik Nandanwar 40; Kavish Duggar 3/37, Moksh Shah 3/47) vs **Sitaram Prakash. Al Barkaat** 116 (Nitin Gurav 4/28) vs **New English School** 55/6 (Aditya Pandey 3/13). **Rizvi Springfield** 77 (Nishad Parab 3/16, Shubh Shetty 3/23) vs **Modern English School** 76/8 (Abdul Khatri 6/32).

'Surprised' Norgaard in sole lead after birdie blitz on rain-hit day

Shantanu Srivastava
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Restraint off the tee and accuracy on the fairways. That's been the cheat code to tame the Delhi Golf Club in the build-up to the DP World India Championship, and come rain or shine, the adage holds true. The rain did come on Thursday, bringing a delay lasting four hours and fifty minutes. Through it all, the guiding principles of navigating the narrow fairways and thick roughs stood firmer than ever.

When the hooter sounded to mark the end of play, Denmark's Niklas Norgaard had surged to a solo lead, firing six-under and leaving the trio of Tom McKibbin, Thomas Detry, and Eugenio Chacarra one shot behind.

Norgaard was in danger of losing his card in late August but finished second at the Husqvarna British Masters and secured another runner-up finish at the Alfred Dunhill Links Championship to regain form.

The big-hitter carded an eagle, six birdies and two bogeys and revealed he surprised himself on a short and narrow lay-out that takes the driver out of the equation.

"I'm very, very happy," he said. "A bit surprised as well. This should not suit me at all. It pretty much just neutralises my best weapon, which is my driver. But I just managed to make no big mistakes, put the irons in play, and putt pretty well.

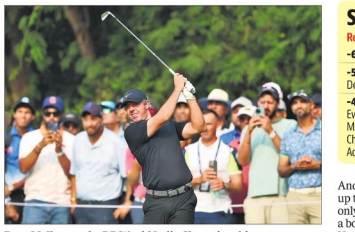
"I had a tough year until August and I think what happened at Belfry (the venue of the British Masters) made me regain my confidence. I didn't think that I'd been playing that bad but I just needed something to spark it and that's what the Belfry did," he said.

Starting on the tenth tee, Norgaard sank birdies on the par 5 14th and par 4 15th holes before bogeying on the 16th. A birdie on the 18th was followed by an eagle in the par 5 first, a 5-iron off the tee setting things in motion.

"I thought maybe I'd been playing a little bit too conservatively. So I said, no matter what happens, I am going to go for it. And then I went for it and hit it up to 4 feet," the Dane said. The only other blip in the round was a bogey on the par 3 seventh but Norgaard more than made up for it with birdies on the two closing holes (8th and 9th).

Six-time major winner Rory McIlroy and defending champion Tommy Fleetwood were tied-13th after contrasting rounds. While Rory was steady — four birdies and two bogeys — Fleetwood dropped 11 places on his final hole (ninth), thanks to a crushing double bogey.

Among the Indians, Om Prakash Chouhan was the top performer, carding 4-under to take the tied fifth spot. As many as 12 players were unable to tee off.



Rory McIlroy at the DP World India Championship. GETTY IMAGES

Scores

Rd 1 (clubhouse leaderboard)

-6 (66) Niklas Norgaard

-5 (67) Tom Mckibbin, Thomas Detry, Eugenio Chacarra

-4 (68) Scott Jamieson, Ewen Ferguson, Robert MacIntyre, Om Prakash Chouhan, Marcus Armitage, Adrian Meronk

Modi lauds Asiad medallists

HT Correspondent
sportm@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Telling the athletes that being in their presence filled him with pride, Prime Minister Narendra Modi met India's Asian Games medal-winners at the Major Dhyan Chand Stadium in New Delhi on Thursday.

In a rousing speech, PM Modi lauded the country's athletes who delivered 85 medals, including 21 gold, at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games. "You have made 140 crore Indians proud. The biggest success is to increase the prestige and respect of the Tricolour. That is what you have done. And that is why your success isn't just yours, but also of the crores of people in the country," Modi said in his speech.

In the audience sat the country's medal winners, including members of both the hockey teams, the women's cricket team scheduled to play Zimbabwe in a T20I in Raipur on Friday, and the men's cricket team that played West Indies in a T20I in Hyderabad on Wednesday.

The PM was presented with a range of memorabilia – from a bow by 17-year-old recurve archer and twice gold medallist Kumkum Mohod, to a glove and golf ball by history-setter in golf Pranavi Urs, to a hockey stick by the women's team.

Modi especially congratulated the women athletes. From India's 85 medal winners, 38 were women, 11 of them gold medallists. "These medals are not just numbers. They are a strong representation of the new India," said Modi.

Medals in sports like MMA and soft tennis were signs that Indians are also making their mark in other sports. "Today, India is rising in the kind of sports where we had no medals ever at the Asian Games," said the PM.

"There was a time when India would win only a handful of medals in big tournaments."

Modi added that Indian athletes have to keep working to continue scaling more heights. The PM also reiterated India's desire to host the 2036 Olympics.

"We have big dreams. We also have a big self-belief of fulfilling them," Modi said.

Kumkum Mohod presents a bow to PM Narendra Modi. PTI

RAGHUVANSHI, SHEDGE ADDED TO MUMBAI SQUAD

MUMBAI: Opening batter Angkrish Raghuvanshi and all-rounder Suryansh Shedge have been added to the Mumbai squad for their Ranji Trophy second round game against Himachal Pradesh.

Mumbai will be without their first-choice openers, Yashasvi Jaiswal and Ayush Mhatre, who played in the opener against Chandigarh. Mhatre is ruled out due to a hamstring injury while Jaiswal will be away on India A duty in New Zealand. Divyaansh Saxena is the other opening option. Shedge performed well for India A in the 50-overs games against Australia A.

Squad: A Raghuvanshi, S Shedge, D Saxsena, S Lad, S Khan, M Khan, S Parkar, A Anand, H Tamore, S Mulani, T Kotian, A Ankolekar, T Deshpande, M Awasthi, S Dsouza, O Tarmale. HTC

U.T. ADMINISTRATION OF DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU

DEPARTMENT OF YOUTH AFFAIRS & SPORTS, DNH & DD

NOTICE

Request for Proposal for Engagement of an Event Managment Agency for Opening and Closing ceremony for 3rd Edition of Khelo India Beach Games 2027

RFP No.DMN/SPORTS/KIBG-EMA-O&C/2026-27/358 Dated:14/10/2026

Tender Reference No.:SPRTS/KIBG-EMA-OC/2026-27/ 358 Dated:14/10/2026

Tender ID:2026_DAMAN_5016_1

For details please scan http://ddd.gov.in

Last Date of Submission of Bid:21/10/2026 upto 06:00 PM

Director-cum-Joint Secretary (YA&S), DNH & DD

NO:IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/588 Date:15.10.2026

INTERNATIONAL FINANCIAL SERVICES CENTRES AUTHORITY
2nd and 3rd Floor, Pragya Tower, GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat

File No. 73/IFSCA/Consultants/2020-21 October 9, 2026

VACANCY NOTIFICATION

International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), a statutory unified regulatory body under the Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Government of India, invites applications from eligible Indian citizens for filling up various positions of Young Professionals/consultants on contract basis. The place of posting is GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

2. The candidates willing to apply are requested to refer **www.ifsca.gov.in/career** for detailed vacancy notification/s and corrigenda issued.

General Manager
CBC 15228/11/0002/2627 **Dept. of General Administration**

ऑयल इंडिया लिमिटेड
ऑयल इंडिया OIL INDIA **Oil India Limited**

P.O. Duliajan - 786602. Assam, India. CIN: L11101AS1959GOI001148

(Advertisement No: HRAQ/ REC–EX-B/2026-03 Dated 15/10/2026)

RECRUITMENT OF EXECUTIVES IN GRADE A, B & C IN OIL

OIL INDIA LIMITED (OIL), a Maharatna Public Sector Undertaking, invites online applications from eligible Indian Nationals, to fill up the following posts:

A. In 'Grade A' in the pay scale of ₹ 50,000 to 1,60,000:

Post Name & Post Code
Hindi Officer (Official Language) Post Code: HO-05
Confidential Secretary Post Code: CS-06

B. In 'Grade B' in the pay scale of ₹ 60,000 to 1,80,000:

Post Name & Post Code
Senior Officer (Mechanical) Post Code: ME-02
Senior Officer (Petroleum) Post Code: PE-03
Senior Accounts Officer / Senior Internal Auditor Post Code: AC-04

C. In 'Grade C' in the pay scale of ₹ 80,000 to 2,20,000:

Post Name & Post Code
Superintending Research Scientist Post Code: CH-01

The last date of receipt of Online Application is 11:00 Hours on 14/11/2026
For details visit: https://www.oil-india.com/advertisement-list

NAVODAYA VIDYALAYA SAMITI
PM SHRI
An Autonomous Organization under Ministry of Education
B-15, Sector-62, Gautam Buddha Nagar
Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201309

एफ.5–2(47)कक्षा–9 एवं 11/2027/नविस(लक्षे)/ दिनांक: 15.10.2026

NOTIFICATION FOR EXTENSION OF LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATIONS FOR CLASSES IX & XI LEST-2027

Online Registration portal for Lateral Entry Selection Test (LEST)-2027 for admission to classes IX & XI for the session (2027-28) was launched on 01.09.2026. The last date of submission of online application is further extended up to 22.10.2026. The candidates may apply free of cost by visiting the following links:

For class IX: https://cbseitms.nic.in/2026/nvsix_9

For class XI: https://cbseitms.nic.in/2026/nvsxi_11

The correction window will remain open from 23.10.2026 to 25.10.2026. Registered candidates make necessary corrections in the field of Category/Gender/Area/ Disability only.

ISSUED BY NAVODAYA VIDYALAYA SAMITI

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, गोरखपुर
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय भारत सरकार द्वारा स्थापित एक स्वायत्त निकाय)
(An autonomous organization under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)

Last date of online Receipt of Application: 14/11/2026 **Dated:15/10/2026**

FACULTY APPOINTMENTS

Professor/Additional Professor/Associate Professor/Assistant Professor

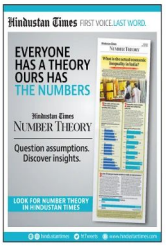
Offline applications from eligible Indian citizens/other citizens as permissible under the applicable Act/Rules are invited to fill up following faculty posts in All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh):

Sr. No.	Subject	Professor	Additional Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Anaesthesia	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
2.	Biochemistry	01 (ST)	-	-	-
3.	Cardiology	01 (UR)	-	-	-
4.	Cardiothoracic Surgery	-	-	01 (UR)	01 (SC)
5.	Dermatology	-	01 (OBC)	-	-
6.	ENT	01 (SC)	01 (SC)	01 (ST)	-
7.	Gastroenterology (Medical)	01 (EWS)	-	01 (OBC)	01 (OBC)
8.	General Medicine	01 (UR)	-	01 (UR)	04 (03- EWS, 01- OBC)
9.	Hospital Administration	01 (UR)	-	01 (OBC)	-
10.	Medical Oncology	-	-	-	01 (OBC)
11.	Microbiology	01 (ST)	-	-	-
12.	Neonatology	-	-	-	01 (ST)
13.	Nephrology	-	-	02 (01-SC, 01-EWS)	-
14.	Neurology	-	-	02 (01-OBC, 01-UR)	01 (SC)
15.	Neurosurgery	-	-	01 (ST)	-
16.	Nuclear Medicine	01 (OBC)	01 (OBC)	01 (UR)	01 (OBC)
17.	Ophthalmology	01 (EWS)	-	-	-
18.	Pathology	01 (SC)	01 (SC)	-	-
19.	Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation	01 (UR)	-	-	-
20.	Psychiatry	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
21.	Pulmonary Medicine	-	-	01 (SC)	-
22.	Radiology	-	01 (OBC)	02 (01-UR, 01-OBC)	04 (02-OBC, 01-SC, 01-ST)
23.	Radiotherapy	01 (SC)	-	-	-
24.	Surgical Gastroenterology	-	-	02 (01-ST, 01-EWS)	-
25.	Transfusion Medicine and Blood Bank	01 (OBC)	-	-	-
26.	Trauma and Emergency Medicine	-	-	-	03 (01-EWS, 01-SC, 01-ST)
27.	Urology	01 (EWS)	-	02 (01-UR, 01-SC)	-
	Total	**16**	**05**	**18**	**17**
	Grand Total		**56**		

The above vacancies are provisional and subject to variation. The Executive Director, AIIMS, Gorakhpur reserves the right to change the number of the vacancies including reserved vacancies as per the Govt. of India rules/circulars. **Application form along with department wise details of seats, reservation, terms and conditions etc. of the various posts are available on institute's website** www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in All the applicants are advised to check AIIMS, Gorakhpur website www.aiimsgorakhpur.edu.in on regular basis for any further updates.

SD/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Gorakhpur

Ref.No.- AIIMS/GKP/Admin./2026-27/2627 Date 15.10.2026



Mahatma Gandhi State Institute of Public Administration, Punjab
Institutional Area, Sector 26, Chandigarh 160019, India
Phone: +91-172-2793589/91 | Fax: +91-172-2793589/90 Extn: 400
Email: helpdesk.mgsipa@punjab.gov.in | Web: mgsipa.punjab.gov.in

APPOINTMENTS
[No. 9465 dated 14.10.2026]

MGSIPA invites applications for the following mentioned purely contractual position latest by 5.00 PM on 03.11.2026 (Tuesday):

Sr. No.	Name of the Specialism Centre	Name of the position	No. of positions	Consolidated monthly remuneration
1.	Disaster Management Centre	Senior Specialist	1 (One) for SC category)	Rs. 1,50,000/-

- For detailed information regarding eligibility criteria, terms and conditions, application procedure etc. log onto **www.mgsipa.punjab.gov.in**

Note: Any corrigendum(s) to this appointment notice shall be published on the above website only.

RO NO. 2018/12/2026/27/16243 Sd/- **Director General**

POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Enterprise)
"Vidyut Bhawan" Near ISBT Crossing, Saharanpur Road, Majra, Dehradun- 248002
Corporate ID : U40101UR2004SGC028675 Tel. No.: 0135-2642711

E-TENDER NOTICE

Power Transmission Corporation of Uttarakhand Limited invites E-Tender for "Laying of OPGW in one peak of 400 kV DC Tapovan (Vishnugad) - Pipalkoti Transmission line" against tender specification no. PTCUL/E-TENDER/C&P-I/TL-16/2026-27. The last date submission of e-bid is **18-11-2026 upto 15:30 Hrs.** For more details please visit e-tender website **www.uktenders.gov.in** (tender id no. 2026_PTCU1_101270_1) and for e-tender notice our website **www.ptcul.org**.

For any assistance on E-Tendering, Please contact +91-8899890000.

R.O. No.: 1969/HQPU/PTCUL/
Date : 15/10/2026

Superintending Engineer (C&P-I)

"Save Electricity in the Interest of Nation"

समाहरणालय, नवादा
(मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)
अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि नवादा जिलान्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना कान्डों / उत्पादवादों में राज्यसात किये गये निम्नलिखित वाहनों को बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत आम नीलामी (Public Auction) क्रमशः दिनांक **30.10.2026, 06.11.2026, 13.11.2026** को समाहरणालय, नवादा में 11:00 बजे पूर्वाहन से की जायेगी। नीलामी योग्य वाहनों की सूची निम्नवत है :–

क्र. सं.	थाना का नाम	थाना काण्ड संख्या	वाहन का प्रकार	निबंधन संख्या	निबंधन का वर्ष	इंजन संख्या	चेसिस संख्या	मूल्यांकित राशि	अग्रधन की राशि	वाहन की अवस्थिति	वाहन मालिक का विवरणी
01	उत्पाद थाना, नवादा	86/25	WAGONR CAR	**MH02BD/9102**	**17-Dec-07**	F10DN4426600	MA3EED81S0 0602452	**35000.00**	**8800.00**	शराब डिपो	मेहरिन मोहम्मद फारुक दलवानिया, पिता– नासवान वहेब, ग्राम– वकोला पाईप लाईन नेहरू रोड, थाना– सांताक्रुज ई मुंबई, मुंबई, (महाराष्ट्र)– 400055

1. विशेष जानकारी के लिए कार्यालय अधीक्षक मद्य निषेध, नवादा से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है nawada.bih.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No. 013723 (Excise) 2026-27

(कृते समाहर्त्ता, नवादा)
अधीक्षक मद्यनिषेध, नवादा

नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Mahad Public Works Division, Mahad-Raigad.
Email :- mahad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in Ph.No. 02145 222167

Tender Notice No.19 for 2026-27 II Call

Online percentage rate tenders in **B-1** Form are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Mahad, District Raigad 402301 for the following works from **Contractors registered in appropriate class** of the Public Works Department of Maharashtra State. The name of work, estimated cost, earnest money, security deposit, time limit for completion etc. The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Maharashtra e-tendering Portal **https://mahatenders.gov.in** as under

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (Rupees)	Bid Security (E.M.D.) (Rupees) via Online	Cost of Tender Form. (Rupees) via Online	Period of completion of work (including monsoon)	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Improvement to Chinchvali tarfe Atone to Kandale Belpada road VR 162 Km 0/00 to 3/500 Tal. Roha Dist. Raigad (5054, 04) II call	9999259/-	100000/-	1180/-	6 Months	Class IV A & Above
2.	Providing Furniture to Teacher Training Center Building at Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University at Lonere Taluka Mangaon, District Raigad.	3059111/-	31000/-	590/-	(6 Month)	Class V A
3.	Renovation to Appar Tahsildar residence and pther ancillary works at Mangaon Tal. Mangaon	2727842/-	MSS	590/-	(6 Month)	MSS
4.	Construction of Samajik sabhagruh at Dahiwad Baudhwadi Tal. Mahad Dist. Raigad II call 8/800 Tal. Mangaon II Call	1602415/-	17000/-	560/-	12 Months	Class VI

Schedule

Seq. No.	Stage	Start Date	Start Time	Expiry Date	Expiry Time
1.	Period of online sale & online Submission of bid documents	16.10.2026	10.00	23.10.2026	18.00
2.	Online opening of Technical bid (If possible) in Office of Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Mahad District Raigad	26.10.2026	12.00		

Note: Bid documents are available on https://mahatenders.gov.in
No. MHD/AB/TC/3688
Date : 14.10.2026
DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 3268

Sd/-
(S. M. Kamble)
Executive Engineer
Public Works Division, Mahad

Starting at an exchange effective price of ₹39,999*

	Pixel 11 256 GB	Pixel 11 512 GB	Pixel 11 Pro 256 GB	Pixel 11 Pro XL 256 GB
MRP (incl. of all taxes)	₹89,999	₹104,999	₹119,999	₹134,999
Store discount	-	₹10,000	-	-
Instant Bank Cashback (up to)	₹7,000	₹7,000	₹10,000	₹10,000
Exchange value of old smartphone*	₹34,000	₹34,000	₹46,000	₹46,000
Exchange Bonus (up to)	₹9,000	₹9,000	₹9,000	₹9,000
Exchange Effective Price	**₹39,999**	**₹44,999**	**₹54,999**	**₹69,999**

1. Up to ₹ 10,000 Instant Cashback on Credit Cards
   HDFC BANK ICICI Bank
2. Up to ₹ 9,000 Exchange Bonus
   CASHIFY SERVIFY
3. Up to 62.5% Buyback value after 9 months
   Google Pixel Upgrade Program

Scan to know more

BAJAJ FINANCE IDFC FIRST Bank TVS CREDIT ICICI Bank Zero down payment No cost EMI upto 24 months also available on consumer loans.

*Terms & Conditions apply. The limited period exclusive offer price is computed on the MRP ₹89999.00 (incl. of all taxes) of Pixel 11, 256 GB, (1 N). The illustrative Exchange Effective Price ₹39999.00 is calculated above MRP, is as reduced by ₹7000 Instant Cashback available on select HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank Credit Cards, and further reduced by an illustrative exchange value of ₹34000.00 on Pixel 9 256GB (1 N) in a good working condition along with ₹9000.00 exchange bonus. The exchange value of ₹46000.00 is illustrated on Pixel 9 Pro 256GB (1 N) in a good working condition. The Exchange Value and Bonus is exclusively provided by the Authorized Trade-in Providers Cashify and Servify at their sole discretion. No Cost EMI consumer loan schemes upto 24 months are available on Bajaj Finance Ltd, IDFC First Bank, TVS Credit and ICICI Bank. The consumer loan approval from the financier is at their sole discretion. Processing fee, foreclosure fee and GST on interest component applicable as per Bank's terms and conditions.